老虎的金黄
El Oro de los Tigres

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旧雨伞
An Old Umbrella 4TH-01

El oro de los tigres
老虎的金黄

An Old Umbrella
旧雨伞

Druvis Ⅲ: ...!
槲寄生：……！

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin ...
槲寄生：维尔汀……

Through the window, she sees a beam of light penetrates the statue suspended in time.
窗外的光穿过了一座停滞的雕像。

Druvis Ⅲ: I saw ... Vertin ... by the "Storm" ...!
槲寄生：我看见……维尔汀她……被“暴雨”——！

Druvis Ⅲ: ... No.
槲寄生：……不。

Druvis Ⅲ: It's just a nightmare.
槲寄生：只是一个噩梦。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

The slender figure gets up. The lobby is as spacious as it used to be, but she's the only being walking across it now.
修长的影子站起身来。偌大的庭院空着，只剩下她一人了。

Druvis Ⅲ: A nightmare overly real.
槲寄生：一个过于清晰的噩梦。

Druvis Ⅲ: Is it because I haven't seen them for so long?
槲寄生：是因为我太久没有见到她们了么？

Rarely this place would be in such serenity.
这个地方鲜有如此静谧的时刻。

Since their return to the Foundation, each one of them has been invited to a one-on-one talk with the Foundation's personnel.
回到基金会以后，所有人都被接连邀请去与机构人员单独交谈。

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin ... was the first to leave.
槲寄生：维尔汀……是最先离开的。

Druvis Ⅲ: She said she was going to talk to Madam Z about which department we would belong to. I haven't heard from her since then.
槲寄生：她说要去与 Z 女士谈谈我们的编制归属问题，自此以后便再没有消息。

Vertin: Yes. Here are their background reports I wrote for your perusal.
维尔汀：是的。这是我撰写的背景报告，请您过目。

Druvis Ⅲ: Then, Sotheby.
槲寄生：接着，是苏芙比。

Druvis Ⅲ: Her boredom was swept away by the invitation. She departed in such a haste that her beloved doll was left behind on the carpet.
槲寄生：邀请扫去了她多日的沉闷，她告别得匆忙，以至于将最心爱的玩偶落在了地毯上。

Vertin: This is Sotheby. A well-educated lady born in a traditional arcanist family.
维尔汀：这是苏芙比，一位受过良好教育的传统神秘学家庭出身的淑女。

Vertin: She comes from an extremely privileged background. Her family had a special influence around the world.
维尔汀：她曾在极度优渥的环境中成长，家族在世界各地拥有特殊的影响力。

Vertin: Besides, she has limited social skills and scientific knowledge. It will be difficult to assimilate her.
维尔汀：除此以外，她缺乏一定的社会常识与科学技术知识，同化难度较高。

Druvis Ⅲ: Compared to Sotheby, Mr. APPLe was apparently not very happy to be invited. When he left, he turned a little green.
槲寄生：与苏芙比相比起来，APPLe 先生显然不太乐意接受邀请。他离开的时候，颜色都有些发青。

Vertin: Mr. APPLe, under his modest and gentle appearance, lies a sharp perception by nature.
维尔汀：APPLe 先生，与他谦和的外表不同，他的性格中藏有审视的锋芒。

Vertin: Being so erudite, he always has his own views of our historical intelligence.
维尔汀：他的学识相当渊博，对我们的历史情报一向有着独到的经验与见解。

Vertin: As far as I know, he remains upset about Captain Regulus's involuntary affiliations with the Foundation.
维尔汀：据我所知，他一直对星锑船长被迫加入基金会一事感到不满。

Vertin: While Regulus has never been truly accepted by the Foundation.
维尔汀：而基金会并没有真正地接纳星锑。

Vertin: She has missed out all the education and training a member of the Foundation should have received. The influence left by the outside world on her is like a banner among the ordinary staff in the Foundation. A banner way too salient.
维尔汀：她的人生错过了基金会成员应受到的所有教育与训练。她现有的烙印，就像是基金会里一面过于鲜艳的旗帜。

Vertin: Once the banner was held up, new arguments were raised, and thus exacerbated the factional conflict inside the Foundation.
维尔汀：这面旗帜的加入，在基金会内部引发了新的争论——这一切都让我们派系的矛盾变得更加尖锐。

Z: Factional conflict? There ought to be no factions in the Foundation. All of us share one common goal. You should know that well.
Z：派系？基金会不应存在派系，我们只有一个共同目标。这一点，你很清楚。

Vertin: But the conflict has been there all the time.
维尔汀：可是矛盾一直存在。

Vertin: And it only grows.
维尔汀：而且愈演愈烈。

Z: ...
Z：……

Vertin: The group that believes in "mankind supremacy" is splitting the Foundation's belief apart.
维尔汀：推崇人类至上主义的团体，正在分裂着基金会的信仰。

Z: ... So, time isn't the only thing you've been observing these years.
Z: ……看来这些年你并不只是在观测时间。

Vertin: The conflicts cannot be covered by regulations anymore, Madam Z.
维尔汀：这些矛盾已经无法再用一纸章程来掩盖了，Z 女士。

Vertin: The "Storm" has been here for 8 years. None of the people who are left behind can shake off the influence it brought.
维尔汀：“暴雨”持续了八年。所有停留在原地的人，都摆脱不了它的影响。

Vertin: Human technologies are being reversed, while arcanum is blooming.
维尔汀：人类科技在倒退，而神秘学却愈发昌盛。

Vertin: The unexpected first "Storm" brought more than half of the Foundation's elite members away from us. The number of staff of the House of Integratus and the Committee cannot compare with that of their heyday even now.
维尔汀：第一场猝不及防的雨，让基金会失去了大半的精英成员。直至现在，共融院与委员会的任职人数都无法再回到当年的盛况。

Vertin: In order to contend against Manus Vindictae, we have kept absorbing arcanists from the outside world ... However, the dissenting voices have only grown louder ...
维尔汀：为了与重塑之手抗衡，我们不断地吸纳外部的神秘学家……直到基金会内部抗议的声音愈来愈大……

Vertin: Loud enough to be heard, and have become a faction that couldn't be shaken—the Mankind Caucus.
维尔汀：大到凝聚成了一个难以撼动的新群体，人类党团。

Vertin: Beyond their control, these new arcanists only brought fear. They demand an unchallengeable power to make decisions and a harsher control of arcanists.
维尔汀：不受控的新增力量正在加深他们的恐惧。他们要求毋庸置疑的话语权，以及对神秘学家更为严苛的管制。

Vertin: Madam Z, I don't want my friends or me to be the sacrifice of this conflict ... As we were four years ago.
维尔汀：Z 女士，我不希望我和我的朋友们，成为这场漩涡的牺牲品——就像四年前那样。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Z: That's why you handed in the background reports of those arcanists as the evidence for your proposition in the negotiation.
Z: 所以你带来了这些神秘学家的背景分析报告，作为谈判桌上的佐证。

Z: Vertin, what do you want?
Z: 你想要的是什么？维尔汀。

Vertin: A neutral, safe, and legitimate place for us.
维尔汀：一个中立，安全，合法的立足之地。

Z: What if I'm also on the side of Mankind Caucus?
Z: 不担心我也是人类党团的其中一员？

Vertin: I don't know whose side you are on. But I believe the future you pursue doesn't end up with the Foundation being split apart by factional conflict.
维尔汀：我不了解您的立场。但我相信，您所追求的未来，一定不包含因党争而分崩离析的结局。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Vertin: That's what I learnt from that stormy night.
维尔汀： 这一点，我已经在那个雨夜里得到了答案。

Vertin: Your eyes told me ...
维尔汀： 您的眼神……

Vertin: ... you didn't belong to that chess game.
维尔汀： 不属于那一场棋局。

Z: ... You may leave the reports. I need some time.
Z: ……资料留下吧。我需要一些时间。

Vertin: No matter what your decision is ... thank you.
维尔汀： 不论结果如何……谢谢您。

In the middle of the office stands solely the lady in white.
办公室里只剩下一个白色的身影。

She flips through the files, sighs, and then picks up the phone.
她翻阅着文件，叹了口气，拿起电话。

Z: Please put me through Delegate Mark.
Z: 帮我转接代表人马克的办公室。

The long hallway is located between the Committee and the House of Integratus, forming a bridge between the two loci of power.
长廊位于委员会与共融院之间，如同一座联结二者权力的桥梁。

Familiar and unfamiliar ones bustle around in the hallway, holding proposals that only have a one-in-ten chance of passing.
熟悉或陌生的面孔来去匆匆，抱着仅有十分之一通过率的议案在走廊上奔走。

Medical Staff I: Hey, Vertin!
医疗职员 I： 嘿！维尔汀。

Vertin: Hello.
维尔汀： ……你好。

Medical Staff I: Your friend is waiting for you in the rehab center. Mesmer Jr., remember?
医疗职员 I： 你的朋友在康复中心等你。小梅斯梅尔，你还记得吗?

Medical Staff II: Let us take you there, so you guys can catch up.
医疗职员 II： 让我们带你过去叙叙旧吧。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 湿漉漉的信
Trail ① Wet Letter 小径

Wet Letter
湿漉漉的信

英文 / ENGLISH
Dear Z, the last person from who I'd expect a letter,

I am glad to hear from you.
About what you wrote to ask, I didn't find anything. No one in the France branch knows about the "Storm," including the leader and some of the senior officers. I think you have to give up on this one.

But we need to know more about the "Storm," so do those big shots. That's why the Foundation is desperate for a source of information and values the "Timekeeper" so much. That being the case, we are back to the beginning ... How ridiculous. I don't think there is anything else I can do for you or her.
The good news is, my business trip to the France branch has been smooth, and I'm estimated to be back in the headquarters tomorrow afternoon (I'm writing this before my way back so I can use the beautiful special stamp I got here).
Maybe we can have another game by then. The people here are not good at ping-pong, so things became boring after I had beaten everyone I saw.

By the way, congratulations on your promotion.
I'm glad to know you have already adapted to the style of communication and the work in the Foundation. Clever as you are, we all know you were still thinking and acting the "scientist" way. Anyway, the time no longer goes forward, but it didn't stop. It has brought us to this mess and we have to do something.

One more thing—
keep the black umbrella you mentioned. You don't always get to find a rain gear used by someone that witnesses and braves the "Storm."

Yours,
Katz
From the France branch
中文 / CHINESE
令人意外的来信者 Z:

很高兴你能给我写信。

关于你托我打听的事情，我一无所获。法兰西分部上下都对“暴雨”一无所知——包括其中领导者与部分高位职员，你应该放弃这条路了。

但我们都需要知道更多“暴雨”的信息。我与你是这样，那些大人物也一样。所以基金会才那样迫切地期待一个信息渠道，如此迫切地需要“司辰”。但这么一来，一切就可笑地回到了原点。我想我无法为你和她提供更多的帮助。

而好消息是，我在法兰西分部的短期工作进行得很顺遂，预计会在明日午后返回基金会总部（而在那之前，我得给你写一封回信，用掉这儿特制的美丽邮票）。

届时，我们可以再打一局乒乓赛。这儿的人并不擅长这种桌上运动，我折服了我能瞧见的所有对手，一切就变得了然无趣。

哦——还有，听说你升职了，这也是一个好消息。

我很高兴你能如此之快地适应政治上的交流，适应基金会的工作。虽然你是个很聪明的人，但我们都知道，你一直保留着你的“科学家”做派——无论如何，时间它不再前进了，可它从不停止。它把我们带到了如今这个场面。我们总得做出应对。

最后——

留下你信中所写的那把黑伞吧。能见证“暴雨”与行走于其中之人诞生的雨具可不多见。

卡兹
于法兰西分部回

离群者
The Outsider 4TH-02

The Outsider
离群者

Foundation Staff: Ms. Druvis, we are waiting for your response.
基金会职员：槲寄生小姐，我们在等候您的答复。

Druvis Ⅲ: Now ... I am the last to be invited.
槲寄生：如今……我是最后一位被邀请的客人。

Foundation Staff: Is there anything else that concerns you, Ms. Druvis?
基金会职员：槲寄生小姐，请问您还有什么疑虑吗?

Druvis Ⅲ: When will my friends come back?
槲寄生：我的朋友们，什么时候会回来?

Foundation Staff: They are waiting for you outside the suitcase, just as we are. All we want is an opportunity to talk to you face to face.
基金会职员：他们与我们一样，都在箱子外等您。只要您能给我们一个与您面谈的机会。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Druvis Ⅲ: Please wait a moment.
槲寄生：请稍等片刻。

There is no time to feel attached to the past.
已经不是留恋的时候了。

She looks at the brown granules in her palm. These are seeds of trees.
她看向掌心中褐色的小颗粒，那是树的种子。

As she wags the fingers, the seeds are sprinkled on the ground by the stairs. They quickly roll and disappear in the gaps and crevices.
种子由指间落向阶梯两侧的地上，它们很快便钻进了砖缝之间，不见踪影。

SPDM Library
第一防线图书馆

Her friends are not here, of course.
朋友们当然都不在这里。

Druvis Ⅲ: May I ask ... where we are?
槲寄生：请问……这是何处?

Constantine: The library, a place where people let down their guards.
康斯坦丁：图书馆，一个能让人放下防备心的地方。

Constantine: Trust always facilitates cooperation, don't you think?
康斯坦丁：信任，能帮助人们更好地建立合作关系，你认为呢?

Druvis Ⅲ: ... But I don't even know your name.
槲寄生：——但我还不知道你的名字。

Constantine: The name is Constantine. I'm the vice president of the Joint Committee of the Foundation.
康斯坦丁：康斯坦丁，基金会联合委员会的副会长。

Constantine: Please allow me to extend a welcome on behalf of the Foundation.
康斯坦丁：请允许我代表基金会，欢迎你的到来。

She taps her pen on the table and calls out a thin pile of documents. The signatures are left blank on the paper.
她的钢笔在桌前敲了敲，桌上出现一小叠文档。这是一份待签署的文件。

Constantine: We have sent this document into that suitcase days ago. I should assume that you have read it.
康斯坦丁：这个文件，几天前就送到了箱子里，想必你已经看过了。

Constantine: What's your conclusion then, Ms. Weyerhaeuser?
康斯坦丁：考虑得怎么样？韦耶豪瑟小姐。

Druvis Ⅲ: Are you referring to ... inviting Sotheby, Mr. APPLe and me to join the Foundation?
槲寄生：你指的是……邀请我、苏芙比和 APPLe 加入基金会的事情吗?

Druvis Ⅲ: We need to discuss this with Vertin before we give you a proper response.
槲寄生：我们需要与维尔汀商议此事，以便给出得当的回复。

Druvis Ⅲ: We don't know much about the Foundation. As far as I'm concerned ... I do not yet intend to join any organization.
槲寄生：我们对基金会的了解并不多。就目前而言，我个人……尚未打算加入任何组织。

Constantine: That is to say, you are inclined to turn down my proposal.
康斯坦丁：——也就是说，对于我的提议，你倾向反对。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Druvis Ⅲ: My apologies ... Vertin has not only been of great help to us, but also saved us from the "Storm."
槲寄生：抱歉……维尔汀不但给予了我们莫大的帮助，更从“暴雨”中救回了我们。

Druvis Ⅲ: I cannot accept the invitation without her opinion, neither can I make decisions for others.
槲寄生：如果没有得到她的意见，我无法贸然接受这个邀请，更不能替其他人做决定。

Constantine: Fair enough.
康斯坦丁：很好。

Constantine gets up on her feet and walks to the other side of the table.
康斯坦丁站起身来，走到桌的另一侧。

There stands an unfinished card tower.
那里放着一座未搭完的牌屋。

Constantine: You, who accidentally and rather luckily escaped from the "Storm" in 1929 and now seek refuge from the Foundation—Weyerhaeuser, Sotheby, and APPLe. You are the spire of the tower.
康斯坦丁：这是你们。阴差阳错躲过了二九年那一场“暴雨”，停留在基金会寻求庇护的韦耶豪瑟、苏芙比、APPLe。

Constantine: Between you and the Foundation, the storeys in the middle, are our investigators who go out to rescue the wandering arcanists and humans.
康斯坦丁：而联结你们与基金会的，是中间这些——冒着生命危险，在外救助流浪神秘学家与人类的基金会调查员们。

Constantine: Vertin, is one of them.
康斯坦丁：维尔汀正是其中的一名职员。

Constantine: Merely a drop in the ocean.
康斯坦丁：沧海中的一粟。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...!
槲寄生：……!

Constantine: Vertin indeed is the key to connect you and the Foundation.
康斯坦丁：维尔汀确实是联结你们与基金会的关键人物。

Constantine: But let's not forget, only an entity as massive and powerful as the Foundation can provide you with long-lasting protection.
康斯坦丁：但别忘了，能为你们提供永久庇护的，是基金会这个权威、稳固，历史悠久的庞然大物。

Constantine: Without the Foundation's supplies, manpower, and technology, even Vertin can barely sail against the great tides of history, let alone the ordinary people, whose fate is doomed to struggle in the endless hazards of time.
康斯坦丁：没有基金会的物资、人力、科研技术做支撑，即便是维尔汀，也只能在历史的洪流中挣扎。其他人，更是会陷入到无止境的时间灾害中。

Constantine: Open your eyes and take a look ...
康斯坦丁：擦亮双眼，看清楚——

Constantine: We, are the unshakable fortress you should rely on.
康斯坦丁：我们，才是你该倚靠的大厦。

Constantine: Do you still wish to talk to Vertin first?
康斯坦丁：你还打算和维尔汀商量吗?

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Constantine: She is receiving a treatment from us.
康斯坦丁：她正在接受我们的治疗。

Constantine: Which means she won't make it back by your side before any decision is made.
康斯坦丁：——在你下定决心之前，她都不会回来了。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Constantine: Her suitcase will also be retrieved for research purposes after the meeting. As compensation for your displacement, we will arrange you a **more decent** room.
康斯坦丁：会谈结束后，我们将收回手提箱用作研究。作为补偿，我们会为你安排一个更为得体的房间。

Constantine: Ms. Z will show you around the headquarters tomorrow.
康斯坦丁：明天 Z 女士会带你去熟悉基金会的环境。

Constantine: Go walk around and meet some people ... Perhaps it will help you see what the most beneficial choice to all of us will be.
康斯坦丁：跟着她四处逛逛，见见朋友，好好思考如何做一个对大家都有利的决定。

Constantine: I will wait for your answer.
康斯坦丁：我会继续等待你的答复。

Constantine: But ...
康斯坦丁：但是……

Constantine: Don't keep me waiting for too long.
康斯坦丁：也别让我等得太久了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

衣帽架
A Coat Rack 4TH-03

A Coat Rack
衣帽架

Lobby, St. Foundation
基金会大堂

Z: ... Yes. I've received the report on the Chicago office.
Z: ……嗯，芝加哥办事处的报告资料我已经收到了。

Z: Well done.
Z: 你做得很好。

The envelope leaves her and flies out of the window. Madam Z quickly walks through the crowds and stops at a door in a hallway.
信封飞出窗外。Z 女士越过人群，快步来到一扇门前。

Aside from the vibrant secretary area, the entire hallway is bathed in a serene vibe.
除了同样在忙碌的秘书区域外，这条长廊都沉浸在一种恬静的氛围中。

This is the door to her own office.
这是独属于她的办公室。

Joint Committee of SF
基金会联合委员会办公室

Constantine: Good timing.
康斯坦丁： 你来得正好。

Z: ...!
Z: ……!

Constantine: Did I startle you? Considering what we have been through together, I didn't expect you to be as surprised as Ms. Weyerhaeuser was.
康斯坦丁： 吓到你了吗？我以为以我们的关系，你不会像韦耶豪瑟小姐那样惊讶。

Z: ... Sharon didn't tell me you're here.
Z: ……莎朗没告诉我你来了。

Constantine: There's no need to tense up. I told her not to say anything.
康斯坦丁： 别紧张。是我特意不让她说的。

Constantine: I have talked to Ms. Weyerhaeuser. Everything is going well.
康斯坦丁： 我已经和韦耶豪瑟小姐谈过了，目前进展得非常顺利。

Constantine: She has gotten quite a shock. That little pale face ... like a stressed cat. She is in dire need of comfort from a friend.
康斯坦丁： 她吓得不轻，脸色发白，如同一只应激的野猫，渴望同伴的安慰。

Z: What do you want me to do?
Z: 你希望我做什么？

Constantine: To do what a good tamer would do. Reach her with a sincere, friendly gesture, ease their pains, answer their questions, and lead them onto the right path.
康斯坦丁： 去做一名优秀的驯兽师，真诚地、值得信赖地伸出你的友谊之手，抚平他们痛苦的心，解答他们的所有疑惑，指引他们一条康庄大道。

Constantine: Of course, most importantly, make them be of use to us—to serve the course of the peace of mankind.
康斯坦丁： 当然，最重要的是，让他们完全归我们所用——为人类的和平事业添砖加瓦。

Z: I see.
Z： 好，我明白了。

Constantine feels pleased with the response. She gets up and walks towards the door.
康斯坦丁对她的回答很满意。她站起身来，向门外走去。

Constantine: None of them has signed the agreement.
康斯坦丁： 他们都没有签下协议。

Constantine: But this recruitment is essential for us. For the short term and for the long run.
康斯坦丁： 但这次收编对我们来说至关重要。不仅事关现在，还会影响将来。

Constantine: Can you see what I am doing?
康斯坦丁： 你能理解我吗?

Madam Z listens with her head bowed.
Z 女士低着头。

Constantine smiles.
康斯坦丁笑了起来。

Constantine: Oh, and there's one more thing.
康斯坦丁： 哦，对了。

Constantine: Don't address her as "Ms. Weyerhaeuser." She doesn't like it.
康斯坦丁： 记得别叫她韦耶豪瑟小姐，她不喜欢这个称呼。

Z: I'll take note on that.
Z： 了解。

She stares at her, until that slim, tall figure goes through the door and disappears in a distant light.
在 Z 女士的注视下，高挑的身影越过门槛，消失在远处的光影中。

Sotheby: Five and two-thirds portions of silver wine, twenty drops of toad oil, and some crumbles of pure gold from Ucayali ...
苏芙比： 五又三分之二的银酒、二十滴蛤蟆油，再来点乌卡亚利软黄金的渣滓……

Guest Room, St. Foundation
基金会客房

Sotheby rests her head on the table, stirring the semi-solid liquid in the tube.
苏芙比趴在桌上，搅拌着眼前的半固体。

She contemplates for a bit and takes out two more tubes with bright-colored materials inside from under her dress.
她思考了一会儿，又从裙子里掏出两条颜色鲜艳的试管。

Sotheby: Da da la la la ♪
苏芙比： 哒哒啦啦啦～♪～

Sotheby: Last ingredient, the burning acid salts ...
苏芙比： 还差最后一步，放入正在燃烧的酸盐……

Sotheby: Sotheby's incredible shapeshifting potion will be done at any minute!
苏芙比： 苏芙比伟大的变形药剂马上就要大功告成了!

The burning acid salts fall into the bowl, and out of that bowl raises a strange smell.
燃烧的酸盐落入碗中，古怪的气味弥漫了出来。

Sotheby: Hmm? Wh-what is going on?! The edge of the potion has turned pink ...
苏芙比：咦？咦——这是怎么回事！怎么边缘的液体都变成粉红色了……

Sotheby: Blimey ... It's the iron bowl ... It reacted with the potion!
苏芙比：啊……是这个铁碗……和它发生反应了！

Sotheby: Oh no ... This is not good. What effect will it cause now? I should have brought my crucible with me. Nothing can work as a decent vessel here!
苏芙比：呜呜……这可糟糕了，这个药剂会变成什么效果啊？都怪我当时没有带坩埚出来。这里能用的容器太少了！

She jumps up with annoyance and starts taking circles in the room.
她气恼地蹦起来，在房间里团团转。

Sotheby: Time is against me. Dinner will be served at any minute. I have to make up my mind now!
苏芙比：要来不及了，他们快来送餐了——我得赶紧下决定才行！

She is quickly counting the ingredients hidden under her dress, 23, 24 ... 106 ...
她快速地计算藏在裙子里的素材的数量。第二十三个、第二十四个……第一百零六个……

Not far away from the room, footsteps come closer and closer to her closed door.
而不远处，脚步声在接近那扇关闭严实的门。

Guard I: Ms. Sotheby, dinner is ready.
守卫 I：苏芙比小姐，晚餐时间到了。

Sotheby: ...!
苏芙比：……！

Sotheby: W-wait! Don't come in!
苏芙比：等，等一下！！先别进来！

Sotheby: Ugh, I don't have enough ingredients for another potion! What can I do?
苏芙比：呜，我的素材不够再做一个变形药剂了！这可怎么办？

Sotheby: This could be the last chance to make it out ...!
苏芙比：如果今天逃不出去，以后可能就……再也没有机会了……！

Guard I: Ms. Sotheby? Do you need help?
守卫 I：苏芙比小姐？有什么需要帮忙的吗？

Sotheby: I-I am putting on stockings! This is lady's dressing time, so don't you come in! Just a minute!
苏芙比：我……我在穿袜子！这可是淑女打扮的时间，你们谁都不许进来！我马上就好！

The tube is radiating heat in her palm.
试管在手心里微微发热。

Sotheby: It's alright, I'll be fine. I may look a bit different from expected, but it doesn't matter.
苏芙比：没关系，没关系。最多也只是一些外观上的区别，没什么大不了的。

Sotheby: Three, two, one!
苏芙比：三、二、一！

She inhales deeply, and finishes the potion in one gulp.
深吸一口气，一饮而下。

The unperfect potion flows through her throat, reeking of the smell of timber in her esophagus.
不纯净的药剂淌过咽喉，在食道里散发出木材的气味。

She feels something is tickling her in the hair, and her head seems to lose its weight; her nails become fluffy like cotton, stretching out in all directions.
接着头发开始发痒，变轻；指甲柔软得像棉花，向四周无限地伸展。

There seems to be a sun hatching in her larynx, hanging over the rest of her body. This is a feeling too distinct to be overlooked.
她感到喉咙变成了一颗悬挂在体内的太阳，鲜明地彰显自己的存在。

Sotheby: Ugh ... *coughing* My throat is burning ...
苏芙比： 唔……咳咳！喉咙好难受……

Sotheby: But I made it, didn't I? *coughing* Let me see ... What am I now ...
苏芙比： 但我好像成功了！咳咳、我看看……我变成了什么……

Sotheby: ... A coat rack?!
苏芙比： ——衣帽架?!

Sotheby: Impossible! I was expecting a movable tennis ball!
苏芙比： 怎么会这样！我是打算变成一个行动自如的网球的！

Guard I: Ms. Sotheby.
守卫 I： 苏芙比小姐。

Guard I: Please excuse me, but I have to open the door.
守卫 I： 很抱歉，但是我必须要打开门了。

Sotheby: ...!
苏芙比： ……！

Creak ... *door opens*
“咔嚓——”

Guard I: Ms. Sotheby?
守卫 I： 苏芙比小姐?

The guard freezes with a dinner plate, looking up and down in bewilderment.
端着餐盘的基金会守卫愣了一下，视线上下移动。

There is truly no one in the room. Nor any places for anyone to hide.
房间内空无一人。守卫也没看到足以藏下一个人的掩体。

Guard I: ...?
守卫 I： ……?

Sotheby: ...
苏芙比： ……

Guard I: This coat rack ... Was it here before?
守卫 I： 这个衣帽架……原本就在这里吗?

He doesn't like the way it stands there. He turns his face around to the desk.
守卫不太喜欢这个衣帽架。他转过身去，面向书桌。

He certainly can't miss that muddy semi-finished potion in the bowl.
桌上那碗像被搅碎的泥一样的半成品很引人注目。

He cautiously dips his gloved fingers in that suspicious mud and takes a whiff.
他用手套沾了沾，在鼻子下轻嗅。

Guard I: She must still be in the room.
守卫 I： 她应该还在房间里。

Yes, indeed. Suffering she is, in this very room.
是的，没错。她还在房间里遭受苦刑。

Sotheby: ...
苏芙比： ……

Itchy. Incredibly itchy.
很痒。十分的痒。

Her throat feels as if it'd become a lump of soil, where water weeds grow vigorously, and they are dancing, and burning.
喉咙里就像长出了一团水草，不仅在跳舞，还在燃烧。

Sotheby: ...
苏芙比：——

Sotheby: *Coughing* ...
苏芙比：口、亥……

Sotheby: *Coughing* ...! Oops ... *Coughing harder* ...
苏芙比：咳咳咳……咳咳……！啊……咳咳咳咳咳……呃唔嗯嗯嗯……

Guard I: ...?! Ms. Sotheby!
守卫Ⅰ：……?！苏芙比小姐！

Sotheby: Whoa ...!
苏芙比：呜哇——!!

Sotheby: Jump, jump! Oomph! Oomph! Oomph!
苏芙比：我跳，我跳——嘿、嘿、嘿——!!

She grips her hat, jumping like a standing twig towards the open door.
苏芙比紧抓着帽子，向敞开的大门蹦去。

What a strenuous move, what a painful pace ... she can't help missing the days when she could walk with two legs.
吃力的动作，缓慢的移动速度——她怀念起了双腿直立行走的日子。

... But the guard seizes her by the pole.
——而守卫直接抓住了她的支架。

Guard I: Ms. Sotheby, you are not allowed to leave the room without permission.
守卫Ⅰ：苏芙比小姐。未经同意，你不能离开这个房间。

Guard I: Please forgive me for being violent.
守卫Ⅰ：请原谅我接下来的暴力行为。

Sotheby: Ugh ... It's the iron bowl's fault ...
苏芙比：呜……都是因为魔药混进了杂质……

Sotheby: This is false imprisonment! I must get out of here today!!
苏芙比：你们这是非法囚禁——！我，我今天一定要离开这里!!

Sotheby: Bodyguards! Bodyguards!!
苏芙比：保镖——！保镖!!

Guard I: A-achoo ...!
守卫Ⅰ：阿、阿嚏……!

The potion Sotheby smashes on the floor has taken effect; the guard is deeply troubled by the sneezes one after another.
苏芙比扔在地上的魔药发挥了作用，守卫被熏得喷嚏连连。

Sotheby: Hmph! You can never seize Ms. Sotheby the great potion alchemist that easily!
苏芙比：哼～想抓住伟大的魔药炼金术师苏芙比小姐，可没有那么容易！

More of the people in white are attracted by the noises in this room.
喧闹过后，门外出现了更多的白袍人士。

Guard I: What? What's going on?
守卫 I： 怎么了？发生了什么事?

Guard I: What's wrong, Ms. Sotheby? Your dress is a mess! Ugh, this room smells terrible ...
守卫 I： 苏芙比小姐，你的衣服怎么这么脏？唔，这个房间有股难闻的味道……

Sotheby: Oh! My body is back. The potion's effect ... wears off ...
苏芙比： 啊！我变回来了，药剂生效时间……结束了……

The guard covered in odd slime tries to get up off the floor with great effort.
沾着奇怪液体的守卫艰难地爬起身来。

Guard I: Achoo! Ugh ... It's good to see you here. W-we must apply for more guards for this room!
守卫 I： 阿嚏！啊……你们来得正好。这个房间需要申请、申请多人看管！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

太阳照常升起
The Sun Will Continue to Rise 小径

You fall back into the crowd. I understand. I can feel the desire and depression burning deep inside your brain: you are longing to be a part of an absurd, broken, bizarre arcanum story which is beyond your imagination and past experience.
???: 你重新跌回了人群之中。我理解的，我能感受到燃自你脑髓深处的渴望与沮丧——你想切身地体会一场怪诞的、破碎的、离奇的，超出你自身经验的神秘学故事。

But sorry, I can't help laughing: you got into some trouble and have to run around blindly among those in white robes like a panicked ant.
???: 但很遗憾，我忍不住要发出怪笑：你遇到了一点儿麻烦，不得不像只蚂蚁惊惶得在白袍子中间兜兜转。

Come on. Close your eyes. Imagine inside a TV with static noise, a red-nosed bad guy opens his arms to you and says, "Welcome, to, the, human, world."
???: 来吧，闭上眼睛试试看。想象一台信号受损的电视机里，一个红鼻子的坏蛋向你摊开双手：欢，迎，来，到，人，类，的，世，界。

选项 / Choices

1. These stupid commas!
1. 这些愚蠢的逗号！

2. I'm already in the human world.
2. 我本来就在人类的世界

分支 1 / Branch 1

I know, dude! As puzzling as our usual big shots. They stand on the podium, with a mic in their hands, and everyone can see their uvula trembling from their wide-open mouths as they speak.
???: 没错，老兄！就像我们常见的大人物一样令人费解。他们总是站在高耸的舞台上，握着麦克风，嗓门里的小舌头缓慢地打着颤。

Hello, hello, testing, testing. Three, two, one, three, two, one. Comma, comma, comma. Everyone has to wait for what will happen with a full bladder and an empty stomach.
???: 喂，喂，测试，测试，三二一，三二一。逗号逗号逗号。而我们所有人都不得不膀胱憋着尿，饿着肚子，等待接下来会发生什么。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Nice pun! But you don't understand what I'm saying, for now. When the day comes, you will find yourself, you will find me, you will find them ... Oh, thinking of that day, my damned heart is beating crazily like a dying reindeer's!
???: 绝妙的一语双关！但现在的你并不明白我在说些什么。等到那一天来临，你找到了你，你找到了我，你找到了他们……哦，一想到那一刻，我这该死的心脏跟个临终的麋鹿似的怦怦乱跳！

But look at this moment, it's just fine. You know where you should be, and you don't have anything that you shouldn't have in your mind. You just crouch here with patience ...
???: 放眼现在，这也很好。你清楚自己的位置，头脑里没有不该有的思绪，甚至还耐心地蹲在这里——

Listen, this is not just a world of arcanists. Arcanists, arcanum creatures, and even arcanum itself are but insignificant existence hidden beneath all else.
???: 听好了，这个世界上不止存在神秘学家。神秘学家，神秘学物种，甚至神秘学本身——都是一个隐秘得不能再隐秘的低微的存在。

You must learn about those who are in power at the present moment. They live on the other side of the earth, setting rules on the thrones in the scarcely populated wilderness.
???: 你必须要去了解现在权势在握的人们。他们住在地球的另一边，在地广人稀的王座上编织着规则。

Much has been done for the order, for the vision, for the ultimate goal which will satisfy the majority yet sacrifice the minority. They wage wars and strike deals, building a pyramid that symbolizes supreme power with skeletons of the commoners.
???: 为了秩序，为了理想，为了满足大多数而牺牲少数的幸福，他们游走在战争与交易之间，用统一的白骨搭建起至高无上的权力大厦。

No, I'm not telling a lame villain story. On the contrary, it's a boring documentary about those in power standing between the sky and the earth, seeking the real meaning of fairness and ideals.
???: 不，我并不是在讲述一个俗套的反派故事。正相反，这是一个无聊的，为了探求什么是公平与理想的，立于天空与大地之间的蠢物的挣扎纪事。

There's still plenty of time! Go ahead. Keep moving, but don't jump to any conclusion. Just make sure you're always on the way, so you will learn more about humans, more and more.
???: 时间还长着呢！向前走，要记得迈开脚步，别轻易下结论，确保你始终在路上。这样你就能越来越了解人类。越来越了解人类。

Take the microscope with you and dig into the rotten history of those poor little things!
???: 带上你的显微镜，好好地去挖掘那堆可怜虫的腐烂历史去吧！

共同接续 / Shared continuation

The Sun Will Continue to Rise
太阳照常升起

干杯，朋友！
Raise A Glass! 4TH-04

Raise A Glass!
干杯，朋友！

Laplace Rehabilitation Center
拉普拉斯康复中心

Brisk, lively running footsteps echo between the walls of the empty hallway.
空旷的走廊上传来充满活力的奔跑声。

Leilani: Ms. Lilya! You are here! Here you are! Heh heh ...
莉拉妮：红弩箭小姐——！你果然在这里！这个、给你！嘿嘿……

Leilani: Our teacher asked me to give you this and asked you to help us to ... um, what was it?
莉拉妮：我们老师让我交给你，说要你帮——呃，是帮忙干什么来着?

Leilani suddenly stops herself. She scratches her head bewilderedly.
莉拉妮突然愣住了，困惑地挠了挠头。

Lilya: To evaluate the mock exam of Zeno's enrollment procedure.
红弩箭：帮忙校验芝诺招生模拟试题的难度。

Leilani: Oh right! That's it! I couldn't find you anywhere. They said you are in the rehab center so I came here ... *pants* as quickly as possible ...
莉拉妮：哦对对对！就是这个！我刚才一直找不到你，听他们说你在康复中心，我就赶忙……呼呼……跑过来了！

Leilani: Well, turns out the moment I saw you, the thing just slipped my mind ... Heh heh, I'm overexcited.
莉拉妮：结果一看到你，我就忘了自己是来做什么的了……嘿嘿，我太激动了。

Lilya: Alright, I got it.
红弩箭：行，我知道了。

Leilani: I'll head back then! It's a great pleasure to see you today!
莉拉妮：那我就先回去啦～！今天能见到你真高兴！

Leilani: Ms. Lilya! Whoo-hoo! Go for it! Allez! Ganbatte!
莉拉妮：红弩箭小姐，呜哦哦哦！加油，加油，加油哇！

Leilani waves at her, running away delightfully.
莉拉妮挥挥手，欢快地跑了。

Lilya: Why "go for it" me ... Do I look like a new recruit to her?
红弩箭：为什么要给我鼓劲，我看起来像个弱鸡吗……

Lilya: Anyway, let me check ...
红弩箭：算了。我看看吧。

Lilya: Elevation: 2500 feet, mountainous terrain, dense forest area, good atmospheric visibility. Enemies: ... groups of ground-based wood critters and airborne Olitiau species 04.
红弩箭：海拔高度 2500 英尺，山地地形，密林环境，大气能见度良。敌人为地面行动的林中魔精群与空中行动的奥利图欧 04 种。

Lilya: If we were to engage the enemy in this dense forest and fight in close range, our mobility will be largely reduced, and we can't "barrel roll" to dodge attacks from the ground. But if we pull up and deal with the air force first ...
红弩箭：进入密林开展近距离空战的话，机动性将大幅削弱，也无法用“桶滚”躲避防守。不如把飞行高度整体拉高，先歼灭空中部队……

Lilya: Hmm ... close enough. Ready to fight.
红弩箭：嗯……差不多了。可以开战了。

Lilya signs her name on the paper.
红弩箭在纸上签下了自己的名字。

Lilya: That's it? Boring.
红弩箭：就这样结束了？真没意思。

Lilya: What kind of new recruits they will let in by giving out such a simple exam ...
红弩箭：这种水平的试题究竟会招来怎样的新兵蛋子啊……

She takes a few mouthfuls from the military canteen hanging on her belt.
她狠狠啜了几口绑带上挂着的水壶。

Z: Are you evaluating the battlefield mock exam for this year? I heard Zeno has updated their question bank.
Z：你在审评今年的新生模拟战场训练题吗？我听说芝诺的题库已经更新了。

Madam Z walks up to her from the other end of the hallway. Not far away from her, a dressy stranger follows.
Z 女士从另一侧的长廊走上前来。她身旁跟着一位衣着考究的外来人。

Lilya: Nah, just killing time.
红弩箭：不，我只是在打发时间。

She throws the exam paper aside, looking up and down at the wand-holding newcomer. Their eyes meet.
她把那沓试题丢到一旁，打量起那个拄着手杖的新面孔。对方也在望着她。

Lilya: ...
红弩箭：……

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Druvis Ⅲ: I smelled bison grass.
槲寄生：我闻到了野牛草的香气。

Lilya: ...?
红弩箭：……?

Druvis Ⅲ: In your canteen.
槲寄生：在你的水壶里。

Lilya: Ha ... right. Authentic Żubrówka, one of the few pastimes I have here.
红弩箭：哈……没错，野牛草伏特加，风味纯正，算是我在这儿为数不多的消遣。

Lilya: Wanna have a sip?
红弩箭：怎么样，来一口?

Druvis Ⅲ: No, thank you.
槲寄生：谢谢，不用了。

Druvis Ⅲ: It smells fresh. Tender. Like thyme and lavender in spring. I believe it is precious.
槲寄生：它闻起来很新鲜，气息柔嫩，如同春日中的百里香与薰衣草。我想它应该很珍贵。

Lilya: You can smell things.
红弩箭：鼻子挺灵敏啊。

Lilya: Fresh indeed, made in 1929. I'll say it's already about ... Forget it, I don't do maths.
红弩箭：确实是新鲜货，二九年产的，距今该有——算了，我也算不清。

A sensitive time. Without saying any more words, they all cast their eyes on the closest window.
这个敏感的时间让他们都不约而同地，把视线投到那扇不远处的透明窗上。

Behind that window, on the bed, lies a patient, securely packed by magnetic coils, rubber tubes, and a transparent helmet.
那张病床上躺着一个被磁圈、橡胶管、透明头罩包裹得严严实实的人。

Lilya: So ... you are here for Vertin too?
红弩箭：所以……你们也是来看望维尔汀的?

Z: I'm showing her around the Foundation, and decided to drop by the rehab center.
Z：我带她来熟悉基金会的环境，顺便来康复中心看看。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Mesmer Jr. sits by the bed. She has noticed the visitors at the window, but she doesn't turn around to them.
小梅斯梅尔坐在病床旁。她注意到了窗外的人影，却没有转过脸来。

Her back stiffens even more. A sign of vigilance.
她的脊背挺得更直了，显得很警惕。

The ward is also guarded by several staff members of the rehabilitation center. Their state-of-the-art equipment spirals up their uniforms.
病房外站着几个康复中心的职员，精良的装备在他们制服上绕了几个圈。

Druvis Ⅲ: Does she dream?
槲寄生：她会做梦吗?

Z: Sometimes.
Z：有时会。

Madam Z stares at the reflection of Druvis's face on the glass.
Z 女士望了望玻璃上倒映出来的槲寄生的脸。

Z: ... Let me show you somewhere else.
Z：……我再带你去其他地方看看吧。

Druvis does not say another word. Silently, she follows Madam Z and moves towards the other side of the hallway.
槲寄生没有说什么，沉默地跟着 Z 女士向另一侧的走廊走去。

Neither of them looks back. At one point or another, their figures overlap each other, as if they were the same person.
她们都没有回头，有时候，身影仿佛重叠在了一起。

Lilya turns her eyes back on the inert person in bed.
红弩箭收回目光，重新望着床上那个一动不动的人。

She jiggles the canteen in her hand. It's still half full.
她晃了晃手上的水壶，里面还留有一半的存货。

Lilya: You have a good taste, "bellwether."
红弩箭：你的品位不错，“越狱头子”。

Lilya: Never tried the vodka from 1929 before. Good for you to get this in the U.S. when both alcohol and coumarin were banned.
红弩箭：我还是第一次喝到二九年的伏特加呢。能在禁酒又禁香豆素的美国搞到这个，真有你的。

Lilya: The thing you said about "Take care of them for me when necessary" ... I'll consider it.
红弩箭：我打算考虑一下了，关于你说的那个——“必要时刻，帮我照看她们”的想法。

Lilya: Raise a glass, friend.
红弩箭：干一杯吧，朋友。

Lilya: To your health, your soon "recovery."
红弩箭：希望你早日“康复”。

Lilya: To our better lives.
红弩箭：希望我们的生活越来越好。

Lilya: To this unknown date, to this messed-up time.
红弩箭：敬这个不知名的年月日，这个乱七八糟的时间。

Lilya: Cheers!
红弩箭：干杯！

Joint Committee of SF
基金会联合委员会办公室

Z: You have a basic idea of this place now. I'll walk you to your room.
Z：基金会的区域已经带你熟悉得差不多了。接下来该送你回房间了。

Z: Is there anything else you want to know?
Z：你还有什么想要了解的吗?

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

Druvis Ⅲ: What do I have to do so you will release Vertin?
槲寄生：我要怎么做，你们才会放维尔汀出来?

Someone has hit the nail on the head.
一针见血。

Z: ...
Z：……

Z: It depends on what you hope to achieve.
Z：这取决于你们的根本目的是什么。

Druvis Ⅲ: Depends on us ... Is that what you said?
槲寄生：取决于我们……是这样吗?

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin, the person we rely on, is being hypnotized in the rehab center.
槲寄生：我们所仰仗的维尔汀，在康复中心因催眠入睡。

Druvis Ⅲ: That suitcase, the world we inhabit, has been taken away for research purposes.
槲寄生：我们所居住的箱中世界，被强制回收用于研究。

Druvis Ⅲ: It's as if the whole thing was manipulated to leave us high and dry and isolated, so that you would have something on us.
槲寄生：这一切都如同一个被特意创造出的把柄，让我们变得如此孤立无援。

Druvis Ⅲ: We do not have a choice, Madam Z.
槲寄生：真正的选择权并不在我们手上，Z 女士。

Z: However, if we change the condition, that "something" they have can turn the negotiation around and in your favor.
Z: 但是只要适当地改变环境，把柄也能变成条件。

Druvis Ⅲ: I ... I do not understand what you mean.
槲寄生: 我……不明白你的意思。

Z: Before she went to the rehab center, Vertin asked me about which department you would be in.
Z: 维尔汀在前往康复中心之前，曾向我咨询过编制的问题。

Z: And we have worked out a feasible proposal.
Z: 我们将它变成了一份可行的议案。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...!
槲寄生: ……！

Z: But a catalyst is what we need at present.
Z: 但是，现在还缺少一剂催化剂。

Z: The quiet, mild, and tranquil status quo makes the change seem unnecessary.
Z: 我们的环境，太平静、太温和、太了无波澜，让改变显得毫无必要。

Z: A proper gust of wind will vitalize the wave of change, and push it to the cusp of revolution.
Z: 只要有一阵恰到好处的东风，就能重新给予它活力，将它推上狂潮的浪尖。

Druvis Ⅲ: You mean ...
槲寄生: 你的意思是——

Druvis Ⅲ: But ... it is risky.
槲寄生: 可是……它充满了风险。

Z: That's true.
Z: 确实如此。

Z: I cannot give you any promises.
Z: 我不能予以什么承诺。

Z: But a fixed pattern of management will only impede the development of everyone. I hold the same idea as Vertin's in this case.
Z: 但一个僵化的管理制度，会越来越不适用于所有人的发展。在这一点上，我与维尔汀意见一致。

Z: Or, there is another path in front of you. Sign your name and become an official member of the Foundation.
Z: 你也可以选择另一条路，签署下你们的名字，成为基金会总部正式的成员。

Z: A path that many arcanists who cannot support themselves yearn for.
Z: 这是许多生活潦倒的神秘学家都十分向往的道路。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生: ……

Druvis Ⅲ: So ... you are not inducing me to join the Foundation?
槲寄生: 所以……你并不打算劝诱我加入基金会?

Z: I'm here to show you around.
Z: 我是来带你熟悉环境的。

Z: My senior asked me to make sure that you had a comforting tour.
Z: 我答应过上级，要确保这趟行程让你感到舒适和安心。

Z: I hope this tour is helpful for you.
Z: 希望今天你能有所收获。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 静置一旁的笔记本
Trail ① A Notebook Left Aside 小径

206th LSCC Seminar - Note
第 206 期科算中心内部报告会-笔记

英文 / ENGLISH
At the meeting this morning, MP Callaghan and his great-grandson Dr. Callaghan Jr. submitted the research report On Zebra Crossing, Lemon, Snow Leopard Pattern, and Transportation and Teleportation Arcanum Rituals in joint names.
In the report, they mentioned an innovational point of view on the relations between zebra crossing and the crisis in human subconsciousness, and that between horse herds and the feeling of levitation. Supported by a considerable amount of experiment data, they were granted series D funding of level 1-11 by the LSCC Funding Channel.
In the same meeting, Tchangues 1-07 Stable Release was displayed,
which were given rounds of applause in the room for 17.8 seconds. There is no doubt that the display has won was a great success.
It was a pair of artificial lower limbs. Its skin and blood vessels crafted through cell reproduction and monkey brain transplantation, and the bones and muscles made with branches, white crystal powder, woolen threads and golden privets from the southeast of France. It is capable of all kinds of movements including walking, running, jumping, and gymnastics moves. It could even spider-walk on the wall for 120.7 seconds.

Just as its inventor Ms. Perotti said, "Centered on the rationality and efficiency, we learn from human civilization when we harness the unstable, everchanging arcanum technology, so we can provide real, stable help for more people." There is no doubt Tchangues is a good example of LSCC's core philosophy. Yes, this is the Laplace Scientific Computing Center.

I think I am going to enjoy working here.

11:21, 09/19, Mesmer Jr.
Laplace Minute Book M - Volume 01 - Page 01
中文 / CHINESE
本日晨会，卡拉汉议员及其曾孙小卡拉汉博士一同提交了《关于斑马线、柠檬、雪豹纹样与运载及传送神秘学术式》的关联研究报告。
在报告中，他们富有创新性地提及了斑马线与人脑潜意识中的危机、马群以及悬空感的关联性，并提供了数量可观、具有参考价值的实验数据，成功地获得了拉普拉斯科算中心经济通道审批 D 轮 1-11 级实验基金。
同会议，长腿牧者[Tchangues]1-07 完成版进行了展示。
展示完成时，会议室中的掌声持续了 17.8 秒之久，本次的展示无疑获得了……相当的成功。
一款使用细胞再造与猴脑移植技术打造外层皮肤与血管，以木杈、白水晶粉末、羊绒细绳与法国西南部金叶女贞制成骨骼与肌肉的人造下肢，轻松地完成了从行走、奔跑、蹦跳直至高难度体操动作，甚至可以保持 120.7 秒的登壁蛛行。

正如其发明者佩罗蒂女士所说：“以人类文明中的理智高效作为核心，驾驭蕴含着躁动与变化性的神秘学技术，为更多人带来真正稳定的帮助。”长腿牧者之上无疑闪烁着拉普拉斯科算中心最为核心的理念……是的，这就是拉普拉斯科算中心。

我想，我会享受在这里工作的日子。

9 月 19 日 11 时 21 分 小梅斯梅尔 记录
拉普拉斯会议记录专用册：M·册 01-页 01

在城堡之内
In the Castle 4TH-05

In the Castle
在城堡之内

Guest Room, St. Foundation
基金会客房

Guard I: Where on earth do these seeds come from?
守卫 I： 这些种子到底是从哪里来的啊?

Guard I: They are stuck in the crevices. Can't even get them out with the gravity vacuum cleaner. It's like they are rooted, tsk.
守卫 I： 卡在地缝里，用引力源真空洁尘器也吸不出来，就像在土里生了根一样，啧。

Guard II: They weren't here until a few days ago. I heard some of these seeds were also found in the rehab center, but the staff there got rid of them in no time.
守卫 II： 都是这几天出现的，听说康复中心也有这些种子，他们发现得早，清除得也快。

Guard I: Bloody hell, looks like we have to dig them out one by one with our fingers. Gotta get it done before the inspector's here.
守卫 I： 真见鬼。看来只能用手指一个个抠出来了，得在监察员来之前弄干净才行啊。

Sotheby: Seed ... What seed?
苏芙比： 种子……什么种子?

Sotheby: Hmm, let me take a look ...
苏芙比： 嘿，让我看看……

She stands on tiptoe, trying her best to figure out what's happening outside the room through the ground glass.
她踮起脚，试图透过模糊的玻璃看清楚外面的景象。

Sotheby: *sighs* I can't see anything! I'm so bored.
苏芙比： 唉！什么也看不见！好无聊呀～

Sotheby: Do I really have to sign the agreement to get out? But I haven't discussed it with anyone yet.
苏芙比： 难道真的要签了字才能放我出去吗？可是我还没有跟其他人商量过呢。

Sotheby: "A fair lady always thinks it through and reaches an agreement with the adults before she signs any document ..."
苏芙比： “真正的淑女在签自己名字之前，必须深思熟虑，并与大人达成统一的意见……”

Sotheby: Mr. Karson has said that hundreds of times. It must be vital!
苏芙比： 卡森先生把这句话说了好几百遍了，它一定很重要！

Sotheby: ... Mmm.
苏芙比： ……呜。

There comes a disturbance from the other side of the door.
门外传来一阵骚动。

Material Room Staff: Backup, we need backup! Emergency!
材料室职员：请求支援，请求支援！

Material Room Staff: A whole forest appears in room 101, the material area! It's ... It's growing out of Timekeeper's suitcase!
材料室职员：材料区 101 房出现了大片树林，是从……从司辰的箱子里长出来的！

Guard II: What are you talking about?
守卫 II：你在说什么？

Material Room Staff: As I said, it's an emergency. The staff in room 102 and 103 are here to help.
材料室职员：正如我所说的，情况紧急。102 和 103 的人都来帮忙了。

Material Room Staff: A large number of branches came out of the suitcase. They can detect our positions and even attack us on their own!
材料室职员：箱子里伸出了许多树枝，它们不仅能察觉我们的位置，还会主动攻击我们！

Guard I: Did you use Drako Drought?
守卫 I：你们有使用“火龙鳞鳞”吗？

Material Room Staff: Of course not! The room is full of inflammables. The whole floor would be burning now if we did.
材料室职员：当然没有！易燃物品那么多，一旦使用火焰咒语，整层楼都会烧起来的。

Material Room Staff: We used military chainsaws, but it's a drop in the bucket ...
材料室职员：我们用了军用油锯，但效率太低了……

Guard I: Fine. I'll go apply for a few more. Just wait for me there.
守卫 I：行吧，我再去申请几个——你们在那里等我。

Guard I: Agata, go help them out!
守卫 I：阿加塔，你先过去帮忙！

Guard II: Roger that!
守卫 II：收到！

Sotheby: A forest is growing out of Ms. Vertin's suitcase ...
苏芙比：维尔汀小姐的箱子里长出了森林……

Sotheby: Could it be ... Ms. Druvis's great arcane skill?☆
苏芙比：难道是——槲寄生小姐在使用了不起的神秘术吗☆？

Sotheby: The guards are gone ... Ugh, I wish I could see that bizarre scene myself.
苏芙比：门口的守卫都离开了……呜，我也好想亲眼去看看那样的奇观哦。

Click ...
“滋滋——”

Sotheby: Hmm? What's that strange sound?
苏芙比：嗯？什么奇怪的声音？

She lays her eyes on the shut door.
视线落到了紧闭的门上。

The keyhole is rattling.
锁眼在颤动。

Sotheby: Hmm ... Is the door shaking?
苏芙比：唔……门板是在动吗？

The rattle visibly becomes stronger.
颤动愈发剧烈。

Sotheby: No, something ... something is coming in!
苏芙比：不对、这是……这是有什么东西要进来了！

The lock shakes so violently, as if it were wrestling something invisible.
门锁仿佛在与一个看不见的物体殊死搏斗。

Sotheby: ...!
苏芙比：……！！

The newborn vine ruthlessly pierces through the lock, leaving the latter hanging in the air like lifeless grapes.
锁芯被新生的枝条贯穿，无力地悬在空中。

The air smells like fresh plant juice.
空气中弥漫着植物汁液的气味。

Sotheby: Wow ...
苏芙比：哇……

Sotheby: The lock, it's actually broken ...
苏芙比：门锁——竟然被打开了……

Sotheby: Which means I'm free to go? Hooray!!
苏芙比：也就是说我可以出去了？好耶——！！

The door quietly opens, giving a way to the outside world.
门轻快地敞开了一条通道。

The place outside has turned into a vigorous new world.
这里变成了一个生机勃发的新世界。

Sotheby: Wow ...! The seeds on the ground have all sprouted ...
苏芙比：哇……！地上好多种子都发芽了……

Sotheby: What on earth is going on?
苏芙比：这究竟是怎么回事呀?

She is baffled, as she fiddles with the sprouts on the ground.
她困惑地拨弄了几下地面上的新芽。

Sotheby: Hmm, the seeds have the same color as the crevice's. I would have missed them if I didn't look carefully ...
苏芙比：唔，种子的颜色和地缝很接近，不仔细看根本发现不了……

Sotheby: Such a slender branch actually broke the lock. How marvelous! You are Ms. Sotheby's hero!
苏芙比：这么细的枝条，居然戳穿了门锁——真是太厉害了！你就是苏芙比小姐的大救星！

Foundation Staff: Hey! How did you get out?!
基金会职员：喂！你是怎么出来的?!

Sotheby: ...!
苏芙比：……！

She is violently pushed to the ground.
苏芙比被重重地一推。

Sotheby: Ugh ... That hurts!
苏芙比：哇呜……好痛！

Sotheby: How rude you are! My potions are broken!
苏芙比：你怎么这么没有礼貌呀！我的试剂都摔碎了！

Foundation Staff: Did you conjure these plants? Stop them now!
基金会职员：这些植物是你弄出来的？快让它们停下来！

Sotheby: Huh? What are you talking about?
苏芙比：嗯？你在说什么？

She turns around to surprisedly find that the sprouts, soaked in the potion, are visibly getting thicker and stronger.
她一回头，发现被试剂浸过的枝条，正在迅速地变得粗壮。

Sotheby: Oh my ...
苏芙比：啊……

Sotheby: It's my ... Quick Quick Growth Potion for plants!
苏芙比：这是……我的植物嗖嗖生长剂！

Twigs thicken into branches, and more new branches come out from them. And new leaves, new sprouts. They crawl forward, forming a tree fortress around Sotheby.
枝条变成了枝干，从而又生长出更多的枝条，新叶，嫩芽。它们蜿蜒向前，围在苏芙比四周，形成了一座木制的城堡。

Foundation Staff: What do you think you're doing?! Stop them!
基金会职员：你究竟想干什么？快点阻止它们——！

Sotheby: I ...
苏芙比：我——

Sotheby: Hmph, no way!
苏芙比：哼，我才不阻止呢！

Sotheby: Come on! Try and catch me again if you can!
苏芙比：来呀！看你们这次还抓不抓得住我！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

林地特快
The Forest Express 4TH-06

The Forest Express
林地特快

Guest Room, St. Foundation
基金会客房

X: Alright, here are ... 30 cans of Dr. Papper, 20 bags of Happy Wedges, 11 bags of Big Foot Gummy, and a bottle of insect repellent for plants.
X：好，我带来了……三十听胡椒博士、二十包快乐充气薯角、十一包大脚软糖，还有一瓶植物用驱虫剂。

Just as he finishes the sentence, a heavy box falls through the chimney, weightily landing in the fireplace.
话音未落，一个沉重的纸箱就从烟囱里一路落下，坠到壁炉中。

X: Oh, good timing.
X：噢，时机刚好。

X: There may be a bit of ash on them, but the flavor and texture should still be fine.
X：虽然多了一点炉灰，但好在不会影响口感。

Regulus: Ugh ... *coughs*
星锑：呃……咳咳，咳咳咳！

Regulus: The ash is killing me. That's way more than a bit ...
星锑：呛死我了，这哪止是一点炉灰啊……

X: I can't just carry them with me in broad daylight. Do you know how many procedures I have gone through just to pay you a visit?
X：我可不敢正大光明地把它们搬进来～光是申请进来探望你们的手续，就已经花费了我不少功夫了。

X: But how come you are locked in the same room? Since when has the Foundation become so benevolent?
X：不过，你们怎么会被关在同一个房间里？基金会真的开始做慈善了？

APPLe: They would like Captain to guide me to the right path ... to join the Foundation. After all, Captain was already a member of them.
APPLe：他们希望船长能来正确地引导我——加入基金会。毕竟船长已经是基金会的正式成员了。

Regulus: Yep. But I don't feel any difference in the benefits I get! At best, I could contact someone from the outside ... and you're here.
星锑：嗯～但我也没感受到有什么待遇上的区别啊！最多是能联络一下外面的人……所以我就把你给喊过来了。

Regulus: So? Texas Hold'em?
星锑：怎么样？一起来玩德州扑克？

X: ...
X：……

X: That's not what I'm here for.
X：这可不是我过来的目的。

X: I've shown you the "Storm" records these years. So did you find anything?
X：这几年的“暴雨”记录，我给你们看过了。这段时间里，你们有没有什么新的发现？

Regulus: Hmm ...
星锑：嗯……

Regulus: You call it a record, but it's so brief that it only has start time and duration ...
星锑：虽然说是记录，但也就只有开始时间、持续时长这种简单的内容……

Regulus: I can't tell any pattern from that!
星锑：根本看不出有什么特别的规律嘛！

APPLe: This APPLe believes that the "Storm," which happens randomly, does not conform to the self-adjusting nature of the universe.
APPLe：APPLe 某认为，当下这种会随机出现“暴雨”灾害的情况，不符合宇宙自我调优的内在特性。

Regulus: Self-adjusting ... Hmm ...
星锑：自我调优啊……嗯……

Regulus: Oh!
星锑：哦～！

Regulus: Is that the theory you mentioned before? Something like "there should be someone who intervenes or improves the system in order to reduce the growth of the instability of the universe" ...
星锑：是你之前提到过的那个理论吗？什么“应该有至少一个人来干预或改良这个系统，以降低宇宙不稳定性的增长”……

Regulus: For example, if the universe is a mooring rope ... no, a bunch of ropes ... there has to be a sailor who pulls the ropes to keep them in order or something.
星锑：假如说，宇宙是一根缆绳，不，是一大堆缆绳，那就必须得有一个拉拽缆绳的水手来维护它们之类的。

X: Sounds like the cosmology from centuries ago ...
X：听起来像是几个世纪前的宇宙观……

He doesn't seem keen on the theory, nor does he repel it; he just quickly spins on his heels without saying a word.
他不置可否，原地转了一圈。

X: But your metaphor reminds me of Madam Z's research on string theory.
X：不过，缆绳的比喻让我想起了 Z 女士的弦理论研究学说。

X: She advocates that the energy string is the most basic unit of the universe.
X：她主张能量弦线是构成宇宙的最小基本单位。

Regulus: Are you talking about Vertin's boss?
星锑：你说的是维尔汀的老板吗?

X: Boss?
X：老板?

X: Well, if that's your definition of immediate supervisor, then yes.
X：如果你是这么理解直属上司的话——是的。

X: Madam Z was a scientist who studied in Britain before she joined the Foundation.
X：Z 女士在加入基金会之前，也是一位留学英国的科学家。

Regulus: Ooh. Bread and honey are the staff of life. That makes sense.
星锑：——哦哦，为面包折腰啊，可以理解。

X: Well, it's not a good choice for most scientists.
X：呵呵，对于大部分科学家来说，这都不是一条理想的道路。

X: Recently she has been promoted from the chief of the vice president's staff to a formal member of the Committee. I guess she will spend even less time in the lab ...
X：她最近也从副会长的幕僚长升任为正式委员了。现在应该更难有时间来实验室了吧……

A sudden, violent bump comes from outside the door.
门外突然出现猛烈的撞击声。

APPLe: Uhhh ...!
APPLe：呃唔……!

APPLe: The whole building shakes. Did something hit it?
APPLe：整栋楼都震了一下，是有什么东西撞上来了吗?

X: Let me see.
X：我来看看。

Looking out of the window, they see a giant oak, cut down from its bottom, leaning on the hallway of the second floor.
透过窗户向外望去，一棵巨大的橡树被连根锯断，它的上半部分坠落在这层楼的走廊上。

Among its ever-growing branches stands a familiar figure in a black dress. A young teenager with a hat, waggling and swaying on a branch, follows her.
不断向上延伸的枝干上，站着一位身着漆色长裙的熟悉身影。她的身后，是一位摇摇晃晃的戴帽子的孩子。

Summoned by a peculiar chanting, more and more trees grow up from the ground, stretch, and spread in mid-air.
伴着奇异的吟唱声，还有更多的翠色树木拔地而起。

X: Is that Druvis? And ... Sotheby?
X: 那是槲寄生？还有……苏芙比？

X: ...
X: ——

He turns around, looking serious.
他倏地转过身来，一脸严肃。

X: What's this? Guys ...
X: 这是什么？你们……

X: I am not gonna be dragged into a riot at this point.
X: 我可不打算在这个时候卷入到一场暴乱中。

Regulus: Ah ... Is that Druvis? What happened to her?
星锑: 啊……那是槲寄生？她怎么变成那个样子了？

Regulus: ... Her new hairstyle is sort of cool.
星锑: ——新发型有点酷哦。

APPLe: Captain, that's not the point.
APPLe: 船长，那不是重点。

X: Agreed, not the point at all. I gotta go. If you want me to take part in such an event, my name should never be in the visitor log.
X: 是的，那不是重点。我得走了，如果想让我参加这种活动，就不应该让我的名字出现在探访记录中。

X: Looks like the whole building will be your battlefield ...
X: 看样子这栋楼都会成为你们的战场……

X: Alright, good luck.
X: 那么，祝你们好运。

Regulus: Wait a minute!
星锑: 等一下！先别走——

Regulus: If we join Druvis ... what would happen?
星锑: 如果我们也和槲寄生一起抗议……会发生什么？

X: ...
X: ……

X: What would happen? I'm not a prophet.
X: 会发生什么？我可不是预言家。

X: But this is gonna be the best spot for protest.
X: 不过，这将是一个绝佳的抗议地点。

X: This building is the furthest one from the center of the Foundation. On the first and second floors are material rooms and research offices. Few staff stay here.
X: 这是距离基金会中心最远的一栋楼。一、二楼是材料室和研究办公区域，都是功能区。平时的常驻职员也很少。

X: The room next to yours is the projection lab.
X: 而你们隔壁的房间是投影实验室。

X: It was used to control the slides projected in the lobby. That screen is gone now, but the transfer devices and circuits are still there.
X: 很久以前它被用来切换基金会大堂的投影公告。现在大堂的那块屏幕已经被撤掉了，但投影中转器与线路还保留着。

X: You know what? If you're going to protest ... make it loud.
X: 要我说，如果你们要抗议……那就喊得大声点。

X: It's been a long time since the Foundation had something this much fun.
X: 基金会可是好久没有这样的好戏上演了。

He pulls out the one sleeve in Regulus's grip and quickly exits the room.
他松开被星锑抓住的衣袖，迅速离开了房间。

Sotheby: Ms. Druvis, is Vertin having a fight with the Foundation?
苏芙比: 槲寄生小姐，维尔汀是和基金会吵架了吗?

Druvis Ⅲ: ... Yes.
槲寄生: ……是的。

Druvis Ⅲ: We have a disagreement with the Foundation, Ms. Sotheby.
槲寄生: 我们与基金会出现了分歧，苏芙比小姐。

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin is seeking a limited freedom for us. Her aspiration is to restore the peaceful life before the "Storm."
槲寄生: 维尔汀在为我们寻求一种有限的自由，一份复原“暴雨”前宁静生活的夙愿。

Druvis Ⅲ: For the authorities, however, her aspiration and ambition are labeled as deviation and rebellion.
槲寄生: 但高台之上，恣意与愿景，被视为叛道而离经。

Druvis Ⅲ: We are thus tempted, alienated, and arrested unjustly.
槲寄生: 我们因而遭受了利诱，离间与不义的拘禁。

Sotheby: That's why we've been grounded all these days ...
苏芙比: 所以我们才会被关了那么久的禁闭……

Sotheby: So we're helping Vertin now, is that right, Ms. Druvis?
苏芙比: 槲寄生小姐，我们现在是在帮助维尔汀，对吗?

Sotheby: I really feel like doing something for her ...! Just like what I'm doing right now, standing brave on the tree!
苏芙比: 我很想为此做点什么……！就像现在这样，勇敢地站在树上!

Druvis Ⅲ: Right. On the tree.
槲寄生: 是的，站在树上。

Druvis Ⅲ: We need to move forward, to move one step further.
槲寄生: 我们应当向前一步，更进一步。

Druvis Ⅲ: When we meet up with Regulus and APPLe, our voices will be stronger, and more and more people will offer their help.
槲寄生: 待与星锑和 APPLe 会合，形成更浩大的声浪，将有愈来愈多的人帮助我们。

Druvis Ⅲ: I believe that when the day comes, we will be able to shake up the balance in the Foundation and tilt it to our side.
槲寄生: 我深信那一日的到来，将能撼动基金会的天平，造就属于我们的时势。

Sotheby: Shake up the balance ... Wow ...
苏芙比: 撼动天平……哇……

Sotheby: Maybe Vertin will come back herself by then!
苏芙比：也许等到那一天，维尔汀就会自己回来了！

Sotheby: I got it! Now my goal is to make more potions, so the trees can grow larger and larger, make them super large!
苏芙比：我明白啦！那我现在的目标就是调配药剂，让树木变大，变大，变得无限大！

Druvis Ⅲ: This is going to be a protracted war of resistance.
槲寄生：这将是一场持久的抗争之战。

Druvis Ⅲ: After we rescue Regulus, please maintain our territory of the woods with the rest of your potions, Ms. Sotheby.
槲寄生：等我们救出星锑，剩下的药剂就用来维持森林的领地吧，苏芙比小姐。

Sotheby: Sure! I will economize on them!
苏芙比：嗯！我会节约点用的！

Sotheby: Look, X is coming out of the room!
苏芙比：呀，快看，X 从房间里出来了！

Druvis Ⅲ: He left. It seems he has made his choice.
槲寄生：他离开了。看来他已经做出了选择。

Sotheby: Not helping us or them ... Well, at least no one is getting hurt from the boiling pot this time.
苏芙比：既不帮助我们，也不帮助他们……嗯，至少，这次不会再有人受到茶壶的伤害了。

Sotheby: Let me see. Hmm, there are more guards at the door now! It seems everyone's there!
苏芙比：让我瞧瞧，唔，门口的守卫变多了！好像是所有人都聚集在那里了——！

Druvis Ⅲ: Perhaps they have guessed our next move ... Regulus.
槲寄生：也许是猜到了我们的下一个目标——营救星锑。

Druvis Ⅲ: Let's go. It's time to meet up with our companions.
槲寄生：走吧，该与同伴们见面了。

Sotheby: Go, go! Regulus must be bored to death just as I was!
苏芙比：出发～！出发～！星锑肯定像我一样，都闷得两眼昏花啦！

Druvis raises her wand.
槲寄生悬起她的术杖。

As the chant goes on, her hair has become increasingly glistening gold.
在吟唱声中，她的发色愈发金红。

The oaks march on like waves. Their bud scales keep growing, extending, chasing, and overlapping each other, and their crowns shoot forward like missiles.
橡树在起伏中行进，芽鳞层叠生长，叶冠如同炮弹一样涌向前方。

Guard II: Watch out! Incoming!
守卫 Ⅱ：小心——！她们过来了！

Guard I: Everyone, get ready to engage!
守卫 Ⅰ：全员做好战斗准备！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

投影中转器
Projector Relay Controller 小径

To Lawrence Cavendish
致劳伦斯·卡文迪许

海盗宣言
The Pirate's Declaration 4TH-07

The Pirate's Declaration
海盗宣言

Lobby, St. Foundation
基金会大堂

The receptionist is confirming the name list just submitted by the House of Integratus.
接待员在确认共融院新提交上来的名单。

The vice president is coming her way. It's rare to see her picking up the files herself.
副会长正向此处走来。她很少亲自来取文件。

But as the daily agenda tracker shows, the chance of the vice president asking for this name list is 85%.
但事程追踪器提示，副会长将有 85% 的概率需要这份名单。

Constantine: Do we have the candidates' name list? Show it to me.
康斯坦丁：代表人候选名单出来了吗？给我看看。

Clerk: Yes, please wait a minute. It'll be prepared right away.
接待员：好的，请您稍等。马上就好。

That's right. Thanks to the invention designed by Laplace Scientific Computing Center, everything here is highly controllable, efficient, and has logic within.
是的。感谢拉普拉斯科算中心的发明，让一切都如此可控，高效，有逻辑。

The fingers of the receptionist lightly percuss the keyboard. She will be able to locate the files faster than ever.
接待员的手灵活地在键盘上敲击，她将比以往更快地找到文件。

Suddenly, she freezes.
突然，她定住了。

Clerk: Um, why is the light on?
接待员：呃，这个灯怎么亮起来了……

With a horrible prediction in her mind, she hesitantly turns to the wall with an open mouth and round eyes.
她几乎是迟疑地，目瞪口呆地转过身去。

"Buzzz ..."
“哔滋滋——”

A gigantic projection appears on the wall.
墙壁上出现了巨幕投影。

An apple shows up in the blurry projection. Under such a poor resolution, it looks like a massive red alert.
粗糙的光将苹果投在墙壁上，如同一个硕大的红色警告符。

A sentence in a crooked font emerges beneath that giant pixel apple .
歪歪扭扭的英文小字显现在苹果下方。

The words are glaring, "THIS IS WAR!"
内容则相当刺眼：“宣战！”

Regulus: Warning, warning! Everybody, listen up. We have taken over the Foundation!
星锑： 警告，警告！全员都有，给我听好了，基金会已经被我们占领！

Regulus: Our demands are: release us, set Vertin free!
星锑： 我们的谈判条件是，解除监禁，释放维尔汀！

Regulus: You have three days. After that, we are ...
星锑： 限你们在三日内放人，否则——

The receptionist cuts off the power, terrified.
接待员一脸惊恐地切断了电源。

The lobby, which sees people striding in and stalking off all the time, now freezes in dead silence.
人来人往的走廊一时变得分外安静。

Clerk: Madam ... I ...
接待员： 副、副——副会长……我……

Clerk: I didn't ... I ...
接待员： 这个不是——我——

Clerk: ...
接待员： ……

Constantine: What's the matter? Something wrong with the printer?
康斯坦丁： 怎么了，打印机出问题了吗?

Clerk: No, no ... Oh right, the candidate name list ... Here you are.
接待员： 没有。没有……哦，对，代表人候选名单……在这里。

She passed on the name list with a pale face.
她面色苍白地递上名单。

Constantine: Thank you, this is exactly what I need.
康斯坦丁： 谢谢，我正需要这个。

Constantine casts a quick look at the wall.
康斯坦丁抬头望了一眼墙壁。

The source of the disturbance has gone.
骚动的影像已经消失了。

Constantine: Sorry for the scene.
康斯坦丁： 让你见笑了。

Constantine: Like others here, they also have the right to make their voices heard. It is the essential step for us to come to an agreement.
康斯坦丁： 他们也有发声的权利，这正是双方达成共识的必经之路。

Constantine: We will take care of this, don't worry.
康斯坦丁： 我们会解决这个问题的，别担心。

She smiles. As she does so, the people around her are visibly relieved and stored to life.
她笑了笑。四周的人又恢复了生气。

Constantine: However ... perhaps we should stop using the old projector. It may lead to accidents, don't you think?
康斯坦丁：不过……年久失修的投影设备还是不要用了，总是容易出现意外事故，不是吗?

Clerk: Understood! I'll remove the transfer devices now ...
接待员：明白！我现在就撤掉这些中转器……

She jumps up on her feet and salutes her.
她几乎是跳着站起来敬了个礼。

Constantine turns around and leaves.
康斯坦丁转身离开了。

Regulus: Oh bloody hell! How dare they cut off the power ...
星锑：气死我了！气死我了！他们竟然切断了我的电源——

Regulus: This Pirate has so much left to declare!
星锑：本海盗还有好多宣言没有发表呢！

Regulus: Wimps! Cowards! Hypocrites!
星锑：懦夫！胆小鬼！伪君子！

Sotheby: Hear, hear! I can't agree more. It is very rude to hang up before others finish their words!
苏芙比：嗯嗯，我很赞同。而且，不听别人说完话就挂掉电话，也是非常不合礼节的做法！

APPLe: This is not telephone, Ms. Sotheby.
APPLe：苏芙比小姐，这个不是电话。

APPLe: But of course, that's not the point.
APPLe：当然，这不重要。

APPLe: No matter what, we've communicated to them the most crucial requirement for negotiation.
APPLe：不论如何，我们都将最关键的谈判条件传达给他们了。

APPLe: I'm sure they will respond to us properly.
APPLe：相信他们会给我们应有的回应的。

Regulus: Humph ... I just wanna take the chance to show our attitude ...
星锑：哼……我只是想把握住这个表达态度的机会……

Regulus: Taking over the radio station at the headquarters of the Foundation ... It's a gas in the late hundreds of years ...
星锑：入侵基金会总部的公共广播，这可是几百年才能等到的大乐子……

Regulus: *sighs* It would've been perfect if we could have another You Can't Win to close it out.
星锑：唉，要是能再来首《You Can't Win》收尾就更完美了。

APPLe: We could look around here to see if there's other broadcasting equipment.
APPLe：我们可以在这附近再找找看，也许能找到其他的广播设备。

APPLe: However, this APPLe does not recommend frequent provocation.
APPLe：不过，APPLe 某不推荐频繁挑衅基金会的行为。

APPLe: Right now it's more important to patrol the surroundings in case we are ambushed by the guards.
APPLe：眼下更重要的是巡视周围的环境，以防遭到守卫的埋伏。

APPLe: Ms. Druvis is forming abatis alone downstairs. Perhaps she needs our help.
APPLe：槲寄生小姐正独自一人在楼下设置鹿砦障碍，说不定她也需要我们的帮忙。

Regulus: Mmm ... Fine, you have a point.
星锑：嗯……好吧，你说的有道理。

Regulus: This Pirate ... has decided to put off the plan to liberate the Foundation!
星锑：本海盗……就暂时推迟解放基金会的计划了！

Almost reluctantly, she forces herself to stop looking at the radio.
她依依不舍地从收音设备上收回目光。

Regulus: Besides forming abatis, what else do we need to do?
星锑：除了放置鹿砦，我们还有什么事情要做吗?

APPLe: There's much to be done, Captain.
APPLe：还有许多事情要处理，船长。

APPLe: Find water sources. Transfer essential equipment. Reserve enough food. Set up multiple defenses in the woods.
APPLe：确认水源，转移必要设备，储备足够的粮食，设置森林的多重防线。

APPLe: And arrange a duty schedule. Make sure someone is garrisoned outside the suitcase, while others are resting inside.
APPLe：还需要安排值日日程，确保大家在箱子里休憩时，能有人在箱子外驻守。

Sotheby: Well, I have the tomato and potato seeds from Ms. Druvis. We must plant them in the suitcase to guarantee food supply!
苏芙比：嗯，我这里还有槲寄生小姐送的西红柿和土豆的种子，我们得在箱子里种起来，才能保证一直有东西吃哦～！

Regulus: Um ... Tomato and potato ...
星锑：唔……西红柿，土豆……

Regulus: All vegetables, no meat ... they're meant for the piggies that grow my bacon.
星锑：都是在胃里荡不起一丁点油花的东西啊。

Regulus: When I was wandering the seas, at least I could have a grilled sea bass every day ...
星锑：以前在海上流浪的时候，每天至少还能吃上一条烤海鲈鱼呢……

Regulus: *sighs* I wonder what Vertin eats in rehab ... Will she be hungry ...
星锑：哎，不知道维尔汀在病房里吃的是什么……会不会肚子饿……

"Grrrr ..."
“咕……”

Regulus: Oooh! Almost forgot about the goodies X sent!
星锑：哦！差点忘了 X 送的一箱好东西！

Regulus: We'll definitely hang in there for a few more days with them!
星锑：有那堆玩意儿，我们肯定能多撑几天！

Regulus: Sotheby, Mr. APPLe, you go downstairs first. I'll meet up with you once I bring the box down there!
星锑：苏芙比，APPLe 先生，你们先下楼吧，等我把纸箱搬下去，就跟你们会合！

Sotheby: Alright! We will meet you at the entrance. Stay safe!
苏芙比：好的呀！我们就在入口那里等你，要注意安全哦！

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 遗落的评分表

Trail ① A Rating Sheet Left Behind 小径

Snacks of the New Era and the Rockin' Pirate
新时代零嘴儿与摇滚海盗

英文 / ENGLISH

○ Rigabit: Yogurt Bullets
Pink yogurt from Michigan which pops out like a bullet.
"Not so good as I thought it would be, but does feel novel ...
Hmm, well, mmm ... 5.6 out of 10."

○ K&K: Oatmeal Breakfast Bars
Actually a candy bar with little oatmeal.
"Not bad, I'll give it an 8."

○ Kjeldson!!! Logger Cookies!!!
Known for the rich butter within, it has a rough flavor of the logger style which is exactly the opposite of the royal style.
"What does logger style mean, dry as sawdust?!
I will put in on the Prohibited List of my ship and it's never getting removed! 1 out of 10!"

○Pota-ta-tato: Face Chips
There are all kinds of facial expressions. I may look the same when deep fried.
"Too many crumbs. Can't taste the flavor of potato. BARBECUE WITH MUSTARD FLAVORED ...
Well, acceptable. 4.5 out of 10."

○ Cheetahs Cheetahs! Amazing Seeds!
Puffed snack. CHEESE SURINAME TOAD JAM FLAVORED.
"When your product is buried in soil but can't grow into anything after 3 days of watering, 24 times in total by the way, you'd better not put the word 'Seed' in its name! 0!
CHECK, OUT, THIS, BIG, ZERO!"

中文 / CHINESE

◎ 利佳比特：子弹酸奶
可以弹射而出的粉色酸奶，来自密歇根州。
没我想的那么好吃，但的确很新鲜……
嗯——嗯、嗯……5.6 分。

◎ K&K：早餐燕麦棒
实实在在的一根糖果。燕麦含量微乎其微。
好吃，8 分。

◎ 红管曲奇！！！伐木工曲奇！！！
以厚重的黄油闻名，与皇家风格截然相反的粗暴伐木工风味。
伐木工风味是指口感干燥如同木渣吗?
我会把它永远地写上禁止登船名单！1 分！

◎ 薯连连·脸状薯片
表情丰富。如果我被油炸，或许也会如此。
碎屑太多，缺少土豆本身的风味，烧烤芥末味儿……
还算可以接受。4.5 分。

◎ 奇滴奇滴！奇妙的种子！

膨化食品，起司负子蟾果酱口味。

如果你的产品被埋进泥土，连续浇水三天 24 次却不能长出一点嫩苗，你最好不要为它起名“种子”！0 分！

——看看，这个，0！

圆桌的两侧
Both Sides of the Table 4TH-08

Both Sides of the Table
圆桌的两侧

The meeting room
基金会委员会会议室

Committee Member I: There is no need to hold an emergency meeting for this.
委员 I： 这种事没有开紧急会议的必要。

Committee Member I: Such "declaration of war" without tactic or plan B is typical example of arcanist behavior.
委员 I： 缺乏战略的，孤注一掷的“宣战”，符合神秘学家一贯的行为模式。

Committee Member I: The area they controlled has no value at all, no matter in terms of the size or the influence.
委员 I： 他们所占据的区域，不论是范围大小还是影响力都不值一提。

Committee Member II: Well, the administration department has not taken official actions yet.
委员 II： 嗯，行政部门目前还没有正式行动。

Committee Member II: I heard the plan was to dispatch a team to escort them to the School of Discipline.
委员 II： 听说部门计划派出一支队伍将他们送到教管学校。

Committee Member I: Problem solved then.
委员 I： 那这件事情解决了。

The books of case files are closed. As the chairs squeakily scratch the floor, the attendants of the meeting stand up.
摊开的卷宗被合上，椅子向后挪动，人们站起身来。

Z: Next time, if Vertin brings back more unregistered arcanists ...
Z: 如果下次维尔汀又带回一批新的非登记神秘学家。

Z: Will the same thing happen again?
Z: ——这一次的事件还会重演吗?

Madam Z stands still where she was.
Z 女士还站在原地。

The committee member stops by the door, and slowly turns back to her.
停在门口的委员慢慢地转过身来。

Committee Member I: I don't understand.
委员 I： 我不理解。

Committee Member I: It's not a shame to join the Foundation, is it?
委员 I： 加入基金会，难道是一件让人颜面扫地的事情吗?

Committee Member I: By signing the agreement, arcanists will enjoy the right to use arcane skills in human society and be bestowed great honor.
委员 I： 签订协议的神秘学家，不仅拥有在社会上使用神秘术的权利，还将被赐予莫大的荣耀。

Committee Member I: The human resource department could have used a whole floor to hold the applications a dozen years ago!
委员 I： 就在十几年前，神秘学家的应聘申请书多到人事部门用一层楼都装不完。

Committee Member I: Not even the New Age Movement could challenge the Foundation's authority in the international community!
委员 I： 就算是新纪元运动也无法冲击基金会在国际社会上的权威！

Committee Member I: And these shortsighted exceptions ... They aren't even worth being made a topic for the meeting.
委员 I： 而眼前这些目光短浅的神秘学家个例——甚至不值得成为一个会议的议题。

Z: Yet ...
Z: 但是……

Z: They're not here for the St. Pavlov Foundation.
Z: 他们并不是冲着圣洛夫基金会的名号来的。

Z: They're here for Vertin. They choose to follow her out of their own will, because of their admiration for her.
Z: 他们选择跟随维尔汀，是出于自身意愿及对维尔汀个人的信服。

Z: That is the essential difference between them and our former recruits.
Z: 这与我们以往招募的职员有着根本的不同。

Committee Member II: You mean ... it's not important at all for them to join the Foundation.
委员 II： 你的意思是……是否加入基金会，对他们来说根本无关紧要。

Z: I'm afraid so.
Z: 恐怕是的。

Z: But we can't expel them.
Z: 但我们并不能将他们驱逐出去。

Z: We both know that the Foundation now requires new members to form a stronger force.
Z: 我们都很清楚，现在的基金会亟需新成员的加入，以构建更强大的势力。

Committee Member I: What are you trying to say, Ms. Z? Skip to the point.
委员 I： 你想表达什么，直接说吧，Z 女士。

She returns to her seat, sits down, and opens the folder again.
Z 女士重新回到座位上，打开了手头的文件夹。

Z: Today, the House of Integratus has resubmitted the revised draft of *Storm Reformation: Manpower and Discipline*.
Z: 今天共融院再次提交了这份《暴雨改革：增员与秩序》的修订草案。

Z: I think it's time to decide if this draft can be adopted and then start the debate.
Z: 我认为现在有必要讨论是否通过这项草案，使其进入到立法辩论阶段。

Committee Member II: You're asking for troubles, madam ...
委员 II： 这是在自寻烦恼，女士……

Z: Please turn to page 21, section 3.
Z: 请看第二十一页第三节。

Z: "External personnel recruited by the Timekeeper should be placed within the Timekeeper's department."
Z: “由司辰招募来的外界人员，归入司辰编制内。”

Z: "The Timekeeper has the duties of education and discipline to them and should be responsible for their follow-up behaviors."
Z: “司辰提供统一的教管及控制，并对他们的后续行为负责。”

Z: "Personnel within the Timekeeper's department, subject to the Foundation's Staff Code, will take orders from the Timekeeper and are not required to take direct orders from the Foundation."
Z: “司辰编制内人员，在遵守《基金会员工守则》前提下，对司辰的命令负责，无需直接听命于基金会。”

Z: This section allows those unregistered arcanists to have more autonomy and develop a stronger sense of identity as a part of the Foundation.
Z: 这将给予非登记神秘学家更高的自主权，提高他们对基金会的认同。

Z: Meanwhile, by giving orders to the Timekeeper, the Foundation still has the military right to deploy them.
Z: 同样，通过司辰，基金会仍然拥有调动和部署这些人士的军事权利。

Z: It can solve the current problem.
Z: 这一节回答了我们现在面临的难题。

Committee Member I: Which means we'll be working with some uncontrollable mercenaries.
委员 I： 换句话说，就是把他们变成基金会的十八线合作雇佣兵。

Z: I'll say it's the reserve service for wartime.
Z: 我认为是紧急战时的预备役。

Committee Member I: It's not going to work. What happened when the arcanists were not under control?
委员 I： 这行不通。放开对神秘学家的管控会带来什么？

Committee Member I: Massacres, tyranny, endless revenge ... History is nothing but a sewer to them, where they vent their excessive energy and deceive those in power with a speech of ignorance.
委员 I： 屠杀、暴政、无止尽的复仇……他们一向把历史当成排泄激情的粪坑，任由狂瞽之言在王座上肆虐。

Committee Member I: The reality has proven that.
委员 I： 现实已经说明了一切。

Committee Member II: Exactly. What's more, there has never been a reform as such in the history of the Foundation.
委员 II： 正是如此。更何况，这种改革在基金会上从未有过先例。

Committee Member II: During the unexpected "Storm," reforming in a rush will only increase the ri- ...
委员 II： 在当下“暴雨”突发的环境下，贸然改革只会增加风——

Constantine: Sorry for being late.
康斯坦丁： 抱歉，我来迟了。

Constantine strides into the meeting room, throwing her folder on the table.
康斯坦丁大步迈进会议室，将文件夹扔到桌上。

Constantine: Quite a heated discussion.
康斯坦丁： 讨论得很热烈啊。

Constantine: I can see you all have a great interest in this draft proposal.
康斯坦丁： 看来大家对这个草案相当感兴趣。

Constantine: Hope I didn't miss too much.
康斯坦丁：希望我现在加入还不算太晚。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 执著的访客
Trail ① A Determined Visitor 小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum
投机倒把和烂糖果

乘坐平底雪橇
A Ride on the Toboggan 小径

Sounds of different colors go into your left ear and slip out from your nostrils, just like a toboggan sliding down a soft piste from a cabin up the mountain to the finishing line at the foot, leaving nothing but excitement that doesn't even last.
???: 不同色彩的声音从你的左耳进入，又从鼻孔里滑出来，就像雪橇从高山小屋中出发，坠到滑道松软的终点线上，除了一时的兴奋什么也没留下。

选项 / Choices

1. Your opening line sucks.
1. 你的搭讪方式逊爆了

2. So, a vacation? I'm ready.
2. 要去度假？很好，我做好准备了

分支 1 / Branch 1

Errr ...
???: ——呃。

What did you say? I, I got bad signal here, oh, ba-bad signal indeed.
???: 在说什么？信号不好，噢，是的。

I mean, I may be different from all of you, but I have a conscience, OK? I never talk s**t, that's the bottom line. What I said were all felicitous hints.
???: 我是说，虽然我与你们都不一样，但我也有良心，好吗？我的原则是不讲废话，这些都是恰到好处的暗示。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Yes. You're always so clever, with an excellent sense of humor! Now take all the cold-proof equipment you've got. The view is good here, but it's still dangerous as you are climbing a snow mountain after all.
???: 没错，你总是这么机灵，充满绝佳的幽默感！带上你所有的防寒装备，这里风景优美，但仍是块要和冰山打交道的危险地方。

I'm sure you have noticed it. Between the glacier and the valley, between the snow mountain and the lake, stands a great building we're all familiar with.
???: 相信你也注意到了，在这冰川与峡谷，雪峰与湖泊之间，屹立着我们熟悉的伟大建筑。

Close your eyes and feel the patterns of interlaced gray and white. The flow of the building, so balanced and symmetrical, is like a sophisticated symphony with beautiful melody.
???: 闭上眼睛，感受那些灰色与白色交错的花纹，建筑的节奏，如此的均衡，对称，像一首洋溢着律动的精密交响乐。

That may be your first impression of the Foundation. After that committee meeting, however, all I could see on your face was a terrible mess, like it was licked by a terrier which has just finished hunting.
???: 这或许是你对基金会的初步印象。然而，经过一场委员会议，我看到你的面容就像被狩猎后的梗犬狠狠舔过，剩下的只有一片糟糕的混乱。

What the f**k are they talking about? Who can explain their relations for me?
???: 他们**的到底在说什么？谁能来解释一下他们的关系？

Good question! In this lonely, whirling, dark universe, I'm the only one who is willing to tell you all these stories on the cold bench in the park.
???: 好问题！在这个寂寞的旋转着的漆黑宇宙里，只有我愿意出现在公园里的冷板凳上，告诉你这些前前后后的故事。

选项 / Choices

1. So what functions does the Foundation have?
1. 基金会都有哪些职能?

2. Who is the boss of the Foundation?
2. 谁才是基金会的老大?

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

Countless! Oh man, you gotta understand, an international political institution with great ambition is bound to make troubles and make up for them.
???: 多得数不清！好家伙，你得理解，一个野心勃勃的国际政治机构，就难免不在捅娄子和擦屁股之间来回跳跃。

The House of Integratus and the committee are in charge of lawmaking, not just in the Foundation, but in countries and even in the global society! Any affairs related to the human-arcanist relationship will be brought to their table, and they will handle each of the affairs with their properly manicured but muscle-torn hands.
???: 共融院与委员会，他们主管着立法，不止是基金会内部的，还有国家的，甚至是国际的！但凡与人类和神秘学家的关系有关联的，都得经过他们患有腱鞘炎的体面的手。

Through the folds in their brains, people set this reasonable rule: delegates of the House of the Integratus are elected to take responsibility for their constituencies. As busy as bees, they submit countless proposals to the committee every year.
???: 人类弯弯曲曲的脑沟建立了这样合理的规则：位于共融院的代表人自竞选中诞生，为他的选区负责。他们往往忙碌得像辛勤的工蜂，每年向委员会提交大量的议案。

Then the committee will choose one lucky proposal and send it to the next step: all the committee members would gather to debate and vote for the proposal, like what happened in a Medieval Fair.
???: 委员会则要选中一个幸运儿，把它推进到下一个流程，开始一场中世纪集会般热闹的辩论投票。

Many would show up in the fair. There would be political parties, a moderator, dozens of expert groups, each with a different standpoint and goal. It's like a mental boxing, modern version! We will have to wait while listening to the war of words. After dozens of days, or even months, we will finally get to see who wins the championship belt.
???: 集会里聚集了许多人，党团，主持人，数十个专家小组，每个人的立场和利益各异，就像一场颇具现代精神的精神搏击！我们将在唇枪舌战中等待十几天，或者好几个月，才能睁大眼睛看清楚是谁拿到了金腰带。

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

You haven't met him yet. Actually, only a few have, as the opportunities are always fleeting like the falling stars.
???: 你还没有见过他。事实上，大部分人都没有，因为机会总像流星一样稍纵即逝。

But it's okay. The Foundation still works well without him! Our responsible Constantine, working without any complaint like an unbreakable lily, is trying hard to change the Foundation's direction to what she believes to be correct.
???: 但没有关系，少了他，基金会照样能流畅地运转！任劳任怨的康斯坦丁，那朵严酷的白百合，正尽职地把基金会往自己所以为正确的方向上掰呢。

Come on, let's look at the bigger picture. Humans have worked out with the brilliant folds in their brains that they need multiple parties to create a balance of power. So, bang! There come the committee, the House of the Integratus, and many other administration departments.
???: 来吧，让我们把眼光放长远点儿。人类聪慧的大脑皮质表明，他们需要一些看起来相互制衡的关系。委员会、共融院和多个行政部门就这样诞生了。

The House of Integratus and the committee are in charge of lawmaking, not just in the Foundation, but in countries and even in the global society! Any affairs related to the human-arcanist relationship will be brought to their table, and they will handle each of the affairs with their properly manicured but muscle-torn hands.
???: 共融院与委员会，他们主管着立法，不止是基金会内部的，还有国家的，甚至是国际的！但凡与人类和神秘学家的关系有关联的，都得经过他们患有腱鞘炎的体面的手。

The committee has the right to approve or reject the proposals from delegates. Well, of course, some of the delegates are very stubborn. They will keep submitting their proposals no matter how many times they have been rejected, just like a red-back shrike with fledglings repeatedly submitting rejected motions until they are exhausted.
???: 委员会有权通过或拒绝代表人的议案。偶尔也有死脑筋的代表人，像只护雏的红背伯劳反复地提交被拒的议案，直到筋疲力尽。

When it comes to the formal debate, you will get to watch a dogfight full of polite yet viciously aggressive language. Everyone, including the president, the delegates, the parties and the expert groups, will turn into maniacs in the arena of power.
???: 等进入到正式的立法辩论阶段，你就能观赏到一场饱含现代文明精华的斗兽表演，所有的主席、代表人、党团、专家小组都是权力竞技场里的狂热分子。

After this stage, the final result depends on the white marble house. They seldom express their opinions, but they will sometimes.
???: 通过了这一关，剩下的就交给那座白色石屋了。他们很少表达自己的意见，很少，但不是没有。

选项 / Choices

1. Are there more?
1. 还有其他的吗?

Oh, yes, yes. Look how polite you are when you ask that question, like I'm some high school student working part-time in a mall selling local socks to you.
???: 噢，是的是的。你询问的模样是多么的礼貌，好像在问一个大卖场里向你兜售本地棉袜的兼职高中生。

And I'd be very nice and tell you, "Of course!" We must not ignore the other administration departments of the Foundation, as well as the headquarters' poor branches located in different countries and the humanitarian School of Primary Defense of Mankind that works like a poorhouse.
???: 我会很好心地告诉你，当然还有其他的了！我们不能忽视基金会其他的行政部门，还有那倒霉的总部下属的各国分部，充满关怀的救济院般的第一防线学校。

Remember, the Foundation is managing the whole world! Of course, they need some rules that are hard to understand, so the wise will be wiser and the silly will be sillier, while those in the middle will show an innocent smile when they die!
???: 要知道，基金会可是在管理世界！他们当然得弄出一点儿弯弯绕的规则出来，好让聪明的人更聪明，糊涂的人更糊涂，大部分生活在中间的人呢，死去的时候能带着无辜的笑意！

Humans are experts on these things. My stupid arcanists, don't just complain; learn to see what they are after, okay? Catch the unspoken drifts between the lines! So one day you will understand ...
???: 人类最擅长折腾这些玩意儿。愚笨的神秘学家不能只知道抱怨，要去领悟，洞见他们的企图——知道吗？去感受规则里溢出来的脑浆！这样你总有一天就会明白……

Life is like a ride on the toboggan.
???: ——生活就像乘坐平底雪橇。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

共同接续 / Shared continuation

A Ride on the Toboggan
乘坐平底雪橇

踟蹰之犬
A Wandering Dog 4TH-09

A Wandering Dog
踟蹰之犬

Committee Member I: We are on page 21, section 3.
委员 I： 我们正在讨论第二十一页第三节。

Committee Member I: Ms. Z insists on adopting this draft.
委员 I： Z 女士坚持认为该草案有推行下去的必要。

Committee Member I: Ms. Z, please walk Madam Constantine through this section.
委员 I： Z 女士，你跟副会长说明一下这节的内容。

Constantine: No need for that. I have read the stenographer's report.
康斯坦丁： 不用，我已经在速记员那里看过了。

Constantine: In fact, this is the second time I'm addressing this proposal. Considering the Integratus has been very determined to its submission, I believe many delegates must have a burning interest in the case.
康斯坦丁： 事实上，这是我第二次看到这份草案了。共融院如此锲而不舍地提交它，想必对此案抱有关注的代表人不在少数。

Constantine: At least it's worth some discussions.
康斯坦丁：我认为它至少是有讨论价值的。

Constantine: Pedra, why do you oppose it?
康斯坦丁：佩德拉，说说你的反对意见。

Committee Member I: The rise of Manus Vindictae has caused the arcanum world to gradually break free from the Foundation.
委员 I：重塑之手的崛起使神秘学界逐步脱离基金会的控制。

Committee Member I: Therefore we need to monitor what our arcanists think and control what they do in a stricter manner, in case they go too far.
委员 I：因此，我们需要更严格地把控基金会神秘学家的思想与行为，以防他们走上歧途。

Committee Member I: Manus Vindictae has a subversive slogan. Their influence has been getting bigger since the first "Storm," so has the scale of their infiltration.
委员 I：重塑之手的口号是颠覆性的。在“暴雨”之后，他们的影响与渗透性就在不断地加强。

Committee Member I: In The Walden incident in 1929, we were given away in advance. It probably had something to do with the infiltration.
委员 I：二九年酒吧事件，我方行踪提前暴露，极有可能与此有关。

Constantine: Very well, a point worth discussion.
康斯坦丁：嗯，很好，你提出了一个值得关注的观点。

Constantine: But it is not relevant to our subject here and now.
康斯坦丁：但它不属于本次议题。

Constantine: Stenographer, please take down the point Mr. Rosa just made. That will be the subject of our meeting in the third week.
康斯坦丁：速记员，标注下刚才的要点，作为第三周议题。

Constantine: Katz, what do you think?
康斯坦丁：卡兹，你的想法是什么?

Committee Member II: The expectations of our constituencies are on our shoulders.
委员 II：我们背负着选区民众的期望。

Committee Member II: Fear of the arcanists has grown due to the attacks by Manus Vindictae in many regions.
委员 II：重塑之手在各地的袭击进一步加深了人们对神秘学界的畏惧。

Committee Member II: It's not ideal for us to implement the "Peace Policy" and promote the arcane technology.
委员 II：这不利于我们“和平方针”的执行和神秘学技术的推广。

Committee Member II: To maintain the Foundation's reputation, we have to start with the registered arcanists. Strengthen the regulations, and show the public that arcanists are reasonable and trustworthy.
委员 II：要想维护基金会的信誉，必须从已登记神秘学家入手，加强管控，让民众看到神秘学家合理可信的一面。

Committee Member II: That is why I am opposed to the draft.
委员 II：所以我反对该草案的内容。

Constantine: ... Inspiring.
康斯坦丁：……相当有启发的看法。

She stands up, pacing around in the meeting room.
她站起来，在会议室内走动。

Constantine: However, what a shame, none of you have realized the key factor in this subject.
康斯坦丁：但是，很遗憾。太遗憾了，你们甚至都没有提到议题的重点。

Constantine: What is the key element that decides whether this proposal will be approved or not?
康斯坦丁：决定这项草案能否被通过的关键之处是什么？

Constantine: Manus Vindictae?
康斯坦丁：是重塑之手么？

Constantine: The constituents?
康斯坦丁：是人们的选票么？

Constantine: No. It's far simpler than those.
康斯坦丁：不，远远没有那么复杂。

Constantine: It's Vertin.
康斯坦丁：是维尔汀。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Constantine: According to the proposal, Vertin will become the only tie between these unregistered arcanists and the Foundation.
康斯坦丁：根据草案的提议，维尔汀将成为维系这些编外人员与基金会的唯一纽带。

Constantine: As the number of Vertin's field missions increases, she will inevitably get in touch with more and more unregistered arcanists.
康斯坦丁：编外人员的数量，将随着维尔汀的外出任务而持续增加。

Constantine: That is to say, outside the Foundation's jurisdiction, a group of people is getting stronger each day—an armed force.
康斯坦丁：也就是说，在基金会的管辖之外，有一支武装队伍在不断壮大。

Constantine: Her attitude towards the Foundation will be the key to all the issues.
康斯坦丁：她对基金会的态度将成为决定这一切的关键。

Z: Vertin received her education in SPDM from an early age. She has a clear tendency.
Z: 维尔汀自幼接受的是基金会第一防线学校的教育，她的态度倾向很明确。

Constantine: Yes, that's what I think.
康斯坦丁：是的，我也这么认为。

Constantine: That's also why I have asked someone who can provide a valid argument on the issue to join us.
康斯坦丁：我为此请来了一位能提供有效论证的特邀人员。

Constantine: You may come in, Sonetto.
康斯坦丁：十四行诗，你可以进来了。

Z: ...!
Z: ……!

The door is pushed ajar.
门推开了一条小缝。

Sonetto enters the room, humbly and prudently. Her uniform seems to have changed a little.
十四行诗小心翼翼地走了进来。她的制服有了一些新的变化。

Sonetto: ... Good day, Madam Vice President. Greetings to all committee members. May the peace be with us.
十四行诗：……副会长好。向各位委员致意。愿和平与我们同在。

Constantine: The Timekeeper is still in treatment. Before she is restored to health, I appoint you to take care of all the relevant matters on her behalf.
康斯坦丁：司辰的治疗尚未结束，在此期间，我委派你代表司辰处理相关事务。

Sonetto: Copy that.
十四行诗：收到。

Constantine: Now, I will ask you some questions. Please answer them truthfully.
康斯坦丁：接下来，我会问你几个问题。请你如实回答。

Sonetto: Clear.
十四行诗：明白。

Constantine: Based on your observation, do you or do you not think the Timekeeper has been loyal to the Foundation?
康斯坦丁：根据你的观察，你认为司辰对基金会是否忠诚?

Sonetto: ...!
十四行诗：……!

Sonetto: Of, of course!
十四行诗：当、当然!

Sonetto: All the students of the School of Primary Defense of Mankind are devoted to the peace of mankind. We have pledged lifelong allegiance to the Foundation that leads the cause.
十四行诗：第一防线学校的所有学员，都将誓死守护人类和平，终身效忠于领导这一事业的基金会。

Constantine: Heh heh, that's not what I'm asking.
康斯坦丁：呵呵，我说的不是这个。

Constantine: Let's put it differently. Why do you think Vertin would provoke other students to rebel when she was in school?
康斯坦丁：这么说吧。据你了解，维尔汀为什么会在在校期间组织学员逃离第一防线学校?

Sonetto: I ... I do not know ...
十四行诗：这……我不知道……

Sonetto: I am sorry.
十四行诗：对不起。

Constantine: After the incident of the "Storm," why would Vertin show reluctance to invite the unregistered arcanists to join the Foundation?
康斯坦丁：“暴雨”事件结束后，维尔汀为什么迟迟不邀请非登记神秘学家加入基金会?

Sonetto: Because ... Emm ...
十四行诗：因为……呃……

Constantine: At one point in her negotiation with the Manus Vindictae, Vertin has agreed to join them. What do you think her true intention was?
康斯坦丁：维尔汀在与重塑交涉期间曾提出要加入重塑之手，你认为她的真实态度是什么?

Sonetto: I ...
十四行诗：我——

Constantine: That'll be enough. I believe we all have our answers by now.
康斯坦丁：好了。我们已经得到想要的答案了。

Sonetto: Madam Vice President! A-According to our investigation of the event in 1929 and Timekeeper's report, it is highly possible that Arcana of Manus Vindictae has the arcane power to influence the sanity and consciousness of others from a certain distance.
十四行诗：副会长！根、根据我们在二九年的调查资料和司辰的报告内容可知，重塑之手的阿尔卡纳很可能具有在一定距离内影响他人神智与意识的神秘学能力！

Sonetto: She is able to exert an irresistible psychic influence on others through short conversations. Timekeeper ... Timekeeper was under huge threats at that time.
十四行诗：她能通过简单的对话对他人造成难以抵御的精神影响，司辰……司辰当时正遭受着极大的威胁。

Sonetto: I think all of her responses were out of her survival instinct.
十四行诗：我认为她的所有回答，全都来源于自我求生的本能……

Sonetto: This is also one of the survival strategies that have been taught in Chapter 1, Book 3 of *Introduction to Strategy* edited by the School of Primary Defense of Mankind.
十四行诗：这也是第一防线学校编《策略概论》第三册第一章所教授过的生存策略之一！

Constantine: I see. You may leave the room now.
康斯坦丁：我了解了。你先回去吧。

Sonetto's eyes turn red.
十四行诗的眼眶红了。

Sonetto: I ...
十四行诗：我……

Constantine: We appreciate the information you just added. You have always been an excellent student. We are very proud of you.
康斯坦丁：多谢你的补充。你一直都是让我们引以为傲的优秀学员。

Constantine: Now it's time to leave and rest.
康斯坦丁：现在请你回去休息吧。

Sonetto: ... Copy that.
十四行诗：……收到。

She leaves the room as instructed.
十四行诗离开了会议室。

Committee Member Ⅰ: ...
委员 Ⅰ：……

Committee Member Ⅱ: ...
委员 Ⅱ：……

Z: ...
Z：……

Silence fills the room.
桌前一片寂静。

Constantine: What a controversial issue.
康斯坦丁：真是一个充满争议的草案啊。

Constantine: What's your view on this, Ms. Z?
康斯坦丁：你的想法是什么，Z 女士?

Madam Z stands up. She takes her time before speaking.
Z 女士站起身来，她沉默了片刻。

Z: In my point of view ... Vertin does have doubts about current system.
Z: 我认为……维尔汀确实对现行制度持有怀疑的态度。

Z: But doubts don't mean disloyalty.
Z: 但怀疑并不代表不忠诚。

Z: In fact, if we want to further expand the staff to contend against the Manus Vindictae...
Z: 事实上，如果我们想要进一步的扩张，加大增员的力度，以对抗重塑之手的威胁……

Z: We need flexible management.
Z: 一个灵活机动的制度是必不可少的。

Z: Apply customized standards to arcanists with different backgrounds and different training objectives.
Z: 我们应当有的放矢，针对不同背景、不同培养目标的神秘学家制定各异的管控标准。

Z: Through this, not only can we remove the doubts of Vertin, but also ease the tension between the Foundation and other unregistered arcanists.
Z: 这样我们不仅能开解维尔汀的疑惑，还能缓和与其他非登记神秘学家的关系。

Constantine squints at her.
康斯坦丁眯起了眼睛。

Constantine: You have been very thoughtful.
康斯坦丁: 你考虑得很周全。

Constantine: Carry it out then.
康斯坦丁: 那就把它推行下去吧。

The stenographer pauses out of surprise.
速记员愣住了。

She looks up at Constantine, seeking confirmation from the look on her face.
她望向康斯坦丁，试图再次确认会议结论。

The stenographer quickly regains her composure and starts typing.
速记员很快回过神，在键盘上敲击下最后一行字符。

"Pass"
“准予通过。”

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 麻烦邻居
Trail ① A Troublesome Neighbor 小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum
投机倒把和烂糖果

夜间航行
Sailing at Night 4TH-10

Sailing at Night
夜间航行

Guest Room, St. Foundation
基金会客房

Matilda: Silver divination stand, white silk, pearls soaked in night dew ...
玛蒂尔达：银质的占卜台、白色的丝绸、浸过夜露的珍珠……

Matilda: Hmm, what else lunar materials do I need ...
玛蒂尔达：嗯，月亮材料还缺什么呢……

Matilda: Alright! Let me see how much frankincense and myrrh are left ...
玛蒂尔达：噢！检查一下乳香和没药还有多少……

Matilda: Cool, just the quantity I need.
玛蒂尔达：很好，没问题，分量刚刚好。

Matilda immerses herself in the work on the desk. She checked the installment of the curtains repeatedly, making sure the moonlight will precisely shed on the orb.
玛蒂尔达在桌前忙活着。她反复确认窗帘的位置，确保月光能无误地映照在晶球上。

A low noise is growing in a vessel not far away from her.
细小的骚动在不远处的容器中响起。

But she has no clue at all.
但她无心留意。

Matilda: Okay, all set. Incense basin, my incense basin ...
玛蒂尔达：很好，都齐全了。香料皿，我的香料皿……

She turns around.
玛蒂尔达转过身来。

Matilda: Ahhh!
玛蒂尔达：呀啊——！

The incense basin falls, making a hollow sound on the Soumak.
一旁的香料皿落到地上，在对称结编织的地毯上发出声响。

???: ~♪
???: ～♪

A pair of pointy ears emerge from behind the basin.
香料皿后面露出尖尖的小耳朵。

Matilda: You again! Annoying divination sprites!
玛蒂尔达：怎么又是你们！烦人的占卜妖精！

Matilda: You are not stealing anything from me this time!
玛蒂尔达：我这次绝对不会再允许你们偷走我的道具了！

???: ~♪~♪
???: ～♪～♪

Her attitude doesn't bother these transparent creatures at the moment.
透明的小生物并不关心她的慌张。

Unlike any ordinary critters who always act in a group, only one or two of them are more than enough to get people in trouble.
它们与那些成群结队的魔精不同，仅是一两只，就能给人们带来极大的麻烦。

Their thin, slim hands grab hold of the edge of the silver incense basin. They are flying towards the window.
细长的小手攥住银制的香料皿边沿，向窗外飞去。

Matilda: Hey! Where are you taking my basin?! Stop it!
玛蒂尔达：嘿！你们想把我的东西偷到哪里去？快给我住手！

She jumps up the windowsill and grips the other edge of the basin.
她扑上窗台，紧紧地抓住银皿的另一边。

Matilda: Ugh ... Looks like you need a good lesson to understand why you shouldn't do this!
玛蒂尔达：呼……看来不好好惩罚你们一下，你们、你们是不会知道教训的！

Matilda: Wait and see. I'll let you know the consequence of messing with Ms. Matilda Bouanich!
玛蒂尔达：等着吧，我马上就会让你们知道，得罪玛蒂尔达·布翁尼小姐，是个什么下场！

The silver basin falls to the floor, knocking a shallow crater on it.
银皿摔到地上，撞出一个陷坑。

Divination Sprite: × ... ×!
占卜妖精：×……×！

The sprites are crawling under the window, looking flabby and weak. Apparently, they have taken quite a shock.
妖精们在窗前软软地爬行，看起来受了不小的冲击。

Matilda picks up the basin and wipes out the dust.
玛蒂尔达拾起香料皿，擦了擦上面的灰。

Matilda: Ha, he who laughs last, laughs best! It's me, ME!
玛蒂尔达：哼，看看是谁笑到了最后～！是我，是我！

Divination Sprite: ♮♭♮♯♭♯♮♯♭!
占卜妖精：♮♭♮♯♭♯♮♯♭！

They burst out an incomprehensible curse, sneaking away from the window with drooping wings on their backs.
它们爆发出一阵难以听懂的咒骂，垂着翅膀从窗外逃走了。

Matilda: Ugh ... these troublemakers. I'm exhausted.
玛蒂尔达：啊……真是的，累死我了。

Matilda: It's kinda late ... Oh! Thank goodness, I didn't miss the high tide!
玛蒂尔达：现在多少点了……哦！还好，还没有错过潮汐时间！

Hurriedly, she starts to restore the order on the desk.
她手忙脚乱地收拾起桌面上的道具。

Matilda: Set the props ...
玛蒂尔达：赶紧把东西摆好……

Matilda: I can't be distracted again. Divination takes my full attention and energy ...
玛蒂尔达：不能再被打搅了，占卜需要全神贯注，凝聚所有的能量……

However, there's a knock on the door.
门外却响起轻轻的叩门声。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda: Ahem! The high tide caused by the moon is coming. Let me see, estimated to start at 20:45.
玛蒂尔达：咳咳！月球潮汐就要到来了，我看看，预测出现的时间是 20 点 45 分。

Matilda: Three minutes to go.
玛蒂尔达：还有三分钟。

Matilda: Gotta purify the orb when the high tide starts to make sure the divination is correct ...
玛蒂尔达：涨潮的同时要净化水晶球，确保获得的占卜知识准确无误……

The knock comes again.
敲门声再次响起。

Matilda frowns.
玛蒂尔达皱起了眉头。

Matilda: Calm down, calm down. This is the key moment ... Whoever it is, I must not be distracted!
玛蒂尔达：冷静，冷静。这可是最关键的时刻……不管是谁，都别来影响我！

Matilda: Alright ... Focus, focus.
玛蒂尔达：嗯……不要分神，不要分神。

Matilda: Eyes closed ... Focus ... Imagine my body rising and falling alongside the tide under the blessing of the moon ...
玛蒂尔达：闭上双眼……集中精神……想象身体正在月亮的祝福下，伴随着潮汐起伏……

Matilda: And she is on the other side of the sea ... waiting for me to find her ...
玛蒂尔达：而她将在和谐的对岸……等候着我去寻找方向……

Matilda: Time to burn the incense ...
玛蒂尔达：是时候焚烧香料了……

Matilda: Show yourself in the orb, Sonett- ...
玛蒂尔达：于水晶中显现形象吧，十四行……

Sonetto: Matilda, are you there?
十四行诗：玛蒂尔达，你在屋里吗?

Matilda: ...?!
玛蒂尔达：……?!

Matilda: Wh-what is ... going on?
玛蒂尔达：这是怎，怎……怎么回事?

Sonetto: I am sorry, but I think I heard your voice.
十四行诗：抱歉，但我似乎听到你的声音了。

Sonetto: I need to ask you ... a favor.
十四行诗：我有事……想请你帮忙。

Her voice sounds different. Exhausted, almost rusty, as if it were coming out from an old cassette.
她的声音听起来有些变化，带着被磨损后的颗粒感。

Matilda: C-coming! Um, w-wait a minute!
玛蒂尔达：我……我马上就来！不对，你先等一会儿！

Matilda: I'm, uh, busy! W-Wait there and be patient!
玛蒂尔达：我现在、忙着呢，你——你给我等好了！

In a great panic, she pulls up the silk, covers the orb, and sticks the both of them into a corner of the couch.
她慌里慌张地掀起水晶球下的丝绸，将它们塞到沙发的角落。

The door opens.
门开了。

They both stand inside the door frame, toe to toe, blocking each other's way. As they awkwardly try to move, they go up and retreat in the same direction, as if this were a tango tutorial.
她们站在门口，前进，后退，如同在进行尴尬的方步练习。

Matilda eventually steps back and lets Sonetto in.
最后，十四行诗被玛蒂尔达迎了进来。

Matilda: Now tell me your request! Wh-what brings you to the bright and intelligent Ms. Bouanich at this time?!
玛蒂尔达：说出你的请求吧！你深夜来找聪明伶俐的玛蒂尔达小姐，是……是来做什么！

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Sonetto forces a smile on her face.
十四行诗脸上挤出一个笑容。

Sonetto: Could you please read the future for me?
十四行诗：能请你为我占卜一下吗?

Matilda sees something she has never seen before on Sonetto's face.
玛蒂尔达在她的脸上看到了从未见过的景象。

They sit down by the orb.
她们在水晶球旁边坐下了。

Myrrh is quietly burning next to them.
没药在一旁静静地焚烧着。

Matilda: Alright. Now is a good time to ask the moon for help ...
玛蒂尔达：嗯，现在是一个适合向月亮求助的时间……

Matilda: Clean your hands in the silver pot, and put them on mine.
玛蒂尔达：在银盆中洗净双手，再放到我的手掌上。

Matilda: Okay. Now sit opposite me, and gaze into the orb.
玛蒂尔达：好了，请坐到我的对面，凝视着水晶球。

Sonetto: Okay.
十四行诗：好的。

She does what she is told. She sees nothing but a clear whiteness in the orb.
十四行诗照做了。她看到水晶球里是一片澄澈的空白。

Matilda: Are you here to confess, to interpret a dream, or to seek the prophecy of the crystal?
玛蒂尔达：你是来告解，释梦，还是来寻求水晶的预言?

Sonetto: I am here to confess ... and to seek the prophecy.
十四行诗：我来告解……也来寻求预言。

Matilda: Tell me about the vision in your heart.
玛蒂尔达：跟我说说积蓄于你心中的画面吧。

Sonetto: The vision ...?
十四行诗：画面吗……?

Sonetto: Hmm ...
十四行诗：嗯……

She looks at the orb. The shape of the sphere becomes blurry and gradually fades out in her sight.
她望着水晶球。球体在她眼中逐渐模糊。

Sonetto: I ...
十四行诗：我……

Sonetto: See myself falling ...
十四行诗：看到自己在不断地下坠……

Sonetto: There are two broken decks ... They were originally one piece.
十四行诗：有两块碎裂的甲板……它们原本是一体的。

Sonetto: Every time I get closer to one deck, the other one sinks.
十四行诗：每当我靠近一块甲板时，另一块就会沉入水中。

Sonetto: People on it will fall with it.
十四行诗：上面的人们也随之一同坠落。

Sonetto: I can feel the coldness of the deep water, and the pains when they struggle.
十四行诗：我能感受到深水处的冰冷，也能感到挣扎时的疼痛。

Matilda: Are you sad about it?
玛蒂尔达：你对此感到悲伤吗?

Sonetto: ... I ...
十四行诗：……我……

Sonetto: I feel fear.
十四行诗：我感到恐惧。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Matilda: I see ... Which deck would you like to approach intuitively? Can you recognize the people on them?
玛蒂尔达：嗯……你的直觉想要靠近哪一块甲板？上面的人影你能看清楚吗?

Sonetto: I ...
十四行诗：我……

Sonetto: There is something bright on that deck, just like ... Timekeeper and Druvis ... It is warm there.
十四行诗：那块甲板上有明亮的东西，就像是……司辰和槲寄生她们……那里很温暖。

Matilda: ... You are attracted to it subconsciously. It guides the way of your heart.
玛蒂尔达：……你不自觉地受它的吸引。它赋予了你心灵的指引。

Matilda: What about the other?
玛蒂尔达：另一块甲板呢?

Sonetto: The other deck ... makes me feel comfortable, as if I have spent a long time there.
十四行诗：另一块甲板……让我感到舒适。仿佛我在那里度过了漫长的岁月。

Sonetto: I can trace back every step I take.
十四行诗：我能在那里找到我每一步的轨迹。

Matilda: Perhaps that symbolizes your senses.
玛蒂尔达：那或许象征了你的理性。

Matilda: Sonetto, are you having trouble making a choice?
玛蒂尔达：十四行诗，你在面临什么抉择吗?

Matilda: I can see the conflict ... between your instinct and senses.
玛蒂尔达：我看到你的直觉与理性处于矛盾的……角度。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Matilda: I heard you attended the committee's meeting today.
玛蒂尔达：听说你今天也参与了委员会的会议。

Matilda: Anything happened?
玛蒂尔达：发生了什么事吗?

Sonetto: I said something wrong.
十四行诗：我说错了话。

Sonetto: I was not properly prepared ...
十四行诗：我没有做好充足的准备……

Sonetto: I was unable to help Timekeeper and Druvis; instead, I created a deeper misunderstanding.
十四行诗：我没有帮上司辰和槲寄生她们的忙，反而加大了彼此的误解。

Sonetto: What choice should I make ... to resolve their conflict? Stalemate like that ... really scares me.
十四行诗：我该如何选择……才能解决他们的矛盾？这样的僵持……让我感到很害怕。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda can't find a word.
玛蒂尔达一时不知道怎么回答。

She sits there frozen, covering Sonetto's wrist with her palms.
她只是呆呆地将手掌盖在对方手腕上。

Matilda: The bright deck ... seems closer and larger.
玛蒂尔达：那块明亮的甲板……似乎距离你更近，也更大一些。

Matilda: Have you ever thought about following your heart?
玛蒂尔达：你有没有考虑过倾听心灵的指引?

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Matilda: Sonetto, maybe you can try following your instinct for once.
玛蒂尔达：十四行诗，或许你可以尝试一次，跟随着直觉采取行动。

Matilda: Maybe something unexpected will happen.
玛蒂尔达：也许会发生意想不到的事情哦。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Sonetto: I tried.
十四行诗：我尝试过。

Sonetto: ... Four years ago.
十四行诗：——在四年前。

Sonetto: I let them go ... That was the worst decision I have ever made.
十四行诗：我放了他们离开……那是我做过最错误的决定。

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Sonetto's hands are on the orb again.
十四行诗重新握住了水晶球。

Sonetto: I am ready. Please tell me the right choice.
十四行诗：我准备好了。请帮我占卜出正确的选择吧。

Matilda: ... Okay.
玛蒂尔达：……好。

As the chaotic snowflakes disappear, the shape of the orb is becoming blurry again.
混沌的雪花消失后，球体重新变得朦胧。

Crystals emerge in thin air ...
而视野中浮现出隐约的晶体。

... One after another, they build up a symmetrical and balanced ship.
它们层层搭建出一艘对称而均衡的小船。

Everything has its trace to follow, its logic to function.
一切都有迹可循，有理可依。

Matilda: "The reality has shown itself."
玛蒂尔达：“实相已显现。”

Matilda: "Take the path you have already taken, walk the way you have already walked."
玛蒂尔达：“步入已步入之道，行进已行进之径。”

Matilda: "You shall benefit from listening to the voice in your mind, as it is not yet time to dock."
玛蒂尔达：“听从脑内的声音将于你有益，因为泊船的时刻未到。”

Sonetto: Listen to the voice in my mind ...
十四行诗：听从脑内的声音……

Sonetto: I see.
十四行诗：我明白了。

Sonetto: I should not have hesitated.
十四行诗：我不该犹疑的。

Sonetto: Thank you, Matilda. Your divination is very helpful ... My mind is very clear now.
十四行诗：谢谢你，玛蒂尔达。你的占卜对我很有帮助……我现在清醒多了。

Matilda: You're ... Ha, of course you should thank me!
玛蒂尔达：谢……哈，你当然应该谢谢我——！

Matilda: You should have known the resourcefulness of Ms. Matilda Bouanich much earlier.
玛蒂尔达：现在才知道玛蒂尔达·布翁尼小姐的神通广大实在是太晚了。

Matilda: For your information, those seeking my help must make an appointment at least 15 days before the divination, otherwise, they won't even get to see me!
玛蒂尔达：要知道，平时找我占卜的人，如果没有提前十五天预约，本小姐可是见都不会见的！

Sonetto: Haha.
十四行诗：哈哈。

Matilda: ...!
玛蒂尔达：……！

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Sonetto: You were very serious during the divination ... Even your tone was different from usual.
十四行诗：你占卜的时候很认真……语气都与平时不一样了。

Sonetto: However, I am more familiar with the way you talk now ... It reminds me of our time at school.
十四行诗：不过，我还是更习惯你现在的说话方式……这会让我想到我们在校的时光。

Matilda stands there, transfixed.
玛蒂尔达呆若木鸡地站着。

Sonetto waves at her and walks out of the room.
十四行诗挥了挥手，走出了房间。

Sonetto: Thank you for making time for me, Matilda.
十四行诗：谢谢你专门为我腾出时间，玛蒂尔达。

Sonetto: If you need my help next time, please let me know.
十四行诗：下次有需要我帮忙的地方，请一定要告知我。

Sonetto: Good night.
十四行诗：晚安。

The door is carefully closed behind her.
门被轻轻带上了。

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Matilda: !%$#...&*...
玛蒂尔达：！%￥#……&*……

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

占卜初学者
Divination Beginner 小径

Long Night Trip
漫漫长夜旅行

甜苹果
A Sweet APPLe 4TH-11

A Sweet APPLe
甜苹果

Z: Richard, tends to oppose.
Z: 理查德，倾向反对。

Z: Gloria, tends to support.
Z: 格洛丽亚，倾向赞成。

Z: Black Agate, tends to oppose.
Z: 黑玛瑙，倾向反对。

Z: Ouzo, neutral.
Z: 乌佐，中立。

Delegate: The situation doesn't look good.
代表人: 目前的形势不容乐观。

Z: Do you have any news, Mark?
Z: 有什么消息吗？马克。

Delegate: Someone is spreading the minutes of your last meeting.
代表人: 有人在传播你们上次会议的内容。

Delegate: I didn't get any direct evidence, but apparently every voter has read the anonymous minutes.
代表人: 我没拿到直接证据。但很显然，每个投票人选都看过了匿名的会议记录。

Delegate: The topic about Vertin ... It has become a great disadvantage to us.
代表人: 你们谈到的关于维尔汀的话题——对我们的票数非常不利。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Z: Double envelopment ...
Z: 两面夹击……

Z: A "4-4 point double low approach" ...
Z: 原来是一招“双飞燕”吗……

Z: No wonder they let the draft go through so easily.
Z: 怪不得会如此顺利地通过草案。

Z: To reject the draft during the committee meeting does not actually address the real problem. The House of Integratus can still re-submit the draft during the next legislative session.
Z: 在委员会议上否决草案并不能解决根本问题。共融院仍然能像这次一样，重新申请该草案的立法程序。

Z: So she is planning for the long term ...
Z: 所以她着眼于更长远的一步棋——

Z: To bring it down in the voting stage and make it a plan that is totally abandoned.
Z: 让它成为一份在辩论环节因联合投票失利而被废除的草案。

Delegate: I'm afraid so.
代表人：恐怕是的。

Delegate: A draft that has failed to win votes can hardly win the trust of the House's reviewers again, and of course it won't be submitted to the committee.
代表人：票选失败的废案，很难再获得共融院审核团的信任，自然就无法提交给委员会了。

She counts the names on the whiteboard again.
Z 女士重新数了数白板上的人数。

Z: Did anyone make any actual move yet?
Z: 人们有实际的动作吗?

Delegate: Not yet. The minutes only changed their preferences, but the number of those who have taken a stand still remains the same.
代表人：还没有。会议记录只是影响了他们的倾向，但明确表态的人数没有变化。

Z: Hmm, just as I expected.
Z: 嗯，这符合我的预期。

Z: This draft is not about Vertin, but a promise to the future—about how to balance the benefits between different interest groups.
Z: 这份草案的重点并不在于维尔汀，而在于将来的承诺，它要如何平衡不同群体的利益。

Z: To reach that, we need to meet the expectations of those groups who have a need for flexible management, and also appease the conservatives and not shake their confidence in controlling the overall situation.
Z: 我们既要满足对灵活制度有需求的群体的期望，也要安抚保守派的情绪，不能动摇他们对控制整体局势的信心。

Delegate: Actually ...
代表人：事实上——

The delegate adjusts his tie and interrupts Madam Z in a clear voice.
代表人攥了攥领带，声音清亮地打断了 Z 女士的分析。

Delegate: We do have an opportunity to change the game now.
代表人：现在有一个反败为胜的机会。

Z: Opportunity?
Z: 怎么说?

He puts in "0411" on the keyboard attached to his wrist, and turns on the big screen.
他在手腕键盘上输入“0411”，打开了屏幕。

Committee member Pedra appears on the screen.
委员佩德拉的形象出现在显示器中。

Committee Member I: I hereby challenge Delegate Mark Hal to a public debate on the revised draft of *Storm Reformation: Manpower and Discipline*.
委员 I：我在此就《暴雨改革：增员与秩序》修订草案向代表人马克·哈尔提出公开辩论挑战。

Committee Member I: This draft of his will bring unpredictable risks to the Foundation, yet Mark himself seems completely unaware of it.
委员 I：他起草的《暴雨改革》将给基金会带来不可预估的风险，而他本人似乎对此一无所知。

Committee Member I: I believe it is necessary to make such risks public in a legal way.
委员 I：我认为有必要对此风险进行公开且合法的展示。

The delegate switches off the projection. As he turns to Madam Z, his cheeks have become rosy in heightened spirits.
代表人关掉了屏幕。他转身面向 Z 女士，满面红光。

Delegate: See, I knew they were going to escalate Vertin's issue.
代表人：你看，他们果然打算进一步扩大化维尔汀的问题。

Z: You want to accept this challenge?
Z：你想要接受挑战?

Delegate: ... All the internal media are reporting the news.
代表人：——内部媒体都在播报这个新闻。

Delegate: If I step back, they will definitely humiliate me and take advantage of the public opinion to undermine the draft.
代表人：如果我拒绝了，他们一定会羞辱我，还会借着舆论打压草案。

Z: Mark ... That's a menacing move.
Z：马克……他这是一步凶招。

Madam Z picks up Pedra's name card and sticks it to the board.
Z 女士拿起佩德拉的名牌，贴到白板上。

Z: It is coming for us.
Z：这是直奔着我们来的。

Z: No matter fight or flight, they have comprehensive preparation for this.
Z：不论是正面应战，还是高飞远遁，他们都有足够的变化来应对。

Z: I would suggest taking the long view and not jumping to conclusions.
Z：我建议从长计议，不要过早下定论。

Delegate: But defense without attack will never bring us victory, Madam Z.
代表人：但是一味地防守无法带来最终的胜利，Z 女士。

Delegate: I've always wanted an opportunity to defend the draft in public.
代表人：我一直在等待一个公开的机会为草案辩白。

Delegate: Concerning the questions they implied about Vertin, I've collected more than enough cases to refute them.
代表人：那些他们暗中抛出的针对维尔汀的疑点，我都搜集了大量足以反驳的案例。

Delegate: Misleading questions twist people's opinions. It's time to tell them the truth.
代表人：别有用心的提问会扭曲人们对事实的看法，是时候向他们揭露真相了。

The gaze behind Madam Z's glasses has become subtly piercing.
Z 女士镜片后的目光隐隐锐利起来。

Z: You have accepted it.
Z：你是不是已经答应了。

Delegate: ...
代表人：……

Z: Was it in front of the media?
Z：也是在媒体面前吗?

Delegate: I was there when Pedra challenged me ... so were the media.
代表人：佩德拉是当着我的面发起挑战的……媒体都在场。

Delegate: ... Well I don't think it is going to be a complete mistake.
代表人：——我不认为这会是一个完全的错误。

The lady in white seems to loosen up for a brief second.
身着白衣的女士的面容似乎有一瞬间的松弛。

She doesn't say a word ...
她没说什么。

... but walks up to him and gives him a pat on the shoulder.
她走到他的身旁，拍了拍他的肩膀。

Z: It is a crucial debate.
Z: 这是一场至关重要的辩论。

Z: Do your best.
Z: 好好发挥。

Druvis Ⅲ: You don't have to come along with me.
槲寄生: 其实你不必跟着我一起来的。

Druvis Ⅲ: I'm here to repel the pests in the woods. It's part of my daily routine.
槲寄生: 我只是例行出来清扫树林的虫害，这是我日常生活中的一部分。

Sotheby: Thank you for your kindness, Ms. Druvis!
苏芙比: 谢谢你的关心～槲寄生小姐！

Sotheby: It is fun to stay in Ms. Vertin's suitcase ... but I really feel like seeing the world out there.
苏芙比: 维尔汀小姐的箱子虽然很有意思……但我还是更想出来看看外面的世界。

Sotheby: By the way, the pests you mentioned ... What are they?
苏芙比: 而且，你说的虫害……是什么呀?

Sotheby: I've heard of a kind of giant worm called the Tatzelwurm. They live in caves, about two to five feet long, and their heads are like cats'.
苏芙比: 我听说过一种住在洞穴里的巨虫，叫塔泽尔亚龙。它有两到五英尺长，脑袋是猫的形状。

Sotheby: Be very careful if you see one. Both its skin and breath are toxic!
苏芙比: 如果你看到它，一定要小心。因为它的皮肤有剧毒，还会通过呼吸喷出毒气！

Druvis bends over, lifting a hanging branch to make a way for Sotheby to walk through.
槲寄生俯下身来，扶起垂下的树枝，帮苏芙比腾出一个行走的空间。

Druvis Ⅲ: Heh heh. I have never heard of such a terrible worm.
槲寄生: 呵呵，我还从来没有听说过这样可怕的昆虫。

Druvis Ⅲ: Hopefully we will not encounter any.
槲寄生: 但愿我们不会与它相遇。

Sotheby jumps briskly over some roots crawling by her feet.
苏芙比灵活地跃过挡在脚下的树根。

Sotheby: Hah, uh!
苏芙比: 嘿——！

Sotheby: So what are we disinfesting this time?
苏芙比: 那我们这次要清理的是什么东西呀?

Druvis Ⅲ: Oak processionary moths. Perhaps a few gray squirrel cubs.
槲寄生: 栎列队蛾，或许还会有一些灰松鼠的幼崽。

Druvis Ⅲ: It's not enough to only rely on potions and arcanum to keep the woods in peace ... Oak trees reside here, and everything will change with it.
槲寄生: 光靠魔药与神秘术来维持森林的秩序是不够的……橡树在此处栖息，一切也将随之变化。

Druvis Ⅲ: Animals that live in symbiosis, fungi that depend on each other, all of them will embrace diversity by the day.
槲寄生：共生相伴的动物，互相依附的真菌，它们都将日渐丰富。

Sotheby suddenly looks up and points to the direction to the edge of the woods.
苏芙比突然抬起头来，指着树林边缘的方向。

Sotheby: Do you mean that?
苏芙比：你说的是那个吗?

Sotheby: A group of grey fluff is flying over there!
苏芙比：那里有一大团在飞舞的灰色毛毛!

Druvis looks in the direction her finger points to.
槲寄生顺着她手指的方向望去。

Clusters of fluff, in gray and brown, coming together and forming a flossy tornado in front of them, fly and dance in the air.
灰色与褐色的茸毛，在不远处聚成一场龙卷风，旋转着，飞舞着。

Druvis Ⅲ: ... A swarm of oak processionary moths!
槲寄生：……是集群的栎列队蛾!

Druvis Ⅲ: They are preying on something.
槲寄生：它们似乎在围攻着一只猎物。

A fuzzy figure in red at the center seems familiar.
那团隐约的红色，令人感到有些熟悉。

Sotheby: Ms. Druvis, let's help out right away!
苏芙比：槲寄生小姐，我们赶紧过去帮帮它吧!

APPLe: *sighs* ... This APPLe is deeply grateful for what you've done.
APPLe：呼呼……APPLe 某对此不胜感激。

APPLe: I almost thought I was caught in a nightmare. This APPLe has never seen so many moths.
APPLe：我差点以为自己要陷入一场噩梦之中了。APPLe 某从未见过这么多的飞蛾。

He is trembling from his stalk to the bottom.
他浑身打颤。

APPLe: Ugh. This APPLe is going to have PTSD from insects.
APPLe：呕，APPLe 某恐怕要出现昆虫创伤后应激障碍了。

Druvis Ⅲ: They are very sensitive to the scent of sap.
槲寄生：它们对植物汁液的香味很敏感。

Druvis Ⅲ: With all due respect, even among all the plants, Mr. APPLe is quite attractive to insects.
槲寄生：请恕我直言，即使是在植物界，APPLe 先生对昆虫也具有相当的吸引力。

Sotheby: So it was the scent that attracted them. No wonder Mr. APPLe's invisibility didn't work.
苏芙比：原来是通过气味发现的呀，怪不得 APPLe 先生的隐形能力没有帮上忙～

Sotheby: Thank goodness we are here!
苏芙比：还好我们及时赶到了!

Druvis carefully cleans off the fluff on APPLe with her handkerchief.
槲寄生用手帕仔仔细细地擦干净苹果沾上的茸毛。

Until he restores his handsomeness.
直到它重新恢复透亮的光泽。

Druvis Ⅲ: Mr. APPLe, did you find out anything?
槲寄生：APPLe 先生，你打听到了什么消息么?

APPLe: Yes, Ms. Druvis. I brought something insignificant.
APPLe：是的，槲寄生小姐。我带来了一些微不足道的新闻。

APPLe: As we planned earlier, I disguised myself and reached the office building next to us.
APPLe：正如我们之前所计划的，我隐去了身形，顺利抵达了隔壁的办公楼。

APPLe: There is a device to detect arcane power at the entrance, however, this APPLe pried out what we needed from the guards.
APPLe：尽管大楼门口设有监测神秘术的装置，但我从守卫的口中，探听到了我们想要的内容。

Sotheby: What, what is it?
苏芙比：是什么？是什么?

Sotheby: Did Ms. Vertin win on that voting list?
苏芙比：维尔汀小姐的投票本本大获全胜了吗?

APPLe: Sadly, not yet.
APPLe：很遗憾，并非如此。

APPLe: It's not time for a formal vote. Everyone is cautious and remains neutral.
APPLe：还没到正式表决的时候。所有人都很谨慎，保持着中立的态度。

APPLe: Apart from that, there are some rumors in the Foundation ... They are not very favorable to Vertin.
APPLe：除此以外，基金会里出现了一些流言……对维尔汀不是很有利。

Druvis Ⅲ: Rumors ...
槲寄生：流言么……

Druvis Ⅲ: It sounds as though the situation that Madam Z handles is more complicated and volatile than I thought.
槲寄生：看来 Z 女士那边的局面，比我想象得更为复杂多变。

Druvis Ⅲ: However, the votes have not been lopsided under such bad circumstances ...
槲寄生：不过，在这样的恶劣的情形下，依然没有出现投票一边倒的状况……

Druvis Ⅲ: Perhaps that means the arcanists who share our aspirations are not in the minority.
槲寄生：或许说明与我们抱有相似愿望的神秘学家，不在少数。

APPLe: That said, I'm afraid we are starting a protracted war, Ms. Druvis.
APPLe：话虽如此，但恐怕我们面临的将是一场持久的战役，槲寄生小姐。

Druvis Ⅲ: Yes. I know. I've taken an inventory of the supplies. We can still hang in there for four weeks and a half.
槲寄生：嗯，我明白。我清点过物资，还足够支撑四周半的时间。

Druvis Ⅲ: Although they have cut off the water and electricity supplies in the building, we can still live on the resources in the suitcase for a while.
槲寄生：虽然他们断掉了这栋楼的水电供应，但依靠着箱子的资源，我们尚能维系一段时日的生存。

Druvis Ⅲ: There are fewer guards destroying the woods, probably because the abatis works.
槲寄生：现在破坏森林的守卫也越来越少了，很可能是我们安置的鹿砦起了作用。

APPLe: What worries this APPLe is that if the procedure to finalise the draft takes more than four weeks and a half, we would ...
APPLe：APPLe 某担忧的是，万一确立法案的流程超过了四周半，那我们……

Druvis Ⅲ: We would then survive by gradually shrinking our territory ... until Madam Z's draft is officially approved.
槲寄生：那我们就通过逐步缩小领地来维持生存……直到 Z 女士的法案获得胜利。

Druvis Ⅲ: We have chosen the thorny trail, and so we are destined to burn our boats and never look back.
槲寄生：我们选择了这条布满荆棘的小径，便注定济河焚舟，永不回头。

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin ... She is worth fighting for.
槲寄生：维尔汀……她值得如此。

APPLe: For this point, Captain and this APPLe have absolutely no disagreement.
APPLe：在这一点上，APPLe 某与船长也绝无异议。

APPLe: Then this APPLe will keep scouting around for updates so that we could respond in time.
APPLe：那么，APPLe 某将继续打探最新消息，以便我们及时应变。

Sotheby: ...
苏芙比：……

Sotheby's eyes are fixed in another direction.
苏芙比定定地望着另一个方向。

Druvis Ⅲ: What are you looking at, Ms. Sotheby?
槲寄生：你在望什么呢？苏芙比小姐。

Sotheby: Over there ... It feels like someone is staring at us.
苏芙比：那里……好像有人在看着我们。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...
槲寄生：……

They both look over to that corner.
他们都向那个角落望去。

There is nothing but shadows. The darkness looks like a pond of unimaginable depth.
那里只有一片沉默的漆黑，如同不见底的深潭。

Druvis stands up.
槲寄生站起身来。

Druvis Ⅲ: Let's go back.
槲寄生：我们回去吧。

Druvis Ⅲ: To the deep woods.
槲寄生：回到森林的深处。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① “无名垂钓者”记录

Trail ① Record of A Nameless Angler 小径

Sightings of the "Nameless Angler"
关于“无名垂钓者”的传闻记录

英文 / ENGLISH
Sunday 07:21
Angelina of the Field Operation Squad passed by the east side of the Foundation Square and

saw someone in white by the fountain.
This is the earliest sighting of the target.

Same Sunday 15:10
Mary of the Medical Department took stock of the Picrasma Extract III in the warehouse, behind which she found a rubber fishing bucket with 3 suckermouth catfishes inside which were 3-4 inches long.

Same Sunday 15:22
Mary left the warehouse and the fishing bucket was gone.
There were water spots and a little granite rubble left on the ground.

Monday 06:30-08:30
A cleaner found some abandoned fishhooks near the fountains as well as by multiple water sources (streams, estuaries). Most of the fishhooks were hung below treetops.

Same Monday 22:33
A patrol squad found a set of fishing gears near reception area 13.
The gear set includes a carbon fishing rod with woolen core, a foldable rubber fishing bucket, a comfortable folding chair, and three buckled boxes of baits made with Carbuncle's tooth pulp.
It is now taken to the Lost and Found.

* * *

All right, it seems to be a "Nameless Angler" in the Foundation.
We have collected some basic information after the first inquiry, but a lot still remain unknown.

What does he want? Where does he come from?
Is he a ghost? A spy sent by other political organizations? Or an arcane puppet made by someone that plans to wipe out all the suckermouth catfishes because they have a problem with the appearance of the race?
Everything, everything remains unknown ...
Hah! Let's move on to the next inquiry!

中文 / CHINESE

周日 清晨 07 时 21 分
外部行动小队的安洁莉娜途经基金会广场东侧，景观泉水旁可见一白色人形。
此为目前最早可知目击记录。

同周日 午后 15 时 10 分
医疗组的玛丽前往仓库核验苦目提取液 3 号数量时，于仓库后方发现一只橡胶制钓鱼桶。其中盛有 3 条长度约为 8～11 厘米的豹纹脂身鲇。

同周日 午后 15 时 22 分左右
玛丽离开仓库，钓鱼桶消失。
地面上可见模糊水印与少量大理石碎屑。

周一 清晨 06 时 30 分～08 时 30 分
清扫负责人员于景观泉水、溪流与海水河等多处水源附近发现废弃鱼钩。其中多半悬挂于树冠下缘。

同周一 夜间 22 时 33 分左右
巡逻小队于 13 号会客房附近发现一副渔具。
其中包含一根碳纤维羊毛芯鱼竿、一只塑胶制可折叠钓鱼桶、一把坐感舒适的折叠椅、三枚卡扣式盒装卡邦克鲁牙髓饵料。现储存于失物招领点。

* * *

好吧，看起来基金会内部的确存在着一个“无名垂钓者”。

根据走访求证，我们已经初步地获得了一些信息，但更多的还是未知。

他的目的是什么？他来自于哪儿？

他是幽灵吗？或是充满了政治色彩的间谍？又或是某个对吸盘清道夫外貌颇有微词、盘算着将其清算干净的家伙鼓捣出的神秘术人偶——？

一切，一切都还是未知的——

哈！让我们开始下一轮的调查吧！

一封来信

A Letter 4TH-12

A Letter
一封来信

Committee member Pedra walks out of the changing room.
委员佩德拉从更衣室里走出来。

He sees Delegate Mark sitting in front of a mirror and shaping his sideburns into sharp summits with pomade.
他看到代表人正坐在镜子前，用发蜡将鬓角塑起高峰。

A tie, ablaze with bright colors, is around his neck.
一条色彩欢快的领巾正系在马克的颈前。

Committee Member I: Isn't that scarf a bit too high-profile?
委员 I： 这条领巾不会太高调吗?

Mark stops his beauty procedures and looks at Pedra in the mirror.
马克停下手上的动作，从镜中看向佩德拉。

Delegate: I think it fits me just well.
代表人： 我觉得刚好。

Delegate: You chose a grey shirt. Wise decision.
代表人： 你选择了灰色的衬衫，这很明智。

Committee Member I: ...
委员 I： ……

Committee Member I: Looks like you're fully prepared.
委员 I： 看来你今天做了相当充足的准备。

Mark doesn't answer that question. Instead, he pulls out a volume of files and starts to draw and write on them.
马克没有回话。他从公文包里掏出一沓文件，在上面勾勾画画。

Debate Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, allow me to introduce the first debater of the day, Pedra Paul Gonzalez Rosa.
主持人： 首先，向各位介绍第一位嘉宾，佩德拉·保罗·冈萨雷斯·罗萨。

Debate Moderator: Graduated from the Law School of the University of São Paulo, he is a member of the committee and more importantly, the challenger of the debate.
主持人： 他是圣保罗大学法学院的毕业生，担任联合委员会的委员要职，更重要的是，他是本次辩论的发起者。

Pedra lifts the curtain and steps onto the stage.
佩德拉掀开后台的帘幕，走了出去。

Debate Moderator: The other debater of the day is the delegate of the House of Integratus, Mark Hal. Over the past ten years, he has served the Foundation by drafting countless acts and conventions.
主持人：辩论的另一方是共融院的代表人，马克·哈尔。他为基金会服务了十年，为我们起草了不可计数的法案与公约。

Debate Moderator: The topic of the debate today, *Storm Reformation: Manpower and Discipline*, is exactly a work of his.
主持人：本次引发辩论的草案《暴雨改革：增员与秩序》正是出自他的笔下。

Not one seat has been left empty around the debate stage.
辩论台下方座无虚席。

Foundation Chamber
基金会议事厅

Madam Z's eyes follow Mark as he walks into the lights on the stage with a big smile.
Z 女士看到马克带着灿烂的笑容走上台前。

The people on the stage are greeting each other. Madam Z takes off her glasses and wipes them again.
台上的人们在寒暄。她褪下眼镜，重新擦拭了一遍。

The chamber is filled with noises. The confrontation between the two sides in her blurred vision is a scene she has seen many times.
喧嚣在大厅中回荡。模糊的视野中，两方对垒的情势，一如她以往熟稔的画面。

Debate Moderator: Alright, both sides are seated.
主持人：两位都入座了。

Debate Moderator: Before we start the debate officially, I suggest we give Mark the draft writer an opportunity to introduce the draft.
主持人：各位，在我们展开正式讨论之前，我建议先给起草人马克介绍草案的机会。

Debate Moderator: Would you please, Mark?
主持人：马克，你愿意代劳吗?

Delegate: With pleasure.
代表人：乐意至极。

Delegate: *Storm Reformation* and its advocators believe in such a goal:
代表人：《暴雨改革》展望一个这样的目标：

Delegate: In this ever changing environment smitten by the "Storm," this draft will help the Foundation win the trust of a considerable number of arcanists who have different backgrounds and abilities, in a more efficient and stable way.
代表人：在“暴雨”肆虐，变数不断的环境里，用这项法案为基金会更高效地，更稳固地笼络住一群背景各异，才能兼备的神秘学家。

Committee Member I: That is exactly where I must raise an objection.
委员 I：这正是我要提出异议的地方。

Committee Member I: The draft has a huge risk which Mark Hal has not realized at all.
委员 I：该草案存在一个巨大的风险点，而马克·哈尔根本没有意识到。

Delegate: No, sir. I totally understand what you're trying to say.
代表人：不，先生。我明白你要说什么。

Delegate: You have put forward several questionable arguments to prove Vertin's suspicion of disloyalty.
代表人： 你们特意挑选了几个可疑的论点，以证明维尔汀居心不良。

Delegate: In response to that, please allow me to invoke the following cases to prove Vertin's competence for leading the unregistered arcanists.
代表人： 那么，请允许我援引案例，来证明维尔汀足以担任编外神秘学家领袖。

Delegate: Please turn to page 373 of Vertin's personnel file. As you can see, since Vertin became the Timekeeper, the number of unregistered arcanists she has rescued so far is, 63.
代表人： 人才档案第 373 页，记录了维尔汀任司辰以来救援的基金会外派人员数量：63 位。

Delegate: That is a number unmatched by that of anyone present. If that's not enough to prove her loyalty, let's continue ...
代表人： 数目远超在座的平均值。如果这不能论证她的忠心，那让我们继续——

Committee Member I: I have to say, Mark, you have completely misunderstood my point of view.
委员 I： 我就直说了，马克，你完全误解了我的观点。

Committee Member I: I don't care what Vertin has done.
委员 I： 我不关心维尔汀的作为。

Committee Member I: But the feasibility of the draft.
委员 I： 我关心的是草案的可行性。

Committee Member I: According to the existing regulations, the duties of educating and disciplining unregistered arcanists are taken by the School of Discipline.
委员 I： 根据现有规定，非登记神秘学家的教育责任由教管学校承担。

Committee Member I: While you suggested in the draft that Timekeeper's personal teaching would replace the current collective training ...
委员 I： 而你在草案中提出用司辰的个人教管替代集体训练……

Committee Member I: Have you ever thought about the budget that we could possibly spend on it?
委员 I： 你是否考虑过这方面的预算？

Committee Member I: The Foundation spends an alarming sum of money on education every year, and there is no way we pay extra for personal training.
委员 I： 基金会每年的文教支出数目惊人，不可能再为额外的个人教管买单。

Delegate: What, budget?
代表人： ——预，预算？

Delegate: Um, I don't see why we're talking about budget all of a sudden.
代表人： 呃，我不明白怎么会提到预算。

Delegate: Did you really read the draft? I didn't mention a word about budget ...
代表人： 你真的有看这本草案吗？我这里面没有一个字提到过预算……

Committee Member I: Of course you didn't, which exactly proves you have never realized the risk I just mentioned.
委员 I： 当然了。这证明了你确实从未意识到我所提出的这个风险点。

Debate Moderator: Oh, it seems the real topic of the debate has just surfaced.
主持人： 噢。看来本次辩论的主题现在才呼之欲出。

Debate Moderator: I believe everyone in the hall is looking forward to where it goes. So Mark, in terms of this point, we would like to know your real thoughts ...
主持人： 相信在座的各位都非常期待接下来的发展。那么，就这个观点而言，马克，你的真实看法……

Z: ...
Z: ……

She gets up, walking towards the entrance.
她起身，向外走去。

This is already a composition which the White would like to see.
这是执白子者所期望的局势。

Z: The Black stone is left there alone. That last move is also a defense in panic.
Z: 黑子已是落空之形，最后一着也是仓皇防守。

Z: If I were the player...
Z: 如果执子者是我……

She gazes into the air, lost in her thoughts. She doesn't feel the gaze cast upon her from another direction.
她出神地想着。没有察觉到不远处投来的视线。

Constantine is watching Madam Z from her corner.
康斯坦丁坐在角落里望着 Z 女士。

As Madam Z walks to the entrance, somebody stops her.
Z 女士走向门口，被人拦下。

A white item is handed to her.
有人将一封白色物什递给她。

And then ...
再然后——

She disappears as soon as she steps out of the hall.
Z 女士的身影便从门外消失了。

Constantine averts her eyes and looks back at the two debaters on the stage.
康斯坦丁收回目光，重新注视起台上针锋相对的两人。

As soon as she has left the hall, Madam Z takes out that white note.
离开会议厅，Z 女士重新掏出了那个白色的纸张。

Z: What is it?
Z: 这是什么?

Secretary Sharon: Sonetto asked me to give it to you personally.
秘书莎朗: 十四行诗委托我亲手交给你。

It looks like a simple, usual letter.
看起来是一封朴素的信。

"Dear Madam Z,
With this letter I send you my best regards."
“向您致意，Z 女士。”

"I have been instructed to manage affairs on behalf of Timekeeper during her treatment."
“司辰治疗期间，我受命代表司辰打理相关事务。”

"Please let me know if there are any missions to alleviate the situation. I will do my best to meet your expectations."
“如有任何缓解当下之局势的任务，烦请告知与我。我定不负所望，尽力而为。”

"Sincerely,
Sonetto"
“诚挚的十四行诗。”

Z: Good news.
Z: 是一个好消息。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 人工梦游使用规范

Trail ① Artificial Somnambulism Guidance 小径

Artificial Somnambulism Guidance (V2.0.16)
人工梦游使用规范（2.0.16 版本）

英文 / ENGLISH
— Welcome Panel - 00101PL —

Welcome to the dream, arcanist.

... To enter the examination dream [Investigator's Stamina & Athletic Performance] ...

Touch the tip of your nose with your left forefinger,
and press the spot above your heart with your right ring finger and middle finger.
Hold the position for 3 seconds. When you feel heat in your throat or the middle part of your spine,
press the start button. [0/0]

... To enter the examination dream [Investigator's Practice of Arcanum Knowledge & Incantations] ...

Press the tip of your tongue against the roof of your mouth and
imagine something that makes your anxious or worried as specifically as possible.
When there are goose bumps on your skin,
press the start button. [0/0]

... To enter the training dream [Custom Mental Stability] ...

Clench your fists 3-5 times,
push the green button upwards by 1 notch,
and press the start button. [0/0]

... To enter the status simulation dream [Conventional Insight Tour] ...

Hold the afflatus medium or the relevant books you need,
swallow the vanilla mint provided by the device,
and press the start button. [0/0]

— New Feature Panel - 00102PL —

How to use the joint training dream [Tactical Cooperation]:

1. Make sure the distance between the two joint training devices is less than 25m and they are not separated by any
aluminium wares;

2. Make sure the two devices have the same mode, enemy number, weather and terrain;
3. ...
4. ...
...
6. Choose a reasonable mode according to your conditions.

中文 / CHINESE

— 引导页·00101PL —

欢迎入梦，神秘学家。

… 进入[调查员体能与运动]考核梦境 …

请使用左手食指触碰鼻尖，
右手无名指及中指按压于心脏上方。
持续三秒，咽喉或脊椎中段感应到热感后，
启动按钮。[0/0]

… 进入[调查员神秘学与咒语运用]考核梦境 …

请使用舌尖抵住上腭，同时，
在脑中尽可能细致地描绘令你感到躁动或忧虑的画面。
当皮肤开始浮现鸡皮疙瘩时，
启动按钮。[0/0]

… 进入[自定义思维稳定性]训练梦境 …

请握拳 3—5 次。
后将绿色按钮向上推进一格，
启动按钮。[0/0]

… 进入[常规洞悉漫游]状态模拟梦境 …

请手持相对应灵感媒介或典籍，
吞服随仪器配置的香草薄荷糖，
启动按钮。[0/0]

— 新增功能页·00102PL —

《“战术协同能力”联合训练梦境启动规范》

1. 请保持联合训练仪器相差距离不超过 25 米，且中间无铝制品阻隔。
2. 请确保应战难度、敌人数量与气候背景设定一致后启动。
3. ……
4. ……
……
6. 请务必选择合理的挑战难度。

闪烁的红
Flashing Red 4TH-13

Flashing Red
闪烁的红

Lilya: Oh. You're also here?
红弩箭：哦。怎么，你也在这儿?

Sonetto hears her. She stops the practice.
听到招呼声，十四行诗停下了手上的动作。

Sonetto: Yes ... I am taking combat drills with the Artificial Somnambulism training system.
十四行诗：是的……我在用人工梦游训练仪进行战斗演习。

Lilya casts a sideways look at the screen in front of Sonetto. There shows her overall time length of practice.
红弩箭瞟了一眼显示屏，那里记录着总操作时长。

Lilya: Six hours ...
红弩箭：6 小时……

Lilya: I'm not the only one goofing around.
红弩箭：看来闲得发慌的不止是我一人。

Sonetto: No, I'm not. I am not goofing around.
十四行诗：不，没有。我并没有闲得发慌……

Sonetto: I am waiting for orders.
十四行诗：我在等候命令。

Her face flushes scarlet.
十四行诗的脸涨得通红。

Lilya initiates the machine in front of her, unaware of her awkwardness.
红弩箭启动了面前的机器，没有注意到十四行诗情绪的变化。

Lilya: Well, much luckier than me.
红弩箭：那你比我幸运得多。

Lilya: I have so many things to bitch about ... "One who plays hooky." Have you heard it? Literally me.
红弩箭：我可是憋了一肚子的牢骚……“游手好闲的木杓粗坯”，听说过吗？说的就是我。

Lilya: I should have turned down the offer when they promoted me to the Foundation headquarters. They don't have any field missions for a flying witch ...
红弩箭：当初就不该升调到基金会总部。身为飞行女巫，居然没有任何外出作战的机会……

Sonetto: Is it because of the provisions of *Talent Protection*?
十四行诗：是因为《人才保护》的规定吗?

Lilya: Only God knows.
红弩箭：鬼知道是什么理由。

Lilya: *House Arrest* may be a better name.
红弩箭：我看规定不如改名叫《囚犯软禁》好了。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

She throws a casual glance at the screen.
红弩箭满不在乎地望向了显示屏。

Lilya: ...
红弩箭：——

Lilya: Look, since we're both bored to death, do you want to have a try at some difficult things?
红弩箭：我说，反正我俩也没事可做，要不要挑战一个高难度的东西?

Sonetto: What is it?
十四行诗：是什么?

Lilya: Hm, this.
红弩箭：喏，这个。

She pouts her lips, hinting at something which she thinks should be obvious to both of them.
她鼓了鼓嘴皮子，好像每个人都该理解她的暗示。

Lilya: Have you tried the Artificial Somnambulism joint training?
红弩箭：你没有试过人工梦游联合训练?

Lilya: Put on the helmet together, and switch to multiplayer mode ...
红弩箭：我俩同时戴上头盔，把旋钮调到“双人模式”……

Lilya: Two operators can take on a harder training mode ... more insane enemies ... Haha.
红弩箭：在并肩作战的条件下，就能选择危险度更高的训练……遇到更疯狂的敌人……嘿嘿嘿。

Lilya: Like playing in the arcade.
红弩箭：就像那些锹儿厅里的街机一样。

Sonetto stares blankly at Lilya as she operates the machines.
十四行诗一愣一愣地看着红弩箭在仪器上操作。

Sonetto: O-Okay. Shall I turn this red knob?
十四行诗：好、好的。是转这个红色旋钮吗?

She is a bit worried, not sure what to do; she has to imitate what Lilya just did.
她有点慌张地模仿了一遍。

And she murmurs ...
随后又小声地嘟囔了一句。

Sonetto: ... What is an arcade?
十四行诗：……什么是街机?

The floor starts to vibrate as the machine goes into function.
在仪器的影响下，地面传来了微微的震感。

The multiplayer mode has been initiated.
“双人模式”启动了。

Lilya: What did you say? I can't hear you with my helmet on.
红弩箭：你说什么——？我戴上头罩了，听不清。

Lilya: Whoo, nice controller. Good! I'm entering the zone now.
红弩箭：嗯，手感不错。很好，很好，感觉来了。

Lilya: It's been a long time. Why not have some fun?
红弩箭：好久没玩了，干脆整个刺激点的吧。

She quickly taps on some buttons, and the warning indicator on Sonetto's equipment suddenly flashes a red light.
她迅速敲打几个按钮，十四行诗仪器的警示灯变成了闪烁的红色。

Sonetto: The light is flashing ... What did you press?
十四行诗：这个灯在闪……你摁了什么?

Lilya: I switched it to the hardest mode! Haha! You better get it together!
红弩箭： 我把训练难度等级调到最高了！哈哈哈……这下我俩可得打起精神来了！

Sonetto: W-Wait ...
十四行诗： 等，等等——

But there's no time to "wait." Two words in big red font appear on the screen in front of them: DRILL STARTS.
来不及了。屏幕上出现了红色的大字：演习开始。

Lilya: Don't fail me, top student.
红弩箭： 优等生，别让我失望哦。

The helmet has cut off their vital fluids and diverted them to a pre-programmed battlefield. The operators' vision is about to change ...
在头罩的影响下，不可见的流体受到阻断，视野即将发生改变——

Sonetto: *breathing out* ... I am ... exhausted.
十四行诗： 呼呼……好……累。

Lilya: Ha ... Almost choking.
红弩箭： 啊，憋死我了。

They take off their helmets, slumping onto the floor together.
两个人脱下头罩，几乎是一致地跌坐到地上。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗： ……

Lilya: ...
红弩箭： ……

Their gloves are soaked in sweat.
汗水浸湿了手套。

They subside into momentary silence, looking at each other.
她们安静了几分钟后，下意识地望向对方。

They burst into laughter in high spirits.
接着，爆发出一阵欢快的大笑。

Lilya: Hahahahaha ... hahaha ... I haven't had so much fun for centuries!
红弩箭： 哈哈哈哈哈……哈哈哈……好久没有这么爽了！

Sonetto: Heh heh ... Hahaha ...
十四行诗： 呵呵……哈哈哈……

Lilya: How many times did we die?
红弩箭： 我们被打死了多少次?

Sonetto: Sorry, haha ... I cannot do math now.
十四行诗： 抱歉，哈哈……我也数不过来了。

Sonetto: My mind ... goes blank ...
十四行诗： 脑袋……一片空白……

Lilya: Hahahaha ... who would expect THE Sonetto would have a brain fade ...
红弩箭： 哈哈哈……怎么，你也有宕机的时候……

Lilya falls backwards, lying on her back, staring at the white ceiling with peaceful joy.
红弩箭干脆地往地上一躺，舒服地望着白色的天花板。

Sonetto leans on the wall, exhausted.
十四行诗则疲软地倚靠在墙角。

It was a fight of verve and vitality. All the noises that have been nagging them for days now seem to have disappeared.
酣畅淋漓的一战，让四周的喧嚷都消失了。

There are only breaths, the wind, and the smell of the concrete floor.
只剩下呼吸，风，还有混凝土的味道。

Lilya: ...
红弩箭：……

Lilya: Have you heard the result of the debate?
红弩箭：知道今天的辩论结果吗?

Sonetto: I heard that ... the number of people opposing the draft significantly increased after the debate.
十四行诗：我听说……辩论结束后，反对的人数增加了很多。

Lilya: Hm ...
红弩箭：嗯……

Lilya: It's not going well.
红弩箭：这可不是什么好趋势。

Lilya: Soon will be the voting session. The opposition is taking the lead.
红弩箭：已经临近投票表决时间了。反对党占据了优势。

Sonetto: ... I hope Ms. Druvis can hold out.
十四行诗：……希望槲寄生小姐他们能撑得住。

Lilya: You visited them?
红弩箭：看望过他们吗?

Sonetto: I submitted a request to enter that building ...
十四行诗：我提交过前往那栋楼的申请……

Sonetto: The system arranged guards to accompany me to ensure my safety.
十四行诗：系统为了保证我的安全，安排了守卫与我随行。

Sonetto: The moment they entered the building, they started sawing the trees ... saying that they need to carve out the path.
十四行诗：他们一进楼里便开始锯树……说需要开辟必经之路。

Sonetto: Since then ... I have not been there.
十四行诗：我……之后再没有去过了。

Lilya: Four and a half weeks. After that, they can't hold on for any longer.
红弩箭：槲寄生他们最多只能支撑四周半。

Sonetto: Really? In that case ... the vote result has to come out before that.
十四行诗：是吗？也就是说……投票必须在四周半内得出结果。

Sonetto is deep in contemplation.
十四行诗陷入了沉思。

Secretary Sharon: Hi, may the peace be with us.
秘书莎朗：你好，愿和平与我们同在。

Sonetto: ...!
十四行诗：……!

Sonetto: Hello! May the peace be with us.
十四行诗：你好！愿和平与我们同在。

Secretary Sharon: Do you mind giving us some privacy?
秘书莎朗：方便让我们两个独处一会儿吗?

Lilya: Do whatever you like.
红弩箭：嗯，随你们的便。

They walk to the break room in the hallway.
女士与十四行诗徐步至走廊茶水间。

Secretary Sharon: Here is Madam Z's message. Please visit her in the office on Friday.
秘书莎朗：我替 Z 女士传话。请你本周五去她办公室一趟。

Sonetto: Ah ... Okay. Copy that! Thank you for the message.
十四行诗：啊……好的，收到！多谢告知。

Secretary Sharon: With pleasure.
秘书莎朗：乐意效劳。

She nods and places her hand on her chest.
她点了点头，将手放到胸前。

Secretary Sharon: Wish you a good day.
秘书莎朗：祝你拥有美好的一天。

Secretary Sharon leaves the room at a quick trot.
秘书莎朗疾步离开了房间。

When Sonetto returns to her exercise equipment, she finds Lilya is about to leave the room.
等十四行诗回到训练仪旁时，发现红弩箭正准备起身离开。

Sonetto: Are you leaving?
十四行诗：你要回去了吗?

Lilya: Yes.
红弩箭：嗯。

She picks up her gloves and the canteen but hesitates. She pauses for a brief moment, then quickly turns back to Sonetto.
红弩箭拾起手套和水壶，沉默片刻，倏地回过头来。

Lilya: Do you know how the penalties for destruction of public property of the Foundation and brawl are determined?
红弩箭：毁坏基金会公共财物及私自斗殴的处罚是如何认定的，你知道吗?

Sonetto: ...?
十四行诗：……?

Sonetto: Well, according to *Measures of the Foundation for Administrative Penalties*, based on the severity of the circumstances, fines will be imposed and the offender's salaries shall be deducted accordingly in minor cases, while detention or expulsion shall be imposed in major cases.
十四行诗：唔，根据《基金会管理处罚法》和情节严重不同，轻则扣除罚金及薪水，重则处以拘役或除名驱逐。

Sonetto: The penalty also depends on what is damaged. For example, production tools, household goods, buildings, equipment, facilities, etc. These are the properties that involve less cost and limited influence if damaged.
十四行诗：认定方式有损坏对象的类型，如生产工具、生活用品、房屋、器材设备等，都属于涉及金额及影响较小的财物。

Sonetto: If the number of people involved in a brawl is equal to or less than eight, and there are no major casualties, the penalty will be minor.
十四行诗：如果私自斗殴的涉案人数小于等于 8 人，且未造成明显伤亡，则处罚从轻。

Sonetto: May I ask what happened? Why are you asking this all of a sudden?
十四行诗：请问，发生什么事了吗？为什么会突然问起这个呢。

Lilya: Nothing. As I said, bored to death.
红弩箭：没什么。闲得无聊罢了。

Lilya: So bored that I have been paying attention to the Foundation's regulations. Even the *Flying Manuals* failed to win this much of my attention.
红弩箭：我都已经闷到去研究基金会的规章制度啦。当年的《飞行手册》我都没看得那么认真。

She waves at her and leaves without looking back.
她摆摆手，头也不回地走了。

Lilya: So long, Sonetto. Hopefully there is good news for us next time I see you.
红弩箭：下次见，十四行诗。希望下次见面的时候，我们已经听到好消息了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

胜负手
All-or-Nothing 4TH-14

All-or-Nothing
胜负手

Delegate: We are falling behind even further. A vote or two won't help us turn this around ...
代表人：差距拉大了。仅凭一两张票也无法扳回局面……

Z: I know.
Z：我知道。

Z: The move to D9 was indeed useless.
Z：D9 确是一步庸着。

Delegate: The arcanists that were on our side have defected.
代表人：如今原本愿意支持我们的神秘学家，也转身投靠了反对阵营。

Delegate: I misjudged the situation in the debate ...
代表人：是我错估了形势，那场辩论……

Delegate: I was going to seize the opportunity ... and the initiative ...
代表人：我本想抓住机会……主动出击的……

She doesn't respond to him, only pacing back and forth in the room.
她没有回应，在房间内来回踱步。

Z: To seize the initiative ...
Z：主动出击……

Z: ... may bring us the chance.
Z：也未必有错。

Thirty-eight lines go across the board in horizontal and vertical directions, crossing one another in 361 intersections as orderly as the stars.
纵横三十八条线，三百六十一个交叉点，如星穹现于眼前。

Z: That is to say, don't pull back, don't jump ... even when they're attacking ...
Z: 换言之，面对对方的进攻，既不“退”，也不“跳”……

Z: But to focus on the bigger picture, to win strong positions ...
Z: 而是着眼于未来的形势，攻占阵地……

She seems to have a sudden flash of insights, and reaches out one of her hands without being aware of doing so.
她似乎有所顿悟，下意识地将手往前一伸。

Z: The Black ... tsuke.
Z: 黑子，靠。

Z: Then ... the White hane. And the Black counter hane here. The White stand, the Black ...
Z: 接着……白子扳，黑子反扳，白子立，黑子……

Z: Osae.
Z: 硬挡。

Z: ...!
Z: ……!!

Z: Through these moves ... I see.
Z: 如此这般……我明白了。

Z: The move to D11 can save us more than ten moku of stones.
Z: D11 的一子，能换回这里的十几目棋。

Z: We can still win within ten moves.
Z: 十步以内，我们还有胜算。

Z: Mark.
Z: 马克。

Delegate: Yes? Are there any other things we can do?
代表人: 怎么了？还有办法吗?

Z: We need an influencer. A leader who can win us more than ten votes.
Z: 我们需要一个有影响力的人，一个能为我们说动十几个人的领袖。

Z: Get me the files of the uncommitted leaders, including those who weren't neutral about this issue in the beginning.
Z: 给我找出所有没表态的多人领袖的档案，即使原本不是中立的也没问题。

Delegate: ... Okay.
代表人: ……好。

He seems perplexed, but still quickly retrieves the files and starts browsing them on the chair.
他虽然有些困惑，但仍然飞快地调出档案，在椅子上翻找。

The room is in complete silence except for the slight noise of flipping pages.
房内只听到翻书页的声音。

Delegate: Barzel.
代表人: 巴泽尔。

Z: No. Too young to be convincing.
Z: 不行，他资历尚浅，难以服众。

Delegate: Nonie, head of the Natural Resource Committee.
代表人: 诺妮，自然资源组委会的领袖。

Z: There are only three of them in the group.
Z: 她们组只有三个人。

Delegate: "Center" Bernard, leader of the Mankind Caucus ... Ugh, forget it.
代表人: “中锋”伯纳德，人类党团的领袖……呃，还是算了。

Z: Bernard?
Z: 伯纳德?

Z: Yes, he can be our man. He is eloquent and leads a group of 11. All of the 11 are his loyal followers.
Z: 不，这个可以。他善于雄辩，手下有十一号人，且每一位都对他十分信服。

Z: Why is he uncommitted? I thought he would be the first to vote.
Z: 他怎么会没有表态？我以为他会第一个投票。

Delegate: Perhaps they believe it's a sure bet ...
代表人: 或许是因为胜券在握……

Z: Find out what he's been up to.
Z: 了解一下他的近况。

Delegate: But Madam Z, are you sure you want to cooperate with him? This doesn't make any sense. We don't even serve the same group.
代表人: 可是，Z 女士，我们真的要和他合作吗？这太荒唐了，我们甚至在为不同的群体服务。

Z: Mark, we are all serving for the Foundation's future.
Z: ——马克，我们都是在为基金会的明天服务。

Z: I just want to know what he needs now.
Z: 我只想知道他现在需要什么。

Delegate: ...
代表人: ……

Delegate: The office in Chicago, U.S.
代表人: 美国芝加哥的办事处。

Delegate: He is trying to cover that region with his influence.
代表人: 他想把那块选区划入自己的势力范围。

Delegate: Bernard believes the employees there are guilty of serious dereliction of duty: they discriminate against humans of different classes and are suspected of committing electoral fraud in collusion with the local capitals.
代表人: 伯纳德认为他们管理失责，区别对待不同阶层的人类，且涉及与当地资本暗箱的违法行为。

Delegate: The Supreme Court's investigators have already intervened.
代表人: 最高裁判所已经派出相关人员介入了。

Delegate: But they cannot go out due to the "Storm" right now ... so the case is pending investigation.
代表人: 但由于“暴雨”的原因，无法外出取证……现在还没有定论。

Z: Chicago office ... I've read the reports on there ...
Z: 芝加哥办事处……我看过那里的报告……

Z: I see.
Z: 我了解了。

Z: Great. Exactly what we can help with.
Z: 太好了，我们正好能伸出援手。

Delegate: Through what?
代表人: 通过什么?

Z: Through Sonetto.
Z: 十四行诗。

Z: I have a meeting with her on Friday ...
Z: 我约了她周五见面……

Z: This may lead us to a win-win situation.
Z: 或许能为我们打开双赢的局面。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 高难演习
Trail ① The Hardest Mode 小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum
投机倒把和烂糖果

跑腿活
Legwork 小径

...
???: ……

选项 / Choices

1. I just woke up. What happened?
1. 我刚睡醒，发生了什么?

2. I have no trouble. Don't come over.
2. 我这里没有麻烦，你不用过来

分支 1 / Branch 1

That was a good sleep, dude. You drooled everywhere. Almost glued my eyelids.
???: 睡得不错，伙计，哈喇子甩得到处都是，差点糊住了我的眼睛。

You didn't expect there to be so many complicated, confusing factions in the Foundation—can't they just make this institution simpler so that people can tell one group from another easily, like telling the difference between cake layers?
???: 你没想到基金会里会有这么多复杂的团体，看起来让人一头雾水——他们就不能造一个简单的组织，让人们的区别就像蛋糕夹层一样清晰可见?

分支 2 / Branch 2

Really? Dude, are you 100% sure that you are trouble-free?
???: 是吗? 老兄，你能百分百地确定自己没有麻烦?

I was sleeping like a baby, having a sweet sweet dream which has been long absent in my life. There were three ladies, a bevy of goofy swans, and I, living a harmonious life together in my dream.
???: 我睡得正香，做了阔别已久的美梦。梦里我和三位女士，一群呆天鹅生活在一起，彼此相处融洽。

Suddenly, a certain jinx woke me up, saying, “I have no trouble. Don’t come over.” How wonderful! I was like a stray dog sleeping on a square. You’ll see, this old man is going to shovel all his complaints into your pure, innocent ear.
???: 突然一个倒霉鬼把我叫醒，告诉我这一切都还好，不需要我的帮助。真是棒极了！我就像广场上的一条狗！等着吧，接下来，糟老头子会把所有的牢骚话都塞进你纯真的耳朵眼里。

How do you feel about the structure of the Foundation? I can see your cockily raised neck, showing your attitude of rejection. Well, perfect! Let’s start with this intriguing topic, then!
???: 你对基金会的组织有兴趣吗？你骄傲的脖颈在表示抗拒——很好，那就从这个令人跃跃欲试的话题开始！

The Foundation is a mess. Listen up, it drifts along the chaotic swirl between order and disorder, enticing countless idealists and realists to come over.
???: 基金会很混乱。听好了，它始终在有序与无序的混乱间摆荡，吸引着无数理想主义者和现实主义者为它驻足。

The “Storm” exacerbates the chaos. Those arcanists who were snorkeling are now surfacing—You see, Ms. Z is a great example. She is even sitting at the same conference table with the human elites.
???: “暴雨”的到来，加剧了漩涡的混乱状况。神秘学家在水下浮潜，不断地往上涌现——你看，Z 女士就是一个很好的例子。她甚至与人类精英们平起平坐地待在同一张会议桌旁。

The undercurrents, however, are still lurking. Natural Resource Committee, Mankind Caucus, Culture and Education Department ... Their members are hard to differentiate given the intricate backgrounds. They bustled for benefits and mired in countless trivial matters.
???: 水面下有更多的暗流在波动。自然资源组委会、人类党团、文教部门……他们的成员相互交错，背景模糊不清难以辨认。他们不止是为了利益，也为了无数缠身的琐碎的烂毛线而忙碌。

You see? You need to divide them into groups, and divide and divide ... until you break a huge entity into small groups, as small as possible. That’s when they are able to clean the vomit on the living room floor effectively and emotionlessly!
???: 明白了吗？你得不断地分组分组分分分组——把一个大团体按目标拆成尽可能小的小团体，才能让他们最高效且不带任何感情地清理客厅里的呕吐物！

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Legwork
跑腿活

自灰烬中
From the Ashes 4TH-15

From the Ashes
自灰烬中

Follower I: Best wishes for the upcoming victory!
拥趸 I： 祝福这胜利在望的好日子！

Follower II: It will be the final vote soon. It's a stunning victory for us ... Cheers!
拥趸 II： 正式表决日马上就要到了。我们大获全胜……干杯！

Bernard: Cheers! May the peace be with us!
伯纳德： 干杯！愿和平与我们同在！

The group is fully immersed in the joy brought by the collective glory.
一群人正沉浸在集体的荣誉中。

Z: You're in a good mood.
Z: 兴致不错。

Follower I: ...!
拥趸 I：……！

Bernard: Z?
伯纳德：Z 女士?

Follower II: You must be in the wrong room.
拥趸 II：不会是走错房间了吧。

Follower II: You can't find those friends who tell balderdash here.
拥趸 II：我们这里可没有那群会胡言乱语的朋友。

Bernard stops them with a wag of a hand. He pushes his way through the crowd and comes up to her.
伯纳德挥了挥手，推开人群，走上前来。

Bernard: What brings you here, our honorable committee member?
伯纳德：什么事？居然能让委员大驾光临。

Z: May I have a word with you, Bernard?
Z: 借一步说话，伯纳德。

Bernard: Let me check my watch again. Hmm, it's three in the afternoon. I don't think I've drunk that much.
伯纳德：让我看看时间，嗯，现在是下午三点，我想我还没有喝醉。

Bernard: Could you repeat that again?
伯纳德：你能再重复一遍刚说的话吗?

Bernard: You want me, to canvass, for you?
伯纳德：要我为你拉票?

Z: To be more precise, to form a partnership.
Z: 准确的说，是建立合作关系。

Bernard: My my, what a creative idea.
伯纳德：喔，喔。一个非常有创造力的想法。

Bernard: What can you offer?
伯纳德：你打算提供什么条件?

Bernard: Not supporting such a stupid draft next time?
伯纳德：下次不再支持这样一项愚蠢的法案?

Bernard: Or recruiting new arcanists for our caucus?
伯纳德：还是要帮我们党团招募神秘学家新人?

Z: What about a witness for the case of Chicago office?
Z: ——或者是为《芝加哥办事处审查案》提供证人。

Bernard: ...
伯纳德：……

He instantly frowns.
在这一瞬间，他的眉头皱了起来。

Bernard: Who is it? Give me the name.
伯纳德：哪个证人？告诉我名字。

Z: I will if you collaborate with me.
Z: 除非你愿意合作。

Z: Or talk to me with a better attitude.
Z: 或者是换一个更友好的态度跟我说话。

Bernard: ... I'm sorry.
伯纳德: ——很抱歉。

Bernard: Our philosophies have always been different, and that led to prejudice.
伯纳德: 我们一直在为不同的理念服务，难免出现态度上的先入为主。

Bernard: But being mysterious won't show us sincerity for each other, right?
伯纳德: 但是打哑谜会阻碍我们看到彼此的诚意。不是吗?

Z: A staff of mine is willing to testify as a witness. Her report can prove your point.
Z: 我有一位下属愿意出席作证。她的报告里记录了能证明你观点的内容。

Bernard: Strong enough to prove their negligence?
伯纳德: 足够证明那群人失责吗?

Z: It depends on the special prosecutor.
Z: 不一定，要看检察官的想法。

Z: But the evidence is strong enough to prove that you're innocent from setting up others out of your personal interest.
Z: 但足够证明你没有因个人利益诬告陷害他人。

Bernard: ...
伯纳德: ……

He can't help breaking into laughter.
他哑然失笑。

Bernard: Looks like you've got your own little bird.
伯纳德: 看来你也有自己的小小鸟儿。

Bernard: The management there sucks. They don't serve humans or arcanists. They are just puppets manipulated by money.
伯纳德: 那里的管理烂透了。他们不是为了人类，也不是为了神秘学家，他们只是金钱的傀儡。

Bernard: I wanna bring order back to that place.
伯纳德: 我想要重整那里的秩序。

Bernard: And I've collected quite a lot of evidence against them.
伯纳德: 为此我收集到了不少证据。

Bernard: Yet the most ridiculous thing happened: in the second week after I submitted the investigation application to the Supreme Court ...
伯纳德: 但可笑的是，在我向最高裁判所提起审查的第二周——

Bernard: The evidence was gone.
伯纳德: 它们就不见了。

Bernard: My men found their charred pieces in the garbage room ... Someone threw them into the shredding incinerator.
伯纳德: 我的下属在垃圾房里找到它们焦黑的碎片……有人将它们丢进了高温碎纸机。

Bernard: It was like I could do nothing but surrender.
伯纳德: 仿佛我除了投降，别无选择。

Z: You have a wolf by your ears ... I understand.
Z: 骑虎难下……我能理解。

Bernard takes a deep breath before he starts to talk again.
伯纳德深吸了一口气。

Bernard: But you're asking for too much.
伯纳德: 但你的要价太高了。

Bernard: Eleven votes? We're on the opposite side. I can never persuade all of them to vote for you.
伯纳德: 十一个人？我们是相反的阵营，我不可能说服所有人去为你投票。

Bernard: Besides, the court session of the Chicago case starts later than the final vote ...
伯纳德: 更何况庭审时间晚于正式表决时间……

Bernard: Don't tell me you want the service before you pay for it.
伯纳德: 你不会打算先收货再付钱吧?

Z: Don't worry. You can vote after testifying.
Z: 不会，你可以等我们作证以后再去投票。

Bernard: How are you gonna do that?
伯纳德: 你打算怎么做?

Z: I will do what I can, in my power.
Z: 用我的身份做一些力所能及的事情。

Z: The vote won't start so soon.
Z: 投票表决不会这么快开始。

He raises one eyebrow.
伯纳德挑了挑眉毛。

Bernard: I can try for nine votes ... or ten.
伯纳德: 九张票……或者十张。

Bernard: For the appreciation of your political resourcefulness.
伯纳德: 作为我对你政治手腕的欣赏。

Madam Z holds the hand waiting in front of her.
Z 女士回握住他的手。

Z: Good luck making a better Chicago office, Bernard.
Z: 期待你将芝加哥办事处变得更好，伯纳德。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

击球点
Contact Point 4TH-16

Contact Point
击球点

Unlike the other days, Constantine isn't by her desk today.
与往日不同，康斯坦丁没有坐在办公桌旁。

The light in the room stays off.
房间内没有开灯。

She has her back to the door, facing the window. Daylight slowly permeates into the dark room through the rigid marble windows.
她背对着门，正望着窗外。窗栏硬挺，日光缓慢地漏入屋中。

Committee Member I: It's Pedra.
委员 I： 我是佩德拉。

Constantine: Come in.
康斯坦丁： 请进。

Committee Member I: I'm here to report the situation so far.
委员 I： 我来汇报今日的情况。

Committee Member I: Some neutral parties have tilted in favor of the draft.
委员 I： 有部分中立的群体倒戈了。

Constantine: How many?
康斯坦丁： 数量有多少？

Committee Member I: Not a lot of them, but enough to make the votes even.
委员 I： 不多。但总数加起来，足以使我们双方的票数不相上下。

Committee Member I: They have always pursued revolution in the Foundation. Looks like Mark has finally persuaded them.
委员 I： 他们一向支持基金会变革，看来代表人马克终于说服了他们。

Committee Member I: I heard Ms. Z has been working hard on canvassing, too.
委员 I： 听说，Z 女士最近也一直在各方游说。

Constantine: ...
康斯坦丁： ……

Committee Member I: But the number of the conservatives remains the same. We don't have to worry about that.
委员 I： 不过，保守派的人数没有变化，这点我们可以放心。

Committee Member I: I believe we will still prevail in the final vote days later.
委员 I： 几天后的表决，我相信我们仍能占据上风。

Constantine: What about the other groups?
康斯坦丁： 那些大小不一的党团群体怎么样了？

Committee Member I: Still functioning as usual, nothing special.
委员 I： 都在正常运作中，没什么出格的动作。

Committee Member I: By the way, Bernard and his men paid a visit to SPDM. I didn't get to talk to them.
委员 I： 对了，伯纳德他们前往第一防线学校探访了，我没联系上他们。

She turns back to face the window.
康斯坦丁又将椅子转向了窗外。

Constantine: Thank you for the report.
康斯坦丁： 感谢你今日的汇报。

Committee Member I: ...
委员 I： ……

Constantine: She has never been so persistent.
康斯坦丁： 她从来没有这么坚持过。

Constantine: Do you know why she's been so different this time, Pedra?
康斯坦丁：你知道这次是为什么吗？佩德拉。

Sports Field of the SPDM
第一防线学校运动场

Committee Member Ⅱ: I didn't realize you had time to invite me to play table tennis.
委员 Ⅱ：没想到你还有空来邀请我打乒乓。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Or ... are you actually here to lobby, Madam Z?
委员 Ⅱ：还是说……你其实也是来游说我的？Z 女士。

Z: Heh heh ... I'll say both, Katz.
Z：呵呵，两者都有吧，卡兹。

Z: Back then when I was a student, I'd often invite my classmates to play ping-pong after we left the laboratory.
Z：以前我每次离开实验室，都会喊上同学打几局乒乓。

Z: A cold shower after getting soaked in sweat is a piece of memory I can't forget.
Z：浑身是汗后再去冲个冷水澡……那段时光，让我记忆犹新。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Heh heh ... you remind me of the old days in the table tennis varsity.
委员 Ⅱ：呵呵……你这话让我想起以前在乒乓球学生代表团的日子了。

Committee Member Ⅱ: You're the only one I can practice with here.
委员 Ⅱ：现在在这里，也就只有你能陪我练练手了。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Serve it, Madam Z.
委员 Ⅱ：发球吧，Z 女士。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Let's compete.
委员 Ⅱ：让我们比试一局。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Hahaha ...! Backhand chop? Great, great.
委员 Ⅱ：哈哈哈……！反手削球？很好，很好。

She nimbly picks up the white ball and bows.
她迅速拾起白色的小球，俯下身子。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Again. Ready to go!
委员 Ⅱ：再来，准备好了！

Z: Hey!
Z：嘿！

Committee Member Ⅱ: Nice shot!
委员 Ⅱ：好球！

Madam Z strikes. The little ball flies over the net in an extremely low parabola, and goes into the unguarded corner of the table.
Z 女士挥动球拍，小球以极低的弧度跃过球网，撞向无人的桌角。

Katz turns her body to one side, striking the ball back confidently.
卡兹迅速侧身，稳稳地回了过去。

Z: We're planning to revise some articles in the draft.
Z：我们打算修订草案中的部分条款。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Which articles?
委员 Ⅱ：什么条款？

Z: The articles about strengthening the control of registered arcanists.
Z: 加强对已登记神秘学家管制的条款。

Z: You're right. We do need to improve the credibility of the Foundation in the outside world.
Z: 你说得对，我们应该提高基金会在外的信誉。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Tell me more.
委员 Ⅱ：说说看。

Z: The Timekeeper's power to discipline should be transferred back to the School of Discipline and the Foundation.
Z: 我们计划将司辰的教管权力交回给教管学校与基金会。

Z: The Foundation will conduct a unified risk assessment on arcanists.
Z: 由基金会对神秘学家进行统一的风险评估。

Z: To ensure this team is always under control.
Z: 确保这支编外队伍的风险水平始终在我们的掌控之中。

Committee Member Ⅱ: But in fact it still belongs to the Timekeeper, right?
委员 Ⅱ：但是实际的编制仍然是归属于司辰名下吧?

Z: That is our minimum requirement and it will not change.
Z: 这是我们的根本要求，这点不会变化。

Committee Member Ⅱ: Heh heh ...
委员 Ⅱ：呵呵……

Committee Member Ⅱ: I didn't expect you to compromise.
委员 Ⅱ：没想到你们会做出让步。

Z: It's not a compromise. It's a reasonable amendment to the draft.
Z: 这不是让步，卡兹。这是针对草案做出的合理的改良。

Z: Transferring the power of education and discipline to the Foundation will help lower the budget and reduce the pressure on Vertin.
Z: 转移管教权力，对降低预算和维尔汀的压力都有帮助。

Committee Member Ⅱ: And you would even lobby an opponent, me, for this amendment.
委员 Ⅱ：你的改良里甚至包含了来游说你的对手——我。

Z: A reasonable appeal shouldn't be rejected just because it is raised by a different faction.
Z: 合理的诉求不会因发声的阵营不同，便有所褪色。

Z: The Foundation needs solidarity, not contradiction.
Z: 我认为基金会需要的是团结与联合，而不是对抗与斗争。

Z: If the draft is meant to pass, I will do whatever I can to make it meet most expectations.
Z: 如果这份草案注定要通过，我将尽我所能，让它满足大多数人的期望。

Z: Just like this ping-pong game ...
Z: 如同这场乒乓球比赛一样……

Z: Friendship first, competition second.
Z: 友谊第一，比赛第二。

Z: Legislation shall serve the people.
Z: 位于人群之中，才是立法的根本。

Committee Member Ⅱ: You have my vote, Madam Z.
委员 Ⅱ：这张选票是你的了，Z 女士。

Z: Heh heh ... A vote is not the only thing I need, Katz.
Z: 呵呵……我需要的，可不止是一张选票，卡兹。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 球类游戏
Trail ① Ball Game 小径

Ping, pong. Ping, pong. Ping pong ping pong ping, pong. Ping. Pong.
???: 乒、乓、乒、乓、乒-乓乒乓乒、乓。乒。乓。

选项 / Choices

1. It's too noisy.
1. 太吵了

2. An imitation show?
2. 一场模仿秀?

分支 1 / Branch 1

Yup. Agreed.
???: 嗯。我同意。

It's too noisy. You were looking at the little ball made of plastic. It hops from left to right, making an annoying sound.
???: 这太吵了。你看见那个合成塑料制成的小球儿，它蹦蹦跳跳，从左到右，发出恼人的声响。

But all we can do to it is look at it, just like all you can do to me is tolerate my existence, for both of us have nowhere to go.
???: 可我们只能看着它，就像是你只能忍受我。因为我们都无处可去。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Yes, an imitation show. A ball imitation show, little thing.
???: 是的。模仿秀。球类模仿秀，小东西。

You're imitating the Messiah, while I'm imitating an orange ball made of plastic.
???: 就像是你模仿着救世主一样，我模仿着一颗合成纤维塑料制成的橙色小球儿。

Being pushed back and forth by two rackets, I have nowhere else to go. Once they apply a force on me, I can't help bouncing to the sky. You can see how the air flows across my dry, wrinkled skin ...
???: 我在两个球拍之间左右颠倒、无处可去，它们给我施加力，我就高高跳起，跳跃造成的气流如何拂过我干燥的发皱的皮——

Oh, what a coincidence! Aren't you in the same situation as mine now!
???: 哦——瞧瞧，这真是太巧了——这也是现在的你！

Ha! Look at your frowning face—
???: 哈！瞧瞧你这家伙皱起眉头的样子——

Your face wrinkles from the eyebrows to the nose tip, but people can barely see those light furrows. We know what that means. You have a poker face, and it's never your fault.
???: 纸张一般的脸儿从眉头到鼻梁都皱起来，纹路很少，痕迹很浅。我们都知道这代表着什么，表情少可从来都不是你的错。

But for now, your face is not the thing that matters. Well, maybe for someone it is, but still, it's not.
???: 但现在你的脸不重要，或许对于有些人来说它很重要，但它还是不重要。

You know what really matters?
The game! Yes, it's the game, of course the game matters!
???: 你知道什么是真正重要的吗?
——球赛，对，是球赛！当然是球赛！

Everyone loves the game. They gather at the stadium, yelling or roaring vehemently. They choose one team to become its fan and spend good money on a team uniform or an autographed ball.
???: 所有人都爱球赛，他们聚在一起，慷慨激昂地欢呼或是怒吼，他们选择自己喜欢的球队，花大价钱买队服或是签名球。

Yet, it's just a ball. You see where I'm coming from?
???: 但——那只是一枚球。你能理解我的意思吗?

Just a ball. Its outline, a circle, could be found in any geometry textbook and anywhere in this world.
???: 只是一枚球。一个几何图像中常见的圆形。一个世界中并不难见的轮廓。

When the first hominid picked up a coconut and threw it to the sky—and caught it—and threw it—and caught it—and threw it again, when she felt joy and yelped, had she ever thought of the future?
???: 当第一个原始人捡起椰子，上下抛——接——抛——接——抛并从中感到愉快，咯咯叫唤的时候，他想过今天吗?

The future where a simple ball has become so complicated and enchanting, now we call it the present.
???: 让一颗简单的球，变得如此复杂而充满奥妙的今天。

选项 / Choices

1. Complicated and enchanting?
1. 复杂而充满奥妙?

Hahahahahaha! Yes, sure! Complicated and enchanting!
???: 哦！当然！复杂而充满奥妙！

Use your silly and smart head to think about this ball game carefully.
???: 动动你愚蠢又机灵的小脑瓜，再去仔细看看这场球类游戏。

The complex scoring rules, the harsh requirements for reactive agility, the countless possible foul points ... Your fingers, your wrists, and arms, a correct way of using them will lead to victory!
???: 它有复杂的计分规则、对反应能力的严苛考验、无数种可能犯规的落球点，从手指，到手腕，再到手臂，正确的发力会为胜利帮上大忙！

What matters more is, like every ball game, it focuses on how you serve the ball and hitting it back.
???: 更重要的是，与所有球类运动相同，它的重点在于抛和接。

It's not an easy job as it sounds. When you are in the game, you need to concentrate. Where will the ball come from, and how will you return it to your opponent—you need to figure that out within half a second.
???: 这不是个简单的活计，当你参与其中，你就得全神贯注。那颗小球从哪儿向你飞来，你要如何将其送回，一切都发生在半秒之内。

Use your power in a proper way, move your feet in a stable pace, inhale and exhale at the right timings.
???: 适当的力道、精巧的小动作，脚下不能乱了拍子，找准呼吸的节奏。

Ping. Pong. Ping. Pong. Ping. Pong. Ping. Pong ...
???: 乒。乓。乒。乓。乒。乓。乒。乓……

The sound will last forever and ever until that bouncing little thing falls to either side of the court.

???: 直到那个不断四处弹射的小东西落在其中一方的阵地之前，这个声音将永恒地持续下去。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Ball Game
球类游戏

小径② 公平竞赛
Trail ② Fair Play 小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum
投机倒把和烂糖果

暗处的回声
Echoes in the Dark 4TH-17

Echoes in the Dark
暗处的回声

Days later
数日后

Foundation Chamber
基金会议事厅

Chairwoman: Constantine.
主席：康斯坦丁。

Constantine, sitting behind the rostrum, looks up. She takes off her reading glasses and closes the book in her hand.
坐在主席台后的康斯坦丁抬起了头。她摘掉老视镜，合上手中的书本。

Constantine: Has the voting started?
康斯坦丁：开始表决了吗?

Constantine: You see, here is the number of votes I have estimated. The pro-drafts will lose by five votes to their opponent.
康斯坦丁：你看，这是我刚推算出的票数，赞成方会以 5 票的落差败北。

Constantine: Don't forget our bet.
康斯坦丁：别忘了我们打的赌。

Constantine: The one who loses will pay for the new stamps.
康斯坦丁：输家要为这一季新出的邮票买单。

Chairwoman: The final vote is not today ... I'm afraid.
主席：今天……恐怕不能表决了。

She has a complicated look on her face.
她的表情有些复杂。

Chairwoman: Z's speech is still ongoing.
主席：Z 女士的演讲还没有结束。

Chairwoman: She has just started the part on Article 3, Section 5 of the rules of procedure ...
主席：她才刚刚开始提及议事规则的第三点第五条……

Chairwoman: But the speech has already lasted seven hours.
主席： 但演讲已经持续了 7 个小时了。

Chairwoman: Even some delegates have left.
主席： 有些代表人都离席了。

Constantine: What ...
康斯坦丁： 什么……

She smiles, surprised.
她惊讶地笑了。

Constantine: A filibuster?
康斯坦丁： 冗长演说吗?

Chairwoman: Yes, and Katz's speech will be right after that.
主席： 是的，卡兹也准备上场演讲了。

Chairwoman: So I guess the final vote won't start until tomorrow.
主席： 我估计正式表决明天才会开始。

Constantine: ...
康斯坦丁： ……

Chairwoman: That won't make a difference. Delaying the vote won't change the result.
主席： 她们这么做的意义不大，拖延战术并不能动摇投票的结果。

Constantine sighs.
康斯坦丁叹了一口气。

Constantine: *sighs* We don't know yet.
康斯坦丁： 也不一定。

Constantine: I didn't expect that she would be trying so hard.
康斯坦丁： 没想到她会这么努力。

Constantine: But for me, this is not necessarily bad news.
康斯坦丁： 但对我来说，这也不算是个完全的坏消息。

Constantine: The filibuster will only have two outcomes.
康斯坦丁： 冗长演讲一旦开始，草案就只有两个结局。

Constantine: It is either one of the parties wins over two-thirds of support and gains victory, or both parties get stuck in a tug of war.
康斯坦丁： 一方获得三分之二的支持从而赢得胜利，或是双方开始一场漫长的辩论拉锯战。

Constantine: If this tug of war doesn't end with a clear outcome, the *Storm Reformation* will end up completely dead and forbidden to be discussed within five years.
康斯坦丁： 拉锯战没有带来明确的结果，《暴雨改革》就将成为一份完全的废案，五年内不得重审。

Constantine: Are the stakes ... getting too high?
康斯坦丁： 这个代价……会不会太大了?

Someone trots over from the doorway. As he comes up to them, he bends over so that only Constantine can hear him.
有人从门口一路小跑过来。他弯下身子，确保只有康斯坦丁能听见。

Chief of Staff: Madam Vice President.
幕僚长： 副会长。

Chief of Staff: Mr. President came back from the Pax House.
幕僚长： 会长从鸽子屋回来了。

Constantine: ...!
康斯坦丁：……！

Constantine: I will go see him now.
康斯坦丁：我去和他见一面。

Chief of Staff: He is waiting for you in the office.
幕僚长：嗯，他在办公室等您。

It has been over a year since they last met.
已经有一年没有见到会长了。

Constantine quickly trots along the hallway.
她在走廊上急匆匆地走过。

The window is clear enough to give reflections. She stops and fixes her collar.
窗上映出她的倒影。康斯坦丁停下，对着玻璃理了理衣领。

The door is left half open.
那扇门是虚掩的。

Constantine: Mr. President ...
康斯坦丁：会长……

Constantine: Good day to you, sir. May the peace be with us.
康斯坦丁：向您致意。愿和平与我们同在。

President: May the peace be with us.
会长：愿和平与我们同在。

Constantine: Are you feeling better these days?
康斯坦丁：您的身体好些了吗?

President: I can still hang in for a few years. Thank you.
会长：尚能坚持几年，多谢关心。

Constantine: Are they doing alright?
康斯坦丁：他们怎么样了?

President: Just as usual. Nothing to worry about.
会长：一如往常，没什么好费心的。

He gives Constantine a small wave in the shadow.
他在阴影中向康斯坦丁招了招手。

She walks up to him.
康斯坦丁走上前去。

President: I'll stay in the Foundation these months.
会长：这几个月我会待在基金会。

President: The agenda is well arranged.
会长：议程我已经让人安排好了。

President: There is something more important that I must tell you in person.
会长：有件更重要的事情，需要当面跟你说。

Constantine nods, and bends over to listen.
康斯坦丁点了点头，蹲下身来。

The shadow of the president casts on her.
会长的影子叠在她的耳后。

The rusty, feeble words are difficult to catch, but the meaning of every word makes her eyes wide open out of shock.
暗哑的、微弱的声音几不可闻，但每一个字的含义都令她睁大了眼睛。

Constantine: ...!
康斯坦丁：……！

Constantine: This, is their judgment?
康斯坦丁：这是，他们的……判断?

President: Yes.
会长：是的。

Constantine: ...
康斯坦丁：……

Constantine: Then ... I have no objection to it.
康斯坦丁：那么……我也没有异议。

She slowly resumes standing, then retreats for a few steps and almost falls on the floor.
她缓缓地站起身来，又不住地退了几步，差点跌倒。

President: Hold tight, my friend.
会长：站稳脚跟，我的朋友。

She supports herself by the file cabinet.
她扶住了一旁的柜子。

Constantine: Excuse me.
康斯坦丁：请原谅。

Constantine: I have to admit I was surprised.
康斯坦丁：不可否认，我确实很意外。

Constantine: Thank you for telling me this.
康斯坦丁：很高兴您能向我转告这则消息。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 与火共舞
Trail ① Dances with Fire 小径

Look at where you are. Paulina also once stood here.
???：看看你的脚下，保利娜也曾如此站在这里。

选项 / Choices

1. Who is that?
1. 那是谁?

A human. A member of the St. Pavlov Foundation.
???：一个人类。一名圣洛夫基金会的成员。

She started from here, took 33 steps and a half, turned left, opened the door, and then turned right, went on for another 5 meters. She stopped and opened the historical intelligence cabinet.
???：她从这里起步，再走三十三步半，左转，开门，右转，前进五米，打开了历史情报柜。

选项 / Choices

1. What was she like?
1. 她是个怎么样的人?

2. Why was she there?
2. 她为什么去那儿?

分支 1 / Branch 1

Human-like. A standard human. Grave-looking, rational-thinking, efficient-acting.
???: 人类。一个标准的人类。严肃、理性、高效率。

She was digging in the files. The only touch of bright color on her was across her neck—a blue polka dot scarf, tied in the French way.
???: 她正在翻找档案。身上唯一鲜亮的颜色落在脖子上。一根蓝色波点丝带，以法国人的方式系着。

The scarf was there to cover up a nevus on her skin. A lonely, dark spot that lacks a symmetric counterpart on the other side of the neck. It's a mark too random and out of place to exist. She did not like it.
???: 那下面藏着一颗痣。它歪向一侧，太随机了。她不喜欢这样。

分支 2 / Branch 2

For work, sweetheart. Most of the actions we took in most of the time were for our jobs, or for the sake of getting one.
???: 为了工作，亲爱的。我们大部分时间做大部分事都是为了工作——或是为了能有一份工作。

She's a good employee, the kind of person who sincerely wishes to contribute to society. Her dedication to work equally applied to events as big as maintaining peace and matters as trivial as looking through old files.
???: 她是个好员工，打心底里希望为社会贡献出自己的力量。从维护和平，到翻找档案柜，她都能认真对待。

It was the 1931 file, or the 1935 one. She hasn't gotten there yet. But there is another folder which has caught her attention.
???: 1931 年的，或是 1935 年。她暂时还没找到。但另一个文件夹引起了她的注意。

On December 28, 1932, on the wonderful Day of the Holy Innocents in Mexico, 13 arcanist high school students attacked the crowd during the nighttime celebration.
???: 1932 年 12 月 28 日，美丽的墨西哥愚人节，13 名神秘学家高中生在夜间庆典间发起了一场恐怖袭击。

They claimed the oracle had uttered to them, from the inside of a gigantic Cordia elaeagnoides, that they had to shoulder the responsibility to protect the people.
???: 他们声称自己从一株巨大的巴西黄金檀中听见了神谕，他们必须肩负起守卫所有人的责任。

So they took their wands and knives, carried bottles of potion of concocted Picric acid and Nitrocellulose and walked into the festival market like any regular happy young people.
???: 于是年轻人们携带着自己的术杖、尖刀、苦味酸与火棉临时拼凑起的调和魔药混入集市。

Their attack led to 17 deaths. Six were injured, among which four were disabled for life.
???: 并由此造成了十七人死亡，六人受伤，其中四人落下终身的残疾。

One young girl among the attackers couldn't physiologically stop her hysterical laughter even when she was under arrest. She quivered convulsively, with her hands twitching tightly on 31-cm-long pruning shears.
???: 其中一位年轻姑娘在被捕时仍维持着生理性的狂笑，她抽搐的同时，双手仍旧紧握着一把长达 31cm 的园艺剪。

She kept muttering the word “Bocote,” which is the common way to call the Cordia elaeagnoides among the lumber dealers. In the Aztec Civilization, it means “giant mouth.”
???: 她反复念叨着“巴克蒂”[Bocote]，木材商们也是如此称呼巴西黄金檀的。在阿兹蒂克文化中，这个单词意味着“巨大的嘴”。

“Any mouth can talk”—in this case of mass hysteria, this was the one true rule.
???: “嘴当能言”——群体性癔症中，这便是可信的铁则。

Hysteria, madness, paranoia, hearing voices or seeing things ... these abnormalities are the sparks flying in the air, and arcanists are like dry cotton. The encounter of the two ... will cause a fire.
???: 癔症、癫狂、疑神疑鬼、幻听与幻视，这些危机就像是火星，而神秘学家如同干燥的棉絮。只等他们相遇……火，就会燃烧。

Paulina complained quietly. She accused the danger of fire, the risk of heat. One can hardly hold no grudges against the flame, when it is hidden next to you, patiently waiting.
???: 保利娜小声地抱怨起来。她控诉火的危险，火的灼热。当你随时会被焚烧，你很难不憎恨火焰。

She started to mutter something of a more extreme nature. She was carried away—forgot that each individual has their own right even in a collective body. She forgot what public opinion can do to subtly influence a community. Her eyes were fixed on the scarlet flame.
???: 她开始嘀咕一些更过激的东西。她忽视了大集体中的个人，忘记了社会对群体潜移默化造成的影响，只顾着看向赤红色的外焰。

Racist thoughts crept silently into her blonde-haired, beautiful head, like a cunning centipede.
???: 种族主义就像是狡猾的千足虫，悄无声息地钻进她那颗漂亮的、密密匝匝长着金发的脑袋里去了。

Fortunately, this is not yet the end of the story. Paulina still had her chances to change.
???: 但好在这不是故事的结尾，保利娜仍有改变的可能。

选项 / Choices

1. To change?
1. 改变?

Change. Yes. An alteration. Everybody has to change.
???: 改变。对，改变。人人都得改变。

You can improve your living standards. Pay for prettier white clothes, drive around in a limo painted in bright pink—anything to prove that you are as much of a man as those tough warriors in ancient Europe!
???: 你可以变得更好，好到穿起更漂亮的白衣裳，开一辆加长林肯，喷满风骚的粉色油漆——只为了证明你和那些古代欧洲硬汉一样勇敢！

Or you can try the bitter side of life. A life so bad that every weekend, you have nowhere to go but lie on a couch hollowed out by your dog and pick your nose. You pick it hard, just to locate and take out the hardest, largest booger that irritates your nasal membranes to stop the endless sneezing.
???: 也可以变得更坏，坏到在每一个周末无处可去，只能躺在被狗掏烂了的沙发上用力地抠鼻孔，只为了找到那颗最硬、最大、最让你鼻腔粘膜瘙痒难耐的鼻屎，好结束永无止境的喷嚏。

The change of Paulina started from a question.
???: 而保利娜的改变，是从一个问题开始的。

A senior staff of the Foundation walked to her, flipping through the pages of the same folder, and asked, "But Paulina, how are you going to deal with the fire?"
???: 更年长一些的基金会职员走向保利娜，继续翻动那本文件夹，她问：“可是保利娜，那你该如何对待火?”

On the next page, the survivors started a new life under the supportive measures, and the crazy children have left their poor family, leaving the violence and harassment behind, and moved into a sanatorium with white walls.
???: 下一页，幸存者的家庭在扶持下重启新生活，而那些癫狂的孩子们则是离开贫穷而又充满暴力与骚扰的家庭，住进了有着白墙的疗养院。

The record of the follow-up visits showed that they have stayed mentally stable since. They learned to calm themselves and overcame drug addiction and alcohol abuse. Some of them were even married.
???: 他们在跟访记录中保持了长期的稳定，他们学会冷静，戒掉了药物成瘾与酒精。他们之中已有人结了婚。

Between the last two pages, there lies a thank-you letter. The names signed at the end of the letter went on for two lines, and the last name ends with a cheerful strike going up, like a smiley face.
???: 最后一个夹页中，感谢信的署名弥了漫长的两行，最后一个单词的笔触愉快地上扬，如同一张小小的笑脸。

“The fire is always there, Paulina. We need to find a way to live with it, not to extinguish it.”
???: “火只是存在，保利娜。我们应当做的不是熄灭火种，而是与其共存。”

“Keep them somewhere safe, like a high shelf, and away from the fuel. Watch over the temperature. Maybe teach them to burn in a manner that no one, including themselves, would be hurt.”
???: “将其放在安全的高处，使其远离引燃物质，管控它们的温度，甚至于教会他们如何不会伤害自己与他人的‘燃烧’。”

“Division and confrontation have never taken this world to a better place, have they?”
???: “分裂与对立从来都不能让世界变得更好，不是吗?”

They went on talking for a bit more—about the responsibilities of this job, about personal liabilities, about hatred, about the minorities, about the practices that ought to be taken to realize ideas.
???: 而后，她们又聊了许多——关于公职责任，关于个人责任，关于仇恨，关于少数族群，更关于身体力行。

Young Paulina had changed. Drops of tears seep out from the bottom of that pair of beautiful green eyes.
???: 小保利娜完成她的转变。那双漂亮的人类绿眼珠子下头拧出了几颗泪滴。

I shed tears with her, of course. Sadly, I was busy sucking the flavoring powder on chips off my fingers and missed the right moment to wipe those tears off my face.
???: 我当然同她一起潸然泪下，但我那时忙着嗦手指上的薯片调料粉，没法子好好地为如此感人的戏码抹上一把泪。

Nevertheless, this is my favorite episode ... We should watch it again! Ahem ...
???: 无论如何，这是我最喜欢的一集——让我们再重播一次！咳、咳咳……

... Look at where you are. Paulina also once stood here.
???: ——看看你的脚下，保利娜也曾如此站在这里。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Dances with Fire
与火共舞

幼犬的道路
Road of a Puppy 4TH-18

Road of a Puppy
幼犬的道路

Sonetto: As witness?
十四行诗：去做证人?!

Z: Yes. Your report means a lot to him.
Z: 是的。你的报告对他相当重要。

Sonetto: I ... I can provide the report, but I have no experience in court hearings ...
十四行诗：我……我可以提供报告，可是我没有任何出席庭审的经验……

Sonetto: If I say something wrong, will it affect the special prosecutor's decision?
十四行诗：如果我说错话了，会影响检察官的判决吗?

That's an unexpected question. Madam Z's voice turns gentle and soft after a moment of speechlessness.
Z 女士愣然，半晌，声音变得敦厚柔和。

Z: Sonetto, testifying is not taking exams. The court doesn't need a skillful witness.
Z: 作证不是考试，十四行诗。法庭不需要一个熟练的证人。

Z: Just honestly tell them what you saw. Focus on the point and don't distort the facts.
Z: 你只要诚实地说出你的见闻就好，不避重就轻，不歪曲事实。

Z: The Supreme Court ... they value the sense of justice of the youth.
Z: 最高裁判所他们……很看重年轻人的公义之心。

Sonetto: Sense of justice ...
十四行诗：公义之心……

Z: And that's a noble quality you have.
Z: 你拥有这项宝贵的品质。

Sonetto: I will do my best, Madam Z.
十四行诗：我会尽我所能，Z 女士。

The meeting room
基金会委员会会议室

Special Prosecutor: Call the witness.
特别检察官：传唤十四行诗。

Entangled by the crowd, Sonetto walks into the court.
在人流的裹挟下，十四行诗走进会议室。

In front of her, the special prosecutor has an almost godlike solemn look on her face.
坐在对面的特别检察官神色庄严，庄严得仿佛——来自另一个世界。

Sonetto: Greetings. May the peace be with us.
十四行诗：您好，愿和平与我们同在。

Special Prosecutor: May the peace be with us.
特别检察官：愿和平与我们同在。

Special Prosecutor: Sonetto, as informed by the subpoena, you have been called forth by the accuser, Bernard Wilson, to testify as the witness in court. Could you specify the relationship between you and the accuser?
特别检察官：十四行诗小姐。如传票所述，伯纳德·威尔逊申请你作为证人出庭，能否介绍一下你们的关系？

Sonetto: We did not know each other. I heard of him at work, but we rarely worked together.
十四行诗：我们并不认识。我在工作中听说过他的名字，但鲜有交集。

Special Prosecutor: Then why did he call you?
特别检察官：那他为什么会指派你作为证人？

Sonetto: I was one of the parties involved in the 1929 "Storm" incident. I submitted a detailed report of that. He searched the database and found the report, so he made a request for access to my supervisor, Madam Z.
十四行诗：我是二九年暴雨事件的当事人之一，提交过一份详细的事件报告。他在资料库里检索到报告后，向我的领导 Z 女士提出了查阅申请。

Sonetto: Then, Madam Z asked if I would be willing to provide the report and attend court as witness.
十四行诗：因此，Z 女士询问我是否愿意提供报告及出庭作证。

Special Prosecutor: Could you tell me the reason why you agreed to testify?
特别检察官：能告诉我，你接受出庭作证的理由吗？

Sonetto: I ... My immediate supervisor is having a long-term treatment, and there are more time slots available on my schedule.
十四行诗：我……我的直属上司正在接受长期治疗，我的工作日程较以往宽松了不少。

Sonetto: I am happy to be able to make a difference during the time, and defend the established facts.
十四行诗：我很高兴能在这段时间里有所作为，为已知的既定事实辩护。

Sonetto: More importantly ...
十四行诗：更重要的是……

Sonetto musters her courage and presents a box of files on the desk.
十四行诗像鼓足了勇气似的，将一盒文件匣放到桌前。

Sonetto: I, personally, believe that there is still much room for improvement for the Foundation's office in Chicago in the United States.
十四行诗：我，我个人认为，基金会美国芝加哥办事处仍有极大的改善空间。

The special prosecutor seems slightly surprised.
检察官有点诧异。

Special Prosecutor: What is this? Ms. Sonetto.
特别检察官：这是什么？十四行诗小姐。

Sonetto: This is a record of all my travels from the time I received the promotion order in the research center to go to the office in Chicago in the United States, to the time I went back to the headquarters of the Foundation when the "Storm" came.
十四行诗：这是我从调研中心收到升职命令后前往美国芝加哥办事处，到“暴雨”来临，我回到基金会总部的所有出行记录。

Sonetto: This is the field report and diary I wrote about the "Storm" in 1929.
十四行诗：这一份是我所编写的二九年暴雨事件实地调查报告和日记。

Special Prosecutor: What point do you make?
特别检察官：你想证明什么呢？

Sonetto: I would like to prove that the Foundation's office in Chicago in the United States violated the declaration "Fight for the Peace and Order of Mankind" and the rights of some humans and arcanists.
十四行诗：我想证明，基金会美国芝加哥办事处违背了“为人类的和平秩序而战”的宣言，侵犯了部分人类和神秘学家的权利。

???: You are tarnishing our reputation!
???：你在玷污我们的名誉！

Someone leaps to his feet on the other side of the table.
会议桌的另一侧有人猛然站了起来。

He is the assigned director of this constituency, the defendant of this court.
他是该选区的现任总部负责人，法庭上的被告。

The Defendant: I request a debate duel. I won't allow her to distort the truth like this.
被告人：我要申请辩论决斗。我不能允许她这样的歪曲事实。

Special Prosecutor: Mr. Seth, I haven't checked these files yet.
特别检察官：赛斯先生，我还没有开始审查这些材料。

Special Prosecutor: Silence, please.
特别检察官：请维持法庭的肃静。

The Defendant: Your Honor, you can examine the files one by one while we're having the debate duel.
被告人：检察官大人，您可以在我们辩论决斗的时候一一审查材料。

The Defendant: I can't bear to see the long history of our office slandered in this way by a newcomer. I demand a duel with her.
被告人：我不能忍受办事处这么多年的历史被一个初出茅庐的新人这样污蔑。我要求与她当面对决。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Special Prosecutor: Sonetto is an investigator with rich combat experience. There is no good dueling with her.
特别检察官：十四行诗是有多次作战经验的调查员，与她决斗没什么好处。

The special prosecutor turns to Sonetto.
检察官转向十四行诗。

Special Prosecutor: Do you accept the debate duel?
特别检察官：你愿意接受辩论决斗请求吗?

Sonetto: I have no objection, madam.
十四行诗：我不反对，检察官大人。

The defendant's neck has turned scarlet out of anger.
被告的脖子涨红了。

The special prosecutor stands up and raises both of her arms.
检察官站起身来，展开双臂。

Special Prosecutor: Please, to the stage, duelists.
特别检察官：两位，请走上台前。

Special Prosecutor: The debate during your duel will be faithfully recorded.
特别检察官：你们在决斗中的辩论内容，我会如实记录。

Special Prosecutor: Three defeats in the debate of one side will end the duel.
特别检察官：有任何一方三次辩论失利，决斗将会终止进行。

Special Prosecutor: You have the floor now.
特别检察官： 现在，请开始——

Sonetto: Schneider ... a friend we met in Chicago.
十四行诗： 斯奈德……我们在芝加哥认识的朋友。

Sonetto: She once chose to join the Foundation under the pressure of both the "Storm" and Manus Vindictae.
十四行诗： 她曾在“暴雨”和重塑之手的双重压力下，选择投靠基金会。

Sonetto: But instead of offering any solution or help, you just gave her a rejection letter.
十四行诗： 但你们没有提供任何解答和帮助，只是给了她一封拒信。

Sonetto: I found this letter in her suit pocket.
十四行诗： 这封信是我从她的西装口袋里找到的。

Sonetto: It had a small line written on it, "Paupers f**k off."
十四行诗： 上面写了一行小字：“穷鬼滚开。”

The Defendant: I-I had completely no idea what this was about ...
被告人： 我，我根本不知道这是怎么回事……

The Defendant: Not to mention the fact that no one at the office had ever heard of the "Storm" ... What help could they offer?
被告人： 更何况办事处的人都没听说过“暴雨”……他们能提供什么帮助?

Sonetto: In this particular case, you should have reported to the headquarters or to the investigators out there, instead of doing nothing but leaving an insult.
十四行诗： 针对这类特殊情况，理应上报给总部或在外的调查员，而不是写下一句侮辱的话，无所作为。

Sonetto: I do not understand ... why there was such wording on it.
十四行诗： 我不明白……上面为什么会写着这样的字眼。

Sonetto: Was it because she did not pay enough "shelter fee" to qualify for sheltering?
十四行诗： 是因为没有给够“庇护金”，所以没有申请避难的资格?

Sonetto: Or was it because the wand she used was transformed by arcanum, which made you think she was an arcanist?
十四行诗： 还是因为她使用改造术杖，让你们误以为她是神秘学家?

Sonetto: Does not the Declaration of Peace say "Everyone, strong or weak, rich or poor, of any race, deserves a helping hand so that the existing peace and order shall be maintained"?
十四行诗： 难道和平宣言，不是“不论身强体弱，富有贫穷，种族区别，都应施以援手，以维护现行的和平秩序”吗?

The Defendant: ...
被告人： ……

Sonetto: They were humans. If only they had made it to the headquarters sooner ... maybe ... they ...
十四行诗： 他们是人类。如果他们能早点回到总部……或许……

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗： ……

Special Prosecutor: In the particular circumstance at present, it's impossible for the headquarters to take in humans from all over the world.
特别检察官： 现在是特殊情况，总部不可能接纳全世界的人类。

Special Prosecutor: But you bring out a possibility, a possibility better than anything that happened.
特别检察官： 但你提出了一个可能性——一个比已发生的事实更好的可能性。

Special Prosecutor: Thank you very much for your testimony, Ms. Sonetto.
特别检察官：非常感谢你的证词，十四行诗小姐。

Special Prosecutor: And also for the debate, Mr. Seth.
特别检察官：同样感谢你的辩论，赛斯先生。

The special prosecutor and the jury get up, gathering the papers on the desk.
检察官和其他陪审团站起来，开始收拾桌面的文件。

Sonetto's ears are gradually cooling off.
十四行诗耳朵的潮热正在消退。

Sonetto: I seemed to be ... too emotional just now ...
十四行诗：我刚才好像……太激动了……

She passes the hallway, feeling completely lost.
十四行诗怅然若失地走过长廊。

She feels the court session is not over, and she is still in the middle of the storm.
她感到自己还没有从那场庭审中走出来。

Special Prosecutor: Ms. Sonetto.
特别检察官：十四行诗小姐。

The special prosecutor stops her from behind.
检察官在身后叫住她。

Special Prosecutor: You brought us a great debate.
特别检察官：你带来了一场精彩的法庭辩论。

In the bright daylight in the hallway, Sonetto finally takes a good look at the special prosecutor.
在走廊明朗的日光下，十四行诗才看清对方的模样。

This is quite an extraordinary face.
那是一张不同寻常的脸。

White, hard, and of a skin texture different from any creature's.
白皙，坚硬，异于任何一种生物的肌理。

Special Prosecutor: Have you heard of the Supreme Court?
特别检察官：你曾听说过最高裁判所吗?

Special Prosecutor: You should come when you are free.
特别检察官：有空可以来看看。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 似曾相识

Trail ① 小径

Déjà Vu
既视感

英文 / ENGLISH
An undefiled scale,
Sitting high up in the hall of judgement,
with the listening ears, the sniffing nose, the watching eyes,
the raising brows, and the speaking mouth.

Being the well-polished, the bright, the spacious,
it is the dazzling daylight itself.

It is the carrier of a noble virtue,
as untouchable as the feathers on a bird's throat,
as unsullied as the unexplored snowy ground,
as undisturbed as the ripple-less milk in the glass.
I trust myself, that I have encountered such whiteness before, sometime, somewhere.

中文 / CHINESE

一杆洁净的天秤，
悬挂于你所见的明堂，
耳、鼻、目、眉、口。
光洁、亮堂、开拓，白如昼日。

它带着某种高洁的品质，
如同雀鸟喉领生着羽毛，
如同从未有人踏足的雪地，
也如同早餐杯里无波的乳液。
我想，
我一定曾见过这种白，
在某时，在某处。

棋盘一角
A Corner of the Board 4TH-19

A Corner of the Board
棋盘一角

Constantine: I was told you have something important to share?
康斯坦丁： 听说你有重要的事情要告诉我?

Chairwoman: Yes, the filibuster is about to end.
主席： 没错，冗长演讲快要结束了。

Chairwoman: Z told me they are going to end the speech and apply for the official vote at noon.
主席： Z 女士通知我，他们打算在今天中午终止演讲，申请进入正式投票表决程序。

Chairwoman: If you are going to continue with the debate, don't forget to send your men.
主席： 如果你打算继续辩论，别忘了安排人上台。

Constantine doesn't reply. She glances at the delegates on their seats.
康斯坦丁没有回话，她扫了一眼坐在席位上的代表人们。

Constantine: Do you see Bernard over there?
康斯坦丁： 你看到伯纳德了吗?

Chairwoman: Yes.
主席： 看到了。

Chairwoman: Quite a lot of his men attended today.
主席： 今天他们党团的出席率很高。

Chairwoman: They have remained uncommitted to Storm Reformation so far. I thought they wouldn't bother to attend ...
主席： 他们一直没有对《暴雨改革》草案表态，我以为他们根本不会出席……

Chairwoman: The opposition side doesn't need a dozen more votes to win, after all.
主席： 毕竟反对票也不缺那十几张。

Constantine: But the advocates of the draft do.
康斯坦丁： 但是赞成党却很需要。

The chairwoman casts an eye on her, perplexed.
主席困惑地看了她一眼。

Yet Constantine doesn't intend to explain.
康斯坦丁似乎并不打算进一步解释自己的言论。

She looks weary.
她看起来很疲惫。

Constantine: There will be a new draft given to you in two hours.
康斯坦丁： 两小时后，我会交给你一份新的修订草案。

Constantine: I brought together a revision group last night with some hired experts. We have adjusted some of the articles in the previous draft.
康斯坦丁： 我昨晚成立了一个临时修订小组，和聘请的专家通宵修改了草案中的一些条款。

Constantine: I will need you to present it to everyone when the time comes.
康斯坦丁： 届时请务必将新草案公示给所有人看。

Chairwoman: What for?
主席： 你为什么要修改草案?

Chairwoman: Is their draft going to be adopted?
主席： 难道草案会通过吗?

Constantine: ...
康斯坦丁： ……

The chairwoman looks ghastly. She can't help but ask again to confirm her suspicion.
主席的脸色变了。她忍不住又问了一遍。

Chairwoman: The draft is going to be adopted, isn't it?
主席： 草案会通过，是吗?

Constantine: ... There are things that even I cannot manoeuvre.
康斯坦丁： ……有些事情，就连我也无法干预。

Constantine: All I can do is bring benefits to as many people as possible.
康斯坦丁： 我只能尽可能地满足大多数人的利益。

Constantine: I have specifically made some amendments to the clearance to educate and discipline unregistered arcanists in section 3 on page 21, as well as the duties and obligations of the Timekeeper's special team in section 1 on page 40.
康斯坦丁： 我专门针对第二十一页第三节非登记神秘学家的教管权限与第四十页第一节的司辰队伍的责任义务内容进行了修改。

Constantine: Every arcanist assigned to the Timekeeper's department will be put through the Foundation's risk assessment and graded accordingly.
康斯坦丁： 所有纳入司辰编制的神秘学家，都需要统一经过基金会的风险评估，根据结果划分等级。

Constantine: Ordinary arcanists only need to receive primary Artificial Somnambulism training. The more extraordinary ones will be sent to the School of Discipline for re-education.
康斯坦丁： 普通的神秘学家，只需要参加初级人工梦游训练即可。较为异常的神秘学家，则需要送入教管学校学习。

Chairwoman: Delegate Mark also submitted another edition which was quite similar to this one.
主席： 代表人马克也提交了一份修订草案，修改内容与这个很接近。

Constantine: Is that so?
康斯坦丁： 是吗……?

She chuckles. It is a half-relaxed and half-bitter smile.
她轻松地，有些失落地笑了起来。

Constantine: Heh heh, well ... very well.
康斯坦丁： 呵呵，那很好……很好。

Constantine: I'm pleased we have reached a consensus even before we meet.
康斯坦丁： 很高兴我们在未曾谋面的情况下达成了共识。

Constantine: Here are more things we have revised.
康斯坦丁： 我这里还有更多的修订内容。

Constantine: Given their resistance to the "Storm," the Timekeeper's special team will take up more work related to Manus Vindictae.
康斯坦丁： 考虑到司辰队伍对“暴雨”的抵抗性，他们将承担更多与重塑之手相关的工作。

Constantine: The Foundation will utilize their abilities.
康斯坦丁： 基金会需要更好地运用这支队伍的能力。

She sits down on her chair.
康斯坦丁靠着椅子坐了下来。

Constantine: We have also fine-tuned the details.
康斯坦丁： 还有部分的细节修改。

Constantine: They will be given more executive power, while the Foundation retains control over all things.
康斯坦丁： 开放更多灵活的，执行上的权力给他们，但宏观的掌控权仍旧要保留在我们手里。

Constantine: Remember, we have to make everyone aware of these changes before the voting starts.
康斯坦丁： 记住，一定要在表决开始前公示修订案。

Constantine: We have to make sure THIS version of the proposal is the one that gets the final approval in the end.
康斯坦丁： 确保我们最后通过的是这个案子。

Chairwoman: Understood.
主席： 明白。

The chairwoman looks up. Lights shed on her reading glasses and give out a bluish white color.
主席仰起脸来，灯光落在老花镜片上，泛着青色的光。

Chairwoman: Can't believe this is happening ... Heh ...
主席： 居然会是这样的结果……呵呵……

Chairwoman: The first revolution targeting arcanists in the past decades ...
主席： 几十年来，第一场针对神秘学家的变革……

Chairwoman: Don't forget my stamps for this quarter, Constantine.
主席： 别忘了给我准备好这一季度的邮票，康斯坦丁。

The right side of the hall is where the most eloquent people gather—the lecture area.
议事厅的右侧，是最为慷慨激昂的演讲区。

Madam Z stands on the podium. After the long speech lasting for days, she feels herself physically struggling to go on.
Z 女士站在讲台上，经过了数天的漫长的演讲，她的身躯已经逐渐乏力。

But her mind is getting clearer and clearer, more and more excited. Every cell in her body is ready to wake up at the very moment the voting starts.
但她的头脑却越发清醒，振奋，如同所有的细胞都做好了准备，要在表决开始的那一刻苏醒。

She looks at the rostrum. Constantine is sitting next to the chairwoman calmly.
Z 女士望向主席台，看到康斯坦丁平静地坐在主席的身侧。

That is a strange calmness.
那是一种古怪的平静。

So strange that she is almost certain that she is watching Constantine place a piece on the bottom-right corner of the board.
古怪到她以为自己看到了康斯坦丁将棋子放到了棋盘的右下角。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Z: Am I so tired that my eyes are failing me?
Z: 看来我已经累到出现错觉了。

Z: No. It's not the time to relax.
Z: 不，还不是松懈的时候。

Z: Just two more hours. Hang in there. It will end soon ...
Z: 最后再坚持两小时。很快，就要结束了……

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

重要说明
IMPORTANT NOTICE 小径

Interpretation of the Supreme Court concerning Some Issues on the Use of Filibusters
最高裁判所关于冗长演讲适用规则若干问题的解释

英文 / ENGLISH

Based on the current circumstances, this interpretation is hereby given in accordance with the relevant regulations and laws, in order to ensure the debates in the legislative process are carried out to serve its designated purpose, and the rights of the parties and interest groups involved are respected in the process.

Article 1 During the legislative debates, any member of the Joint Committee of the St. Pavlov Foundation who has doubt on the bill itself and requires explanation has the right to request an open debate from the chairperson. The chairperson in charge of the matter is obliged to accept this request.

...

...

Article 12 Within the 60 days of the legislative process and on the premise that all the parties are in compliance with the universally ratified Code of Conduct in the legislative period, both parties are entitled to an unlimited number of debates before the official voting on the bill and have the right to give up and withdraw from the debates.

Article 13 Termination of speech by either of the two parties will be considered as their

withdrawal from the debate. The debate will hence end and the voting on the bill will be initiated. If the other party requests to continue with the speech, the Supreme Court will approve the proceeding of the debate. The debate will then last until that party requests voting or withdraw from the debate.
Article 14 Had no conclusion been drawn within 60 days, the Supreme Court shall determine the bill to be repealed. Any repealed bill will not be allowed to re-enter the legislative process within the next 5 years.
Article 15 In 10 days after the debate starts, both parties involved will be allowed to request voting to end the debate.
...
Article 20 The filibuster is a special legislative process established for controversial issues. Any bill being put through the filibuster process will require two thirds of the votes of the Committee members' to pass. The Supreme Court will determine the bills which has less than two thirds of the votes to be repealed.
中文 / CHINESE
为正确实行立法中的辩论流程，依法保障参与人及团体的合法权益，根据有关法律规定，结合现实实践状况，制定本解释。

第一条　在立法辩论阶段，对议案本体持有疑义，尚无法得出结论的基金会联合委员会成员，有权向会议主席提请公开辩论请求，主席应予受理。

……

……

第十二条 在六十日期限内，符合立法辩论普遍遵循和认可的行为规范前提下，双方拥有申请无限次辩论及放弃辩论的权利。

第十三条 任何一方主动终止演讲，将被视为流程上的辩论弃权，即刻进入正式投票表决程序。另一方如若申请继续辩论，最高裁判所将认定辩论程序继续进行，直到该方申请投票表决程序或弃权。

第十四条 超出六十日期限而未得出结论的法案，最高裁判所可以认定为废案，五年内不得进入立法程序。

第十五条 辩论开始十日后，允许任何一方申请进入投票表决流程，根据在场投票结果裁定是否正式结束辩论。

……

第二十条 冗长演讲为解决争议而设，属特殊立法程序。在此程序中的议案，需在正式投票表决中获得三分之二的票数才允予成立。与此不符的议案，最高裁判所可以认定为废案。

草坪午餐

Picnic on the Lawn 4TH-20

Picnic on the Lawn
草坪午餐

Regulus: Ah ...
星锑：啊……

Regulus: Roast leg of lamb ... Wellington steak ...
星锑：烤羊腿……惠灵顿牛扒……

Regulus: Turkish kebab ...
星锑：土耳其烤肉……

Regulus: Ah ... I want meat ...
星锑：啊……好想吃肉……

Sotheby: Hmm? Are you hungry?
苏芙比：嗯？你肚子饿了吗？

Sotheby: Worry not, worry not. The leaves of the potatoes we planted have turned yellow!
苏芙比：别担心，别担心。我们在箱子里种的土豆的茎叶已经变黄了哦！

Sotheby: Ms. Druvis said this is the harvest time! Let's dig them out and make shepherd's pie!
苏芙比：槲寄生小姐说，这个时候就可以准备采收土豆啦～！我们挖出来给大家做牧羊人派吧！

Regulus: Potato? Vegetable? ... No. I don't want them anymore.
星锑：土豆？蔬菜？……不，我已经不想再吃这些东西了。

Regulus: I've been eating healthy salads for a month!
星锑：我已经吃了一个月的健康沙拉了！

Regulus: I want meat ...
星锑：我想吃肉……

Regulus: I want rich, juicy, meaty, sinewy, savory, sizzling meat!!
星锑：我想吃饱满，多汁，肉感厚实，筋肉弹脆的肉——！！

Regulus suddenly springs to her feet.
星锑突然一蹦而起。

Regulus: Wait! ... It smells so good. That's meat!
星锑：等等！……好香，我闻到了好香的肉味！

Regulus: Where's that smell coming from?
星锑：这是从哪里飘过来的味道？

Sotheby: Hmm ... I do smell something good as well ...
苏芙比：唔……好像是有一股香喷喷的味道……

Sotheby stands on tiptoe, seeking the source of the incredible smell.
苏芙比踮起脚尖，试图寻找香气的来源。

Regulus: I'll take a look!
星锑：我去找找看！

Regulus rubs her stomach, grabs her bag, and dashes out.
星锑揉揉肚子，背上她的背包就向外冲去。

Sotheby: Wait, Regulus! The critters' lair is over there!
苏芙比：等一下，星锑！那个方向住着好多魔精呀……！

Regulus: Critters?
星锑：魔精？

Regulus: Haha, no worries! Critter is a type of meat! Roast it over fire and a square meal is here!
星锑：哈哈哈，别担心！魔精也是一种肉！
用火烤一烤，美味不得了！☆

Regulus: Ah, it smells so good ...
星锑：啊，好香……

Regulus: It's over here ...
星锑：是在这边——

She has gone.
星锑的声音越来越远。

Sotheby: Oh no, what can I do ...
苏芙比：唔，这可怎么办……

Sotheby: Father said some critters could cause hallucination and diarrhea if eaten ...!
苏芙比：父亲说过，有一些魔精吃下去会出现幻觉和拉肚子的……！

APPLe: What's going on, Ms. Sotheby? Why are you here walking around alone?
APPLe：苏芙比小姐，发生什么事了吗？为什么一个人在这里兜圈呢？

APPLe floats in the air and looks around them.
苹果飘浮在空中，四下看了看。

APPLe: Em, where is Captain?
APPLe：船长怎么不在这里？

Sotheby: Oh, good to see you here!
苏芙比：呀，太好了，你们来了！

Sotheby: Regulus said she smelled meat ... and went straight to the forest to catch critters!
苏芙比：星锑说她闻到了一股肉香……所以跑去森林里抓魔精了！

APPLe: ... Waffle!
APPLe：……真糟糕。

APPLe: It has been too long since we last had Dr. Papper. Does Captain finally start to have a senior moment?
APPLe：太久没有喝到胡椒博士，船长终于开始犯糊涂了吗？

Druvis Ⅲ: Let's hurry over and take a look.
槲寄生：我们赶紧跟过去看看。

Druvis Ⅲ: The smell of food is unusual. It's verdant over there. There may well be other dangers lurking somewhere.
槲寄生：食物的气味不同寻常，那里草木丛生，很可能潜藏着其他的危机。

Regulus's figure appears among the trees.
树林阴翳中逐渐看到了星锑的身影。

The aroma of food has also become more intense.
那股食物的香气也越来越浓。

Sotheby: This is weird. Where on earth does the smell come from?
苏芙比：奇怪，这个味道到底是从哪里来的呀？

Regulus is also looking for the answer to the same question.
星锑似乎也在寻找香味的来源。

She looks down, scrabbling in the weeds. As she goes through them, the weeds unexpectedly shake, out of which springs up a black shadow.
她低下头，在草丛里翻找。草丛猛地抖动了一下，扑出了一只黑色的东西。

Regulus: Whoa!
星锑：哇啊——！

Sotheby: Blimey, it's a Carbuncle! Regulus, it's not edible!
苏芙比：呀！是卡邦克鲁！星锑，这种不能吃！

There comes another one.
接着又扑出了一只。

One after another, until Regulus has an armful of angry Carbuncles.
一只，接着一只。直到星锑的怀里抱满了愤怒的卡邦克鲁。

Druvis Ⅲ: That's the lair of Carbuncles. They've been stirred up!
槲寄生：那是卡邦克鲁的巢穴。它们被惊动了！

Regulus: Whoa ... a bumper harvest of critters ...
星锑：呜哇……魔精大丰收……

Regulus: Come and help!
星锑：你们快来帮帮忙！

APPLe: Hold on, Captain! We're coming!
APPLe：船长，撑住！我们来了！

Regulus: Oooh ... Are they really all inedible?
星锑：呜呜……这些，真的都不能吃吗?

Regulus: I did smell the sizzling meat ...
星锑：我明明闻到了喷香扑鼻的肉味……

Regulus: It's somewhere around here, right around ...
星锑：就在这附近，就在——

Lilya: Oh, hi.
红弩箭：喔，嗨。

Regulus: Whoaaaa—!
星锑：哇啊啊啊——！

Regulus: Who are you?!
星锑：你是谁?！

An athletic figure shows up from behind the bushes.
被拨开的树丛里站出一个强壮的身影。

Druvis Ⅲ: Lilya?
槲寄生：红弩箭?

Druvis Ⅲ: What are you doing here ...
槲寄生：你怎么会在这里……

Lilya throws her bag at their feet ...
红弩箭将肩上的背包往地上一扔——

A roasted leg of lamb, wrapped in tinfoil, falls out of her bag.
一块包在锡纸中的烤羊腿掉了出来。

Lilya: I got you something good.
红弩箭：我给你们带了点好东西。

Roasted pork knuckle, farmers sausage, black forest ham, some unknown drinks, leba bread, leba bread, and leba bread.
烤猪肘、农式香肠、黑森林火腿、不知名的饮料，还有列巴，列巴和列巴。

Regulus: Whoa—!
星锑：哇——！

Regulus pulls out the lamb as quickly as a flash and devours the meat.
星锑一个猛掏，将烤羊腿塞进口中。

Regulus: Ah! Lamb! It tastes so good ... sooo gooood! I barely know what grease is supposed to taste like ooooooh ...
星锑：啊！羊腿！好香……好香！我都快不认识油脂该有的味道了呜呜呜……

Regulus: *chewing* ... Thank the great god of rock for his blessings! This Pirate finally gets some meat to eat!
星锑：嚼嚼……感谢伟大的摇滚之神的保佑！本海盗终于有肉吃了！

Lilya: Huh? It is me you should thank, the goddess of victory who soon brings you freedom.
红弩箭：哈？你最应该感谢的是我，即将给你们带来自由的胜利女神。

Druvis Ⅲ: Bring us freedom soon? May I ask ... how should I interpret your words?
槲寄生：即将给我们带来自由？请问这句话……要如何理解？

Lilya: Heh heh.
红弩箭：呵呵。

Lilya sits down on the ground.
红弩箭一屁股坐在了地上。

She opens one of the cans and pours the drink into her mouth.
她拧开一瓶饮料，直往嘴里灌。

Lilya: You want some?
红弩箭：不打算来点么？

Druvis takes the drink from her and takes a sip.
槲寄生接了过来，尝了一口。

Druvis Ⅲ: Thank you so much for coming alone and providing us with supplies, Lilya ...
槲寄生：红弩箭，非常感谢你愿意只身前来，为我们提供物资支援……

Druvis Ⅲ: However, please tell us why you are here.
槲寄生：但请告诉我们，你为何会来到此处。

Druvis Ⅲ: ... Did Madam Z send you?
槲寄生：——是 Z 女士派你过来的么？

Lilya shakes her head. She gives out four fingers.
红弩箭摇摇头，伸出四个手指。

Lilya: Already been four and a half weeks. Right?
红弩箭：四周半，是这个时间对吧？

Lilya: This is not the first time I visit you guys here.
红弩箭：我不是第一次来这里看望你们了。

Druvis Ⅲ: ...!
槲寄生：……！

Druvis Ⅲ: The one hiding in the shadow last time ... It's you?
槲寄生：上次躲在黑影里的人……是你？

Lilya: I wonder how much longer you can hold on for Vertin.
红弩箭：我很好奇你们到底能为维尔汀坚持多久。

Lilya: You see, saying is one thing, fighting is another.
红弩箭：要知道，喊口号和上战场是完全的两码事儿。

Lilya: I've seen many deserters. Way too many.
红弩箭：我见过太多的逃兵了。

Lilya: Crying out loud, peeing their pants, drooling all over on their rabbit foot ...
红弩箭：哭爹喊娘，吓尿裤子，乱啃兔脚……

Lilya: But you guys are different.
红弩箭：但你们不一样。

Lilya: You actually did it. You conquered places in the Foundation, defended your own places, and put pressure on those in white till this day, the last day in this four weeks and a half.
红弩箭：你们竟然真的做到了。攻占阵地，守卫战线，向白袍子施压，一直到今天，一直到四周半的最后一天。

Lilya: That's the iron will I appreciate.
红弩箭：这是老子欣赏的钢铁精神。

Lilya: And if I didn't come today, would you eat your boots tomorrow?
红弩箭：如果我今天不来，你们明天不会打算去吃靴子吧?

Regulus: Of course not. We still have potatoes. Almost ripe.
星锑：当然不，我们还有土豆，都快收获了。

Sotheby: And carrots!
苏芙比：还有胡萝卜！

Lilya: Hahahahaha!
红弩箭：哈哈哈哈哈——！

Druvis Ⅲ: Thank you for your kindness, Ms. Lilya. May I take it that you are coming to bring us the good news?
槲寄生：承蒙你的关照，红弩箭小姐。我是否可以理解为，你是来为我们带来好消息的呢?

Druvis Ⅲ: Is there a final result for Madam Z's draft?
槲寄生：是 Z 女士的法案出结果了么?

Lilya: So far as I know, Madam Z hasn't given up yet.
红弩箭：据我所知，Z 女士到现在仍然没有放弃。

Lilya: Just like you, when she gets serious, she looks like a fierce doe.
红弩箭：她跟你们一样，认真起来，就像一头凶猛的鹿。

Lilya: But I already lost my patience.
红弩箭：但我已经没耐心等下去了。

Lilya: Tons of "processes" need to be done before it can be performed, even if the draft is passed at the final vote.
红弩箭：就算法案能在基金会通过，从确立到落地还有一堆繁琐的破流程要走。

Lilya: As long as Vertin is still on that bed in the ward, you are just an isolated island.
红弩箭：只要维尔汀还在病房里，你们就仍然是座漂泊的孤岛。

Lilya: Everyone can step on you.
红弩箭：任何人都有权利过来踩上一脚。

Lilya stands up and pats off the dust on her carelessly.
红弩箭站起身来，随意地朝屁股上拍了拍。

Lilya: "Take care of them for me when necessary."
红弩箭：维尔汀那家伙，送我伏特加时说了一句……

Lilya: That's what Vertin said when she gave me the vodka.
红弩箭：“必要时刻，帮我照看她们。”

Lilya: It's time to deliver on my promise.
红弩箭：是时候兑现我的诺言了。

Druvis Ⅲ: Are you going to do something dangerous?
槲寄生：你要做什么危险的事情吗?

Lilya: A thing that is worth the risk.
红弩箭：要做一件值得冒风险的事情。

Lilya: I've been waiting for this moment for so long.
红弩箭： 我期待这一刻很久了。

Lilya: Someone needs to wake up from the dream.
红弩箭： 有些人的梦，也该醒了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 聚光灯之外
Trail ① Outside the Spotlight 小径

The story has come to a new stage.
???: 故事发展到了新局面。

It is fascinating. It has plots of unwavering loyalty, survival from the jaws of death, and even a little bit of ... unconventional excitement!
???: 它很动人，充满了矢志不渝的忠诚，绝境得生的希望，甚至还掺杂了一点儿——一点儿离经叛道的刺激性！

Raise your head, and you will see this splendid spotlight grilling the top of our heads like a stove heating a frying pan.
???: 抬起头，我们的脑袋顶上已经被这盏辉煌闪耀的舞台灯照得发烫，像是炉子上的煎锅。

We mumble, and mumble, and mumble ... something like arcanists, new changes, perseverance, and the "Storm." Right, that's it! The "Storm"!
???: 我们的嘴里嘀咕着，嘀咕着、嘀咕着——嘀咕着神秘学家，嘀咕着新改变，嘀咕着坚守，嘀咕着“暴雨”。哦，没错，就是“暴雨”！

The "Storm" is no longer something new here. Everyone in the story talks about the "Storm." People don't find it attractive anymore.
???: “暴雨”在我们这儿早就不是新闻了，这故事里的人人嘴上都挂着这个词儿，人们早不觉得新鲜。

Once you turn the camera out of the spotlight, you'll see many other people on the stage. Many, many other f*****g people.
???: 一旦你把镜头转到聚光灯之外，就会发现舞台上站着许多人。许多许多**的人。

选项 / Choices

1. Who are they?
1. 他们是谁?

2. Where do they come from?
2. 他们从哪儿来?

分支 1 / Branch 1

The other actors. Actors who are different from you.
???: 另一些演员。和你们不一样的演员。

Their name won't be listed in the cast at the end of the movie. Not even a poor "St. Pavlov Squad Leader A."
???: 他们的名字不会出现在演职员名单中，甚至连一个可怜的“圣洛夫基金会小队长 A”都捞不到。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Neat question. People always need a place to come from.
???: 好问题。每个人都需要一个来处。

Then I will give you a neat answer as well, you inquisitive little thing. They came from their mothers' tummies. Can you understand it? Is it too difficult for you?
???: 那我也一样简单地回答你，充满了好奇心的家伙——他们从自己妈妈的肚子里来，你能理解吗？会不会太难了？

They're a bunch of people, a bunch of people just like you, though there are still differences between you and them. Open their bellies, and you can find everything that should be there—the liver, the stomach, the spleen, the lungs, and the heart.
???: 这是一群人。一群和你们一样的人。但这中仍有差距。打开他们的腹部，肝、胃、脾、肺、心一样不缺。

Their faces are clear to be seen. Look at them carefully, carefully. Oh, you might have met one or two of them.
???: 他们的面目很清晰，仔细瞧瞧——仔细瞧瞧。哦，其中那么一两个你也曾经见过。

They come from the same institution as yours, the St. Pavlov Foundation.
???: 他们与你来自同一个组织，光辉熠熠的圣洛夫基金会。

Eve from the France branch, La from the Egypt branch, and the Matryoshka from the Russia branch.
???: 法兰西分部的伊娃，埃及分部的拉，俄罗斯分部的套娃。

Oh right, your first friend made in a branch, that—that young man with a red nose—Ken! Ken from the Scotland branch. You looked here, you looked there, you couldn't find him anywhere, however hard you tried.
???: 对了，你最早认得的分部朋友，那个——那个年轻的红鼻子家伙，那个来自苏格兰分部的肯——但你左瞧，右看，你没有见到他。

选项 / Choices

1. Where did he go?
1. 他去哪儿了？

Good question. I'll help you find him.
???: 好问题，我会带你找到他的。

Let's keep looking around, but this time, vertically instead of horizontally. That's right! Upside vertical. Don't be afraid of that radiant spotlight, look there! Ignore the risk of blinding your eyes!
???: 让我们继续四处张望，放弃左右，瞧瞧头上——对，往上瞧！别怕那盏刺眼的舞台灯，尽管朝着要瞎了眼的方式去看！

And you see it. A white umbrella, bigger and wider than any umbrella you have seen. Those green flashes stinging your eyes is the price you have to pay for finding it.
???: 你瞧见了。那是一把白色的伞，比你见过的任何伞都要大，都要宽阔。而你的眼珠前刺痛的绿色光斑是你为此付出的代价。

The white umbrella is a shelter from the rain, saving that Orange-hair girl in white for you.
???: 这把白色的伞遮挡了许多雨水，为你留下了那橘红头发白衣裳的小姑娘。

And you have witnessed how people standing in the pouring "Storm" without shelter fade away.
???: 而“暴雨”倾盆而泄的地方，那些没有遮蔽的地方，你也亲眼见证过人们如何消逝。

Like your little friends, and Ken from the Scotland branch.
???: 就像你的小朋友们，也像是苏格兰分部的肯。

Remember the differences I just mentioned?
???: 还记得我说过的差距吗？

选项 / Choices

1. ...
1. ……

A great time to keep silent.
???: 这是个陷入沉默的好时机。

Your ugly trauma, a mixture of your mental issues and miserable past, would burst out in the next second, making everyone's heart twitch.
???: 你丰富的心理创伤与凄惨的过去将在此刻充沛地爆发，让每个人感到心脏抽痛。

But think otherwise.
???: 但，再想想看。

If the truth were known to all—today's not real, and there's no tomorrow, I'm going to eat my shoes, and an asteroid is falling—then all of them would go crazy.
???: 如果人人都能知道真相，知道今天是虚假的，明天不复存在，而我马上就会吃下我的鞋子，小行星即将坠落——他们都会发疯的。

Those "pigeons" valuing sense above anything won't sit aside and let this happen.
???: 那些理智至上的“白鸽”当然不希望看到那种事情发生。

So they made the most sensible choice. The huge white umbrella has only sheltered those qualified people. "Qualified" according to their standard.
???: 所以他们做出了最理智的抉择。这把巨大的白伞，始终都只笼罩着它所认定的人。

Now, let's cross our arms and make an arrogant judgment like those cynics, "How cruel it is!" And then, you may start contemplating.
???: 现在，让我们揣起手来，高高在上地点评一句“真是残忍的暴行”，再开始思考。

Should they all go aboard the ark? Can this ark carry these many people?
???: 这艘方舟应该把他们都带上吗？方舟能做到吗？

Try to raise the question as peacefully and slowly as you can. And their enthusiasm will be dampened and let out a sound like what you hear when you pour water into a heated pan—sssss ...
???: 你要尽可能平静而迟缓地提出这个问题，那些群情激奋的家伙便会像是被泼了冷水的热锅一样发出一声“嗤——”的漏气声后安静下来。

选项 / Choices

1. ... What about their feelings?
1. ……他们的感受呢?

Their feelings. Oh, they! You mean Eve, La, and the Matryoshka! Of course, you care about your friends. That's a virtue of yours I won't forget.
???: 他们的感受。哦——他们！你是指伊娃、拉和套娃！当然了，你关心你的朋友，我不会忘记你美好的品德。

In order to understand their feelings, you need to bend down and reach. That's right, reach for the dark corner under the stage.
???: 当你想明白他们的时候，得先躬下身子，然后伸手——对，伸手去摸摸那舞台下阴暗的角落。

Until your fingertip is wrapped by soft, warm, and considerate black velvet, as comfortable as a mother's singing to her baby in a crib.
???: 直到你的手指被阻隔，你会从皮肤尖端感到一阵体贴而柔软的包裹。黑色天鹅绒，美好得像是婴儿摇篮里母亲的歌声。

That's what the people without a shelter above them are feeling now.
???: 这便是那些头顶空空之人现在所感受到的。

选项 / Choices

1. ...
1. ……

More silence. You are really good at finding the right timing for your silence, just like my friend and I are experts in farting soundlessly in the elevator cart.
???: 又一次沉默。你总是擅长选择沉默的时机。就像是我和我的朋友擅长在电梯间里悄无声息地放屁。

My hypocrite and dumb friend, think about it in a different way.
???: 我虚伪又愚笨的朋友——换个角度想想吧。

Who knows how much garbage there is under the stage? There may be liquid seeping out of rotten pastry and dairy products, intrusions of American cockroach with sleek abdomen crawling everywhere ...
???: 我们都不知道这下头有多少垃圾，也许那些腐坏的饼与奶制品正在渗出汤汁，而无数油光锃亮、须长尾巴全的美洲大蠊在上头爬行。

Who can say it's not a blessing to know nothing about the truth?
???: 瞧不见真相未尝不是一种幸运。

Especially when you can't leave this shitty place.
???: 尤其是在你无法离开这狗*地方的时候。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Outside the Spotlight
聚光灯之外

好天气
Good Weather 4TH-21

Good Weather
好天气

Chairwoman: Final round of the vote.
主席: 正式表决的最后一轮投票。

Chairwoman: Voters, please hurry up.
主席: 与会成员，抓紧时间。

Chairwoman: One minute to go.
主席: 还有一分钟。

Mesmer Jr.: ...
小梅斯梅尔: ……

Chairwoman: Please be responsible to your votes in every round.
主席: 请珍惜你们手上的每一次投票机会。

Chairwoman: Vote as soon as possible.
主席: 快点投票。

Debate Moderator: The draft-avocates have more votes now, but they still need more than that to meet the supermajoritarian requirement.
主持人: 赞成票超过了反对票。但要到三分之二的支持率还有点距离。

Mesmer Jr.: What ...!
小梅斯梅尔: 什……！

Chairwoman: Please vote now.
主席： 请快投票。

Chairwoman: Thirty seconds to go.
主席： 还有三十秒。

Chairwoman: Final countdown.
主席： 开始进入倒计时。

Chairwoman: Ten seconds to go.
主席： 最后十秒。

Chairwoman: This will be your last chance to vote. Please hurry up!
主席： 没有投票的成员请马上投票！

Chairwoman: Voting closed.
主席： 投票结束。

Chairwoman: Storm Reformation: Manpower and Discipline passed.
主席： 《暴雨改革：增员与秩序》法案通过。

Mesmer Jr.: ...!!
小梅斯梅尔： ……！！

Lilya: Bucket list, one less!
红弩箭： 终生成就之一，达成！

Lilya: The glass is not as hard as I thought.
红弩箭： 这里的玻璃没我想象中的硬啊。

Lilya: Hey, time to wake up, Vertin.
红弩箭： 喂，该起床了，维尔汀。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀： ……

Senior Guard: What's that sound? What's going on?!
高级守卫： 什么声音？发生什么事了?！

Staff staying outside the ward rush into the room.
原本站在病房外看守的职员都冲了进来。

Lilya: That was a quick reaction.
红弩箭： 哟，反应得挺快嘛。

Lilya: Один, две, три ... Well, relax. I'll keep the acceptable damage under eight.
红弩箭： 一个，两个，三个……嗯，放心，我会尽可能地把受伤人数控制在八个以内。

Mesmer Jr.: What ... w-what is this ...
小梅斯梅尔： 啊，什么，这是什么……

Mesmer Jr. crouches next to the stool, rubbing her hands aimlessly.
小梅斯梅尔只是缩在凳子旁边，胡乱重复搓手的动作。

The staff are putting on well-designed helmets as they come in.
从外跑进来的职员戴上了精致的头盔。

Senior Guard: Everyone, get your gear, formation one ...
高级守卫： 各位，排好队形，拿上装备——

Senior Guard: Capture the intruder!
高级守卫： 制服入侵者！

Lilya: Hahaha! Bring it on! Let me have my dear long-lost real fight!
红弩箭：哈哈哈……来吧！让我来体验一下久违的实战——！

Lilya: Heh ... heh heh ... hahaha ...
红弩箭：呵……呵呵……哈哈哈……

Senior Guard: Emergency! Room 1525 calling for backup!
高级守卫：救援，1525 房间紧急呼叫救援！！

Lilya whisks away his walkie-talkie.
红弩箭一扫帚打飞了传呼机。

Lilya: Hey, no backup! I need to strictly follow the damage control standard.
红弩箭：喂，别呼叫增援！我得严格控制情节的严重程度才行。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Vertin: L- ... Lilya ...?
维尔汀：红……红弩箭……？

Lilya: Finally awake?
红弩箭：你终于醒了？

Lilya: Nice, time for us to leave.
红弩箭：很好，那我们也该离开这里了。

Lilya: Come here and sit on the broom ... yes, behind me ... Grab tight! Don't say I didn't warn you if you fall down and die!
红弩箭：过来，给我坐到扫帚上……对，坐到我后面，抓紧了！半空中掉下去是会真没命的！

Vertin: Urgh ...
维尔汀：唔……

Neither the mind nor the body is responding to her calling.
头脑和身体不听使唤。

No reaction can be given to what is happening.
无法对眼前的景象产生反应。

She only knows to grab the handrail tightly.
只知道要紧紧抓住侧边的扫帚扶手。

The metal handrail feels cold and hard. This is the result of everyone's effort.
扶手，金属质感的扶手，只知道这冰凉的触感，这扶手，这一切都来之不易。

Lilya: Alright, Red 38, let's go!
红弩箭：好，红色 38，出发——！

A strong shake.
强烈的震感。

Senior Guard: Mesmer Jr., Mesmer Jr.! What are you doing?! They are running away! Go ... Get them!
高级守卫：小梅斯梅尔，小梅斯梅尔！你在干什么？她们要走了，快……快抓住她们啊！

Mesmer Jr.: *sobs* They are, mad people ...
小梅斯梅尔：呜……是，是疯子……

Lilya: Save your whining for Constantine!
红弩箭：别白费功夫了！还是省点力气去向康斯坦丁告状吧！

The broom rises into the air.
身下的载具腾空而起。

It doesn't waste a second to pause, flying towards the open windows.
它坚定地，永不回头地驶向那扇洞开的大窗。

The dazzling, glaring white light—so strange, but also so familiar.
那刺目的，耀眼的白光——如此陌生，又如此熟悉。

Warm wind blows in through the window.
温热的暖流从窗户涌入。

It's a cloudless, sunny day outside.
窗外晴空万里。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Vertin: What good weather.
维尔汀：今天是个好天气。

Vertin: My friends.
维尔汀：朋友们。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 被裁剪过的旧报纸

Trail ① A Clipping of Old Newspaper 小径

A Clipping of Old Newspaper
被裁剪过的旧报纸

英文 / ENGLISH
What Does Abstained Vote Mean And The Necessity of Abstention Ballot Box

Abstained Vote is one of many forms of protest votes.
It usually turns up next to an empty seat, inside a dustbin, between the washing machine and the wall, in the middle of a book, or in one of the inner pockets of an old jacket. It is the invalid vote cast because the voter has abstained from voting, and thus would not be counted into the election result.

Different from other reasons which caused failure to vote, voters cast abstained votes because they neither approve nor disapprove of the available options of the voting. They may have swung between different answers, or even were once slightly more in favor of one motion/candidate over the rest of them, or hold a pessimistic opinion to all the options provided; whatever the reason might be, in the end, they decide to not support any motions/candidates in the election.
Many have also argued that abstention from voting is, in fact, an action guided by a clear awareness of their given rights. As the subjects of rights, voters are entitled to the freedom not to vote.
It is also argued by the same group of scholars that, when the voters are requested to choose between unfavorable options, it takes courage and determination to stay true to their own ideas and become the dissidents in this case. Such action is worthy of praise. They are individual thinkers who know what they need and are strong enough not to compromise.
The Abstention Ballot Box is specially set up to count the votes of this group of people. It stands for a new possibility, a new way to the yet unknown solution to the problem, a relatively

bumpy path compared to the easy way. Those who know its value and seek for the difficult path will eventually find their way in, and along which they shall find places they truly belong to.

The New York Daily Jan 19th, 1961
Written by: John Greymirror Brown
中文 / CHINESE
《弃票的内容解读及“弃票箱”的必要性讨论》

弃票，逆反票的一种。

通常出现在空坐席旁、垃圾桶内、洗衣机缝隙中、某册书本夹页或是旧夹克的里侧口袋。被视为放弃投票而生成的无效票，不计入票池统计。

撇去时间造成的漏票、失误票等特殊情况，弃票的产生，往往意味着持票者对该选题不支持也不反对。他们曾在其中摇摆，具有倾向或是对双方都持有悲观的态度，并在最终以个人意志放弃选票。

但另一派研究者们认为，弃票的出现象征着持票者权利主体意识的提升，象征着“选择的自由”真正存在于这场选择之中。

他们认为：当主流的“二选一”难题置于面前，敢于、勇于、决定于此时出列，成为差异者的行为是值得犒赏的。促成这部分差异者的并非懒惰、悲观或优柔寡断，而是更为激进且清晰的独立性——他们清晰地明白自己的需求，且不愿妥协。

在此，我们姑且将这一论调代表的票群计入“弃票箱”。它代表着一种新可能，一种全新的处事方式，一条相较于坦荡大道之言，蜿蜒曲折的小路。追寻着它的人自会找到它，寻得属于自己的归身之处。

撰稿者：约翰·灰镜·布朗

——《纽约每日报》1961 年 1 月 19 日刊

归巢的鸟群
Returning Birds 4TH-22

Returning Birds
归巢的鸟群

Lilya: How do you feel?
红弩箭： 怎么样?

Lilya: Getting used to the light?
红弩箭： 习惯这亮光了吗?

Vertin: Hmm ...
维尔汀： 嗯……

Vertin: The wind feels ... so good ...
维尔汀： 风……好舒服……

Lilya: Haha, this is just an appetizer. I'll be gentle since you are just "discharged."
红弩箭： 哼哼，你还没试过更舒服的呢。看在你“刚刚出院”的份上，我这次开得温柔点儿。

Vertin: Are they alright?
维尔汀： 他们还好吗?

Lilya: Good as new.
红弩箭： 挺好的。

Lilya: They stayed up all night, just to save you.
红弩箭：大家都为了你忙得脚不沾地，通宵未眠。

Lilya: Haha, I guess you are the only one who has slept tight.
红弩箭：哈哈，我看现在睡得最好的只有你了。

Vertin: Haha ...
维尔汀：哈……

Lilya: Madam Z, Druvis, Sonetto ...
红弩箭：Z 女士，槲寄生，十四行诗……

Lilya: From the bill, and the protesting, to countless debates, planning and ...
红弩箭：从改革法案、宣战抗议……到无数次的打探、辩论与计算……

Lilya: Everyone is holding their umbrellas for you, Vertin.
红弩箭：所有人……都在不约而同地为你撑伞，维尔汀。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Lilya: The "Storm"...
红弩箭：会过去的。

Lilya: It will pass, one day.
红弩箭：这一场“暴雨”。

Vertin: Thank you. Thank you all.
维尔汀：……谢谢你们。

Vertin: Yes. Everything is going to be alright.
维尔汀：是的，一切都会好起来的。

Lilya: Enough flying. Time to head back.
红弩箭：兜够风了，是时候返程了。

Vertin: What are we doing next?
维尔汀：我们接下来要怎么做?

Lilya: Hmm ... no idea. Meet your friends first.
红弩箭：嗯，不知道，先和你那群朋友见个面吧。

Lilya: Fight with your comrade in arms, fear no danger ahead.
红弩箭：只要能和战友一起并肩作战，就无需畏惧前路的艰险。

Lilya: Grab tight, I'm going to speed up.
红弩箭：抓紧点，我要加速了。

The wind flows through them like waves.
涌动的风扑面而来。

Lilya: Charge! The great Red 38!
红弩箭：冲锋，伟大的红色 38——!

Lilya: Long live Su-oıвe!
红弩箭：万岁!

Druvis Ⅲ: How are you feeling? Better now?
槲寄生：怎么样？现在好些了吗?

Regulus: *coughs* ... It's ... it's killing me ...
星锑：咳咳，咳咳咳……噎死，噎死我了……

APPLe: Here's water! Captain, sip, please. Don't put too much pressure on your esophagus.
APPLe: 水来了！船长，请小口小口喝，不要对食道造成太大的压力。

APPLe: *sighs* This APPLe told you not to swallow leba in haste ...
APPLe: 唉，APPLe 某说过，不能这么着急地吞咽列巴……

Regulus: *drinks water*
星锑: 咕咚……咕咚……

Regulus: Ah ... *coughing* ...
星锑: 啊……咳咳……

Regulus: I'm ... I'm alive ... Ah ...
星锑: 活，活过来了……啊……

Regulus: Oooh, I thought I wouldn't be able to see the sun tomorrow or see Vertin discharged!
星锑: 呜呜，我还以为，我要见不到明天的太阳，也见不到维尔汀出院了！

选项 / Choices

1. You will.
1. 还能见到哦

2. Why are the leba bread here?
2. 为什么这里会有列巴

分支 1 / Branch 1

Regulus: Who's talking?
星锑: 谁在说话?

Is it because they have been apart for too long?
是因为分隔了太久吗?

Or is this an illusion generated by their longingness?
还是因为过于思念产生了幻觉?

They turn around in slow motion, straining their eyes.
所有人都像电影慢镜头一样转身，睁大了双眼。

Regulus: Vertin!!!
星锑: 维尔汀——！！！

Regulus: You're back!
星锑: 你回来了！

分支 2 / Branch 2

Regulus: Because Lilya—
星锑: 因为红弩箭她——

Regulus: Wait, whose voice was that ...
星锑: 不对，怎么多了一个人的声音……

Regulus: Is it ...
星锑: 是……

Mixed feelings turn into tears running out of her eyes. Is it out of shock, or ecstasy?
夺眶而出的情绪，是惊愕，还是欢喜的热流?

So many struggling days and nights.
是无数个挣扎的日与夜。

This is the finish line of desperation. Ahead of them, hopes await.
是无望与希望的界限。

Regulus: Vertin! You silly git!
星锑：维尔汀！你个混蛋！

Regulus: Now you come back!
星锑：总算知道回来了！

共同接续 / Shared continuation

APPLe: Vertin!
APPLe：维尔汀！

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin!!
槲寄生：维尔汀！！

Sotheby: Vertin!!!
苏芙比：维尔汀！！！

Regulus: Whoa ... *sobbing* ...
星锑：哇啊……呜呜呜……

Druvis Ⅲ: Are you feeling okay? There was a lot of equipment connected to you ...
槲寄生：你的身体还好吗？我看到你身上接了很多设备……

Druvis Ⅲ: Do you feel any discomfort?
槲寄生：现在会有什么不适吗？

APPLe: Do you need any nutritional supplements, Ms. Vertin? We have a lot of healthy, fresh salads here ...
APPLe：需要补充点营养吗？维尔汀小姐。我们这里有很多刚做好的健康沙拉……

Sotheby: Where did you come back from? What are all these white pigeons doing after you?
苏芙比：你是从哪里回来的呀！为什么会有那么多白鸽跟着你呀！

Sotheby: You seem to have gained weight ... No no, lost weight? Um, no ...
苏芙比：你好像胖了……不对，应该是瘦了，嗯，还是不对……

Vertin: I'm fine. Fit as a fiddle.
维尔汀：我很好。没胖也没有瘦。

Vertin: Just a bit of headache, nothing else.
维尔汀：身体也很好，只是有点头痛。

Vertin: It's good to see you again.
维尔汀：能再次见到你们，真好。

Vertin: Thank you for being here ... being around me.
维尔汀：谢谢你们还在这里……还在我身边。

Regulus wipes her face on the coat in front of her.
星锑使劲地把脸往面前的衣襟上揉了揉。

Regulus: ... Of course!
星锑：……这不是废话吗！

Regulus: Of course we ... we're waiting for you!
星锑：我们，我们当然要等你回来啊！

Regulus: You're the only ... friend we have in this world!
星锑：你可是我们留在这个世界上唯一的……朋友了！

All the waiting has been worthwhile.
似乎所有的等待都获得了应有的回报。

In the meantime, footsteps come from a distance.
而此时此刻，许多人的脚步声从树林外传来。

Footsteps of well-trained, strong soldiers.
训练有素的，边锐分明的脚步声。

Constantine: Welcome back, Vertin.
康斯坦丁：欢迎你回来，维尔汀。

A figure in a white robe emerges in the woods.
身着白袍的人出现在林中。

Constantine: We have good news to share.
康斯坦丁：我们正好有一个好消息要分享给你。

Vertin: ...!
维尔汀：……！

Next to her, stand Sonetto, Madam Z, and some unfamiliar faces.
康斯坦丁的身旁站着十四行诗，Z 女士，还有一些没有见过的职员。

The moment their eyes meet in the air, Sonetto opens her mouth—but she eventually doesn't speak a word.
与十四行诗对视的那一刻，她似乎张了张嘴，但什么也没说。

Sonetto: ...!
十四行诗：……！

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

Sonetto: ... This is good. This is great.
十四行诗：……这样也好。这样很好。

Vertin: May I ask what good news?
维尔汀：请问是什么好消息？

Constantine: The passage of the bill—*Storm Reformation: Manpower and Discipline*.
康斯坦丁：《暴雨改革：秩序与增员》法案在基金会通过了。

Constantine: Once it's approved by the Pax Security Council, it will become law.
康斯坦丁：等人类和平安全理事会审阅无误，它便会成为一部正式的法律。

Constantine: Your friends and you will enjoy more autonomy, and a life with even fewer restrictions.
康斯坦丁：你和你的朋友们将拥有更独立的自主权，以及更自由的生活方式。

Constantine: You will also have a more respectable status in the Foundation.
康斯坦丁：你在基金会也会获得更多的尊重。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Constantine: Ms. Z will fill you in with more details.
康斯坦丁：其他的修订细节，就由 Z 女士传达给你吧。

Vertin: Thank you for telling me this.
维尔汀：感谢您告知我这一消息。

Lilya, who has been quiet by their side the whole time, suddenly speaks up.
在旁侧一直沉默不语的红弩箭突然冒出一句话。

Lilya: What about the treatment?
红弩箭：那这治疗怎么说？

Constantine: Treatment?
康斯坦丁： 治疗?

Constantine: Didn't it finish just now?
康斯坦丁： 不是刚好结束了吗?

Constantine: This treatment has an investigative purpose, and the Timekeeper has passed the examination as a safe, low-risk individual. As Ms. Z has said, Ms. Vertin is strong enough to be the Timekeeper.
康斯坦丁： 这次审查治疗的结果为低风险，判定为安全。正如 Z 女士所说的，维尔汀小姐具有坚毅的精神，足以担当司辰这一职位。

Constantine: However, you will receive punishments for the damage to public property. I suggest you heed it as a warning.
康斯坦丁： 不过，对于非法破坏公共场所财物的行为，我们会施与一定的惩罚，以示警戒。

Lilya: ...
红弩箭： ……

Constantine waves to the crowd. The rest of them are about to leave.
康斯坦丁挥了挥手，其他人也准备离开了。

Constantine: We should say our goodbye. Please rest well.
康斯坦丁： 我们走了。请各位好好休息。

She suddenly notices the white dove on the tree and stops.
她注意到了伫立在树上的白鸽，突然停了下来。

Constantine: Hmm, seems like the dove of the white marble house is paying you a visit.
康斯坦丁： 嗯，看来你遇到了来自白色石屋的鸽子。

Vertin: What do you mean?
维尔汀： 这是什么意思?

Constantine: Heh heh ... Nothing peculiar.
康斯坦丁： 呵呵……没什么特别的意思。

Constantine: It just means you have come to their notice.
康斯坦丁： 只是代表着，你被他们注意到了。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

小径① 小狗儿之歌
Trail ① The Song of A Puppy 小径

The Song of A Puppy
小狗儿之歌

英文 / ENGLISH
I once looked down at a brave young dog,
It was gallant, the most courageous of all.
It wears a hat in piebald, and has eyes of emerald.
The first-magnitude stars sprinkle on its spine. Its tail was as green as the moss.

It was once asleep, once hungry, once afraid, once in tears,
once an umbrella, once a tree,
once a jumping coat rack and a ship

Oh, but then, but then --
It's again the brave young dog. Loyal and gutsy, it walks among the hearts of gold.
中文 / CHINESE
我曾见过一只勇敢的小狗儿，
最勇敢、最勇敢的小狗儿。
它有花白的帽檐，它有碧绿的眼睛，
它有一等星的背脊，也有苔藓绿色的尾巴。

它曾沉睡，曾饥饿，曾退怯，也曾哭泣，
它曾是一把伞，又成了一棵树，
再变为一艘船或一根蹦跳的衣帽架。
哦，如今呀，如今呀——
如今它又成了勇敢且忠诚的狗儿，行走在金子般的心之间。

今时往日
Old Days Once More 4TH-23

Old Days Once More
今时往日

This is the end. Everything has been settled.
一切都尘埃落定了。

Time flows by like water flows over a perfectly flat plain.
日子将像水自东流般平铺直叙地淌过。

Z: Yes. That's right. En, I got it.
Z: 没错，是这样。嗯，我明白。

Z: I'll reply tomorrow.
Z: 我明天答复你。

Madam Z returns to her office as usual.
Z 女士与往日一样，回到自己办公室的门前。

But this time, the secretary, who always fully engages in the daily agenda, looks up to her.
这一次，沉浸在事程规划的秘书抬起了头。

Secretary Sharon: Please wait, Madam Z.
秘书莎朗: Z 女士，请稍等。

She passes her a box.
她将一个小方盒递过来。

Secretary Sharon: Madam Constantine asked me to give this to you.
秘书莎朗: 副会长要我把这个交给你。

Z: Did she say why?
Z: ……她有说什么原因吗?

Secretary Sharon: No, she didn't explain it.
秘书莎朗: 没有，她没特别说明缘由。

Sharon quickly goes through her head.
莎朗在原地想了一下。

Secretary Sharon: Wait, I think she mentioned ... it's September 11 in the Chinese calendar today.
秘书莎朗: 哦，她好像提了一句……今天是农历九月十一。

Z: ...
Z: ……

Z: I see. Please send my thanks to her.
Z: 知道了。帮我传达一下谢意。

Sharon nods and quietly returns to her seat.
莎朗点点头，安静地回到了自己的办公区。

Madam Z looks at the box.
Z 女士低头看着手中的方盒。

A faint smell of red sandalwood wafts in the air.
一股淡淡的，小叶紫檀的香气在空气中飘浮着。

A set of brand new Go.
是崭新的黑白棋子。

A gift card is attached.
里面附有一张短小的贺函。

Constantine: "I'm glad to witness your progress."
康斯坦丁: “很高兴见证了你的成长。”

Z: ...
Z: ……

Madam Z closes the box calmly and puts it into her pocket.
Z 女士平静地将盒盖合上，放进口袋里。

She opens the door and walks into her office.
她打开门，进入了办公室。

She looks around.
Z 女士环视了一圈办公室。

This is just an ordinary room. Normal, but practical.
这是一间普通且适用的房间。

There are regulation documents, academic journals, and calendars and agendas. An old photo is placed next to the mirror.
四周放了规章文件、学术期刊、日程表，还有一张置于镜旁的老照片。

She sees herself in that mirror.
她在镜中看到了自己的脸。

The face in the mirror is a lot more mature than the young girl in that old photo.
比起那张黑白照片中的少女，如今镜中人的轮廓变得更加分明。

... Will a doe become a tigress?
——白鹿会成为猛虎吗?

She runs her hand through her hair.
她捋了捋头发。

It doesn't seem too long ago when she still had a braid to her shoulder.
留着及肩的长辫的日子，仿佛尚在眼前。

She combs her hair and splits it into three strands.
她将短短的发尾分为三束。

Lay the leftmost strand on top of the rightmost, go across, then the right goes on top of the left, cross, and tie it up.
左趋右，交叉，右趋左，交叉，复系之。

The braid bristles, like an awkward sheep tail.
辫子翘了起来，就像不合时宜的羊尾辫。

Z: Heh heh ...
Z: 呵呵……

She opens the refrigerator and takes out a plain cake under the cold light.
Z 女士打开冰柜，在冷色的光照下捧出一块白色的蛋糕。

With a tight pull, the lamp turns off.
轻轻一拉灯绳。

The room quiets down again.
屋内恢复了最初的静谧。

Happy birthday to you, happy birthday to you.
祝你生日快乐，祝你生日快乐。

May the good luck go with you. Happy birthday to you.
祝你幸福祝你健康，祝你前途光明。

blows out the candle
呼。

THE END
THE END